

RAS Prelims 2026 · Handwritten Class Notes

Rajasthan History, Art & Culture

Chapter-by-chapter notes in coaching-lecture style —
concept first, then the facts, with flow charts, mind
maps, previous-year callouts and current-affairs links.

RH01 Pre-historic and Proto-historic Sites of Rajasthan

RH02 Sources of Rajasthan History

RH03 Early Dynasties of Rajasthan

RH04 Mewar: Guhil-Sisodia Dynasty

RH05 Marwar, Dhundhar, Bikaner, Jaisalmer, Hadoti & Other States

RH06 Rajasthan & the Mughals; Medieval Administration and Revenue System

RH07 Rajputana under the British; 19th-Century Conditions & Reform

RH08 1857 in Rajasthan; Peasant and Tribal Movements

RH09 Prajamandals, Press, Freedom Fighters & Integration of Rajasthan

RH10 Architecture: Forts, Palaces, Temples, Havelis, Stepwells

RH11 Painting Schools and Handicrafts

RH12 Performing Arts: Music, Dance, Theatre, Instruments

RPSC RAS & RTS Preliminary Examination · 6 December 2026 · 150 questions · 200 marks · 1/3

RH13 Language, Dialects, Literature; Saints, Sects and Folk Deities

negative marking

RH14 Social Life: Fairs, Festivals, Customs, Dress, Ornaments, Tribes

RH01

Pre-historic and Proto-historic Sites of Rajasthan

About 2-3 questions a paper, and they have come from a small pool - Kalibangan, Ahar, Ganeshwar, Balathal, Ojijana, Bairath. Matching and one-liners dominate; ordering questions appear now and then.

This is the archaeology chapter - mounds, excavators, pottery and rivers. RPSC does not ask you to interpret anything here; it asks site-to-district, site-to-river, site-to-excavator and site-to-that-one-famous-find. Clean tables win these marks.

Pre & Proto-historic Rajasthan

Palaeolithic

- Didwana - Singi Talav (Nagaur)
- Budha Pushkar (Ajmer)
- Luni valley
- Berach valley

Mesolithic

- Bagor - Kothari, Bhilwara
- Tilwara - Luni, Barmer
- Microliths
- Animal domestication c. 5000 BCE

Ahar / Banas

Chalcolithic

- Ahar - Tambavati
- Gilund
- Balathal
- Ojijana
- Black-and-Red Ware

Copper belt

- Ganeshwar - Kantli, Sikar
- Jodhpura - Sabi
- Kurada (Nagaur)
- OCP pottery

Harappan / Bronze Age

- Kalibangan - Ghaggar, Hanumangarh
- Baror (Sri Ganganagar)
- Sothi (Bikaner)
- Rang Mahal

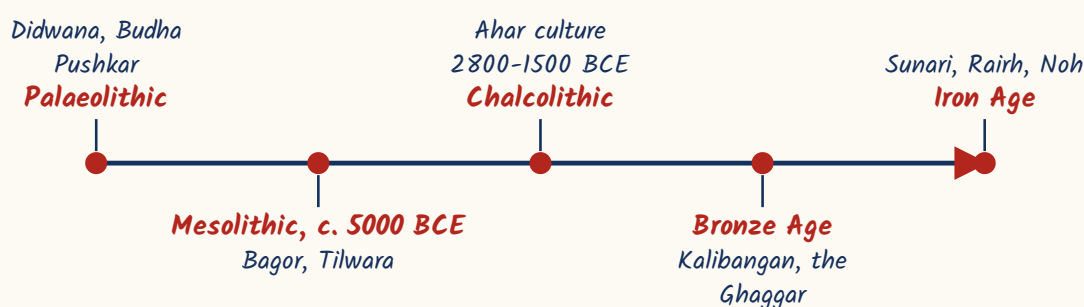
Iron Age & early historic

- Sunari (Jhunjhunu)
- Rairh (Tonk)
- Noh (Bharatpur)
- Nagari (Chittorgarh)
- Bairath (Jaipur)

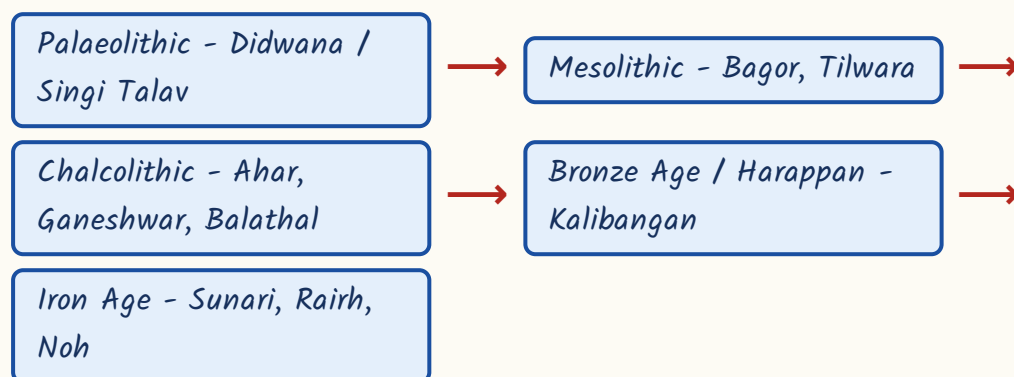
Fix the ladder first - five stages, one anchor site each

Every question in this chapter is really the same question: which stage does this site belong to. So fix the ladder before you learn a single name. Rajasthan's record runs Palaeolithic, then Mesolithic, then Chalcolithic, then Bronze Age (which here means Harappan), then Iron Age. Learn one anchor site per stage and hang everything else on those five pegs. The order itself is asked - Didwana, Bagor, Ahar, Kalibangan, Sunari. D-B-A-K-S.

The cultural ladder - Palaeolithic to Iron Age



The stage ladder - and the exact order RPSC asks



- Palaeolithic - stone hand-axes and flakes, no pottery, no farming; sites sit on old river gravels and lake margins.
- Mesolithic - microliths, that is tiny stone blades; the first animal domestication; Bagor is the type site.
- Chalcolithic - copper and stone used together, settled village farming, Black-and-Red Ware pottery.
- Bronze Age in Rajasthan means the Harappans, and that means Kalibangan and the Ghaggar valley only.
- Iron Age - iron slag, smelting furnaces and punch-marked coins; Sunari, Rairh and Noh.

TRAP

Rajasthan has no separately established Neolithic site of its own. The Mesolithic at Bagor runs straight on into the Chalcolithic. If an option offers you a famous Neolithic site of Rajasthan, treat it with suspicion.

Palaeolithic and Mesolithic - the stone-tool layer

This layer is thin in the exam but it is free marks, because only four or five names exist. All of them are river-valley or lake-margin sites - early humans camped where there was water and where there were pebbles to work.

- Didwana in Nagaur, with its Singi Talav locality, is Rajasthan's best-known Palaeolithic site.
- Budha Pushkar in Ajmer is the other named Palaeolithic site.
- The Luni valley in the west and the Berach valley in Mewar are the two classic Palaeolithic tool-bearing tracts.

Mesolithic - Bagor is basically the whole answer

Bagor in Bhilwara is India's largest and best-documented Mesolithic site. Say that adjective exactly - largest - because that is the wording RPSC uses. It sits on the Kothari river. V.N. Misra dug it between 1967 and 1970.

- Bagor gave some of India's earliest evidence of animal domestication, around 5000 BCE.
- The tool kit is dominated by microliths; five human burials were recovered.
- Tilwara in Barmer is the other Mesolithic site - on the Luni, also excavated by V.N. Misra, 1967-68.

TRAP

Three B-names, three completely different things. Bagor = Mesolithic, Bhilwara, Kothari river. Bairath = Ashokan and Buddhist, Jaipur region. Barli = Rajasthan's oldest inscription, Ajmer. Examiners rotate these three inside one option set.

The Ahar or Banas culture - the heart of the chapter

Ahar culture is the Chalcolithic village culture of southern Rajasthan, roughly 2800 to 1500 BCE. It is also called the Banas culture, after the river system it sits in. Two features define it. One, Black-and-Red Ware pottery carrying white linear designs. Two, heavy use of copper with almost no microliths. That second point is the examiner's favourite - these people had so much copper that they stopped bothering with stone blades.

The four Ahar-culture sites you must be able to place

Site	District	River / setting	The one fact
Ahar (Aghatpur, Aghatdurg)	Udaipur	Ayad-Berach	Called Tambavati - the place of copper

Site	District	River / setting	The one fact
Gilund	Rajsamand	Banas	First dug by B.B. Lal; later Indo-American work
Balathal	Udaipur	Near Udaipur, fortified mound	Oldest skeletal evidence of leprosy in India, c. 2000 BCE
Ojiyana	Bhilwara	Hill slope	Painted bull and cow figurines

- Ahar was first dug by Akshay Kirti Vyas in 1953, then by R.C. Agrawal and H.D. Sankalia in 1961-62.
- Gilund's later excavation was by V.S. Shinde and G.L. Possehl.
- Balathal was excavated by V.N. Misra from 1993; it has a massive fortified enclosure wall.
- Ojiyana was excavated by B.R. Meena of the ASI Jaipur Circle in 1999-2000.
- Tag line for revision - Ahar = copper, Gilund = B.B. Lal, Balathal = leprosy plus fort wall, Ojiyana = figurines.

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2021 - the ancient name Tambavati, meaning the place of copper, refers to which site? Answer: Ahar, Udaipur.

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2021 - the oldest skeletal evidence of leprosy in India was reported from which Rajasthan site? Answer: Balathal, from a skeleton of about 2000 BCE.

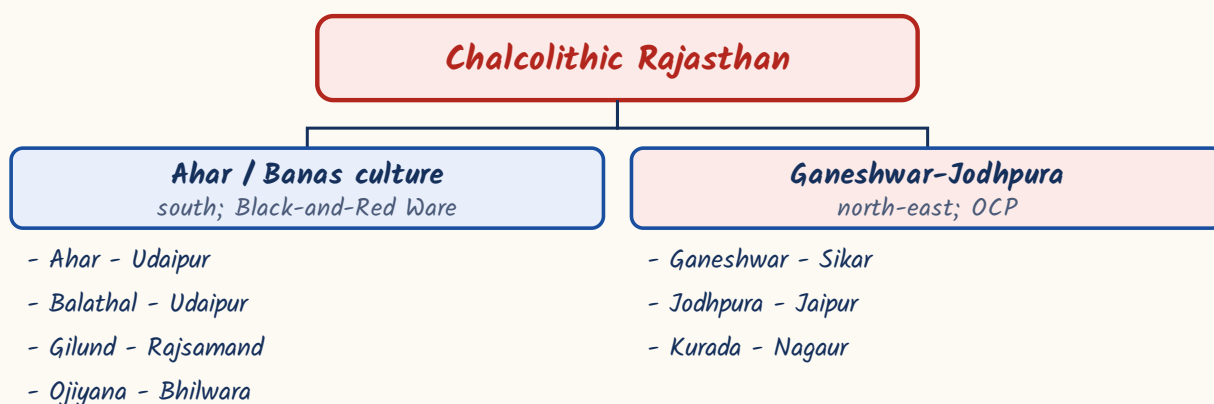
ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2024 - the excavation of Ojiyana was conducted under whose direction? Answer: B.R. Meena, ASI Jaipur Circle, 1999-2000.

Ganeshwar-Jodhpura - the copper belt of the north-east

Different corner of the state, different culture. While Ahar was working copper in the south, a separate copper culture grew up in the north-east, next to the Khetri copper belt. This is the Ganeshwar-Jodhpura culture. Its pottery is Ochre Coloured Pottery, OCP - not Black-and-Red Ware. That single contrast has carried more than one question.

Two Chalcolithic cultures, two corners of the state



- Ganeshwar lies in the Neem ka Thana area of Sikar district, on the Kantli river.
- It was excavated by R.C. Agrawal and Vijay Kumar.
- Over 2,000 copper objects were recovered - arrowheads, fish-hooks, bangles, chisels.
- The culture is believed to have supplied copper to the Harappans.
- Jodhpura, the second name site, lies on the Sabi river in the Jaipur region.
- Kurada in Nagaur is a separate copper-hoard site.

Ahar vs Ganeshwar - the contrast RPSC builds questions on

Ahar / Banas culture	Ganeshwar-Jodhpura culture
Southern Rajasthan - Ayad, Berach, Banas	North-eastern Rajasthan - Kantli, Sabi
Black-and-Red Ware with white linear designs	Ochre Coloured Pottery (OCP)
Copper consumed at the settlement	Copper produced, and probably exported
Udaipur, Rajsamand, Bhilwara	Sikar, Jaipur region

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2023 - Ganeshwar, famous for its hoard of copper objects, is in which district? Answer: Sikar.

TRAP

Ganeshwar is in Sikar; Sunari is in Jhunjhunu. Both are Shekhawati, both sit on the Kantli, and both are about metal - but Ganeshwar is copper and Chalcolithic, Sunari is iron and Iron Age. Do not let the shared river fool you.

Kalibangan - the one Harappan site of Rajasthan

Kalibangan in Hanumangarh is the star of this chapter, and it also appears in the Indus Valley chapter of Indian History. It sits on the left bank of the dry Ghaggar. The name means black bangles, from the bangle fragments littering the mound. Do not learn it as a description - learn it as a list of firsts and onlys, because that is exactly how it is asked.

Kalibangan - the firsts and onlys

Ploughed field

world's earliest; pre-Harappan

Double fortification

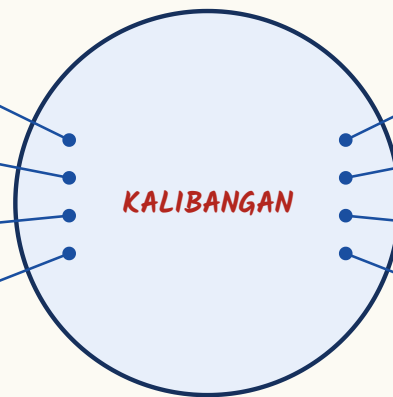
citadel and lower town both

Earthquake

evidence from about 2600 BCE

Bricks

3:2:1 early, 4:2:1 mature



Fire altars

a row of seven on the citadel

No covered drains

unlike Mohenjo-daro

Cylinder seal

woman between two spearmen

Ghaggar, left bank

Hanumangarh district

- World's earliest attested ploughed field - pre-Harappan, with criss-cross furrows.
- A row of seven fire altars on the citadel mound.
- The only Harappan site where both the citadel and the lower town were fortified.
- No elaborate covered drainage system - the opposite of Mohenjo-daro.
- Evidence of an earthquake around 2600 BCE.
- A cylinder seal showing a woman between two spear-bearing men; three types of burial.

Who found what at Kalibangan - the discovery chain

Luigi Pio Tessitori draws attention, 1917-18



A. Ghosh identifies it as Harappan, 1951-52



B.B. Lal & B.K. Thapar excavate, 1961-69



Site museum opens, 1983

Kalibangan Period I vs Period II - the brick question

Period I - pre-Harappan	Period II - Mature Harappan
Bricks 30 x 20 x 10 cm	Bricks 30 x 15 x 7.5 cm
Ratio 3 : 2 : 1	Ratio 4 : 2 : 1
The ploughed field belongs to this phase	Fortified citadel and fortified lower town

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2023 - the excavation of Kalibangan between 1961 and 1969 was directed by whom? Answer: B.B. Lal, with B.K. Thapar. A. Ghosh only identified the mound, in 1951-52 - that is the distractor.

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2021 as a statement question - both citadel and lower town fortified (true), seven fire altars on the citadel (true), elaborate covered drainage like Mohenjo-daro (false). Answer: statements I and II only.

TRAP

The drainage statement is the standard false option. Kalibangan had no developed covered drainage. And its lower town was fortified - if a statement says unfortified, it is wrong.

CURRENT LINK

Current link, as of September 2026 - no pre-historic site of Rajasthan is on the UNESCO World Heritage List. The state's inscribed properties are the Hill Forts of Rajasthan (2013), Jantar Mantar Jaipur (2010), the Walled City of Jaipur (2019) and Keoladeo National Park (1985). Kalibangan is a centrally protected ASI site with its own museum since 1983. If an option pairs Kalibangan with UNESCO, it is wrong.

The Iron Age and early historic mounds

Now the metal changes. Iron appears in the north-east and east of the state, along with punch-marked coins and the beginnings of the town. Three names carry this section - Sunari, Rairh and Noh. Learn the third column of the table below; that is the column that gets asked.

Iron Age and early historic sites

Site	District	Setting	Famous for
Sunari	Jhunjhunu	Kantli river	Earliest iron-smelting furnaces reported from Rajasthan
Rairh	Tonk	Dheel river	3,075 punch-marked coins, huge iron slag heaps
Noh	Bharatpur	Eastern plain	Four-fold sequence OCP - BRW - PGW - NBPW; Jakh Baba yaksha
Nagari	Chittorgarh	Ancient Madhyamika	Capital of the Shivi janapada
Rang Mahal	Hanumangarh	Ghaggar	Swedish expedition; Kushana-Gupta material
Bhinmal	Jalore	Western Rajasthan	Roman and Greek wine vessels, Shaka-period material

- Rairh was excavated by K.N. Puri in 1938-39 and is called the Tata Nagar of ancient India for its iron working.
- The colossal yaksha statue worshipped locally as Jakh Baba came from Noh.
- The Ghosundi-Hathibada inscription was found close to Nagari.
- Rang Mahal was dug by a Swedish expedition led by Hanna Rydh, 1952-54 - the only Rajasthan site dug by a foreign woman archaeologist, which is why it gets asked.
- Bhinmal was excavated by R.C. Agrawal, 1953-54.
- Baror (Sri Ganganagar) and Sothi (Bikaner) are Ghaggar-valley pre-Harappan and Harappan sites; A. Ghosh named the Sothi culture after Sothi.
- Jhadol (Udaipur), Pindpadaliya (Chittorgarh), Malah (Bharatpur), Kurada (Nagaur) and Sabaniya of the western desert belt are the smaller proto-historic finds.

Bairath - Ashoka, the Buddha and a circular temple

Bairath, also called Viratnagar, in the Jaipur region, is the odd one out in this chapter. It is not a Chalcolithic village at all - it is a Mauryan and Buddhist centre. Daya Ram Sahni excavated it in 1936-37. It links straight into the Mauryan chapter of Indian History, so learn it once and use it twice.

- Two minor rock edicts of Ashoka have been reported from Bairath.
- The Bhabru edict, also called the Calcutta-Bairat edict, names the Buddha, the Dhamma and the Sangha.
- That edict is no longer at the site - it is preserved in the Asiatic Society, Kolkata.
- Bijak-ki-Pahadi at Bairath has India's oldest free-standing circular Buddhist temple, a chaitya-griha.
- A jar containing punch-marked silver coins and Indo-Greek coins was found here.
- Bhim ji ki Dungri and Ganesh Dungri are the site's other mounds.

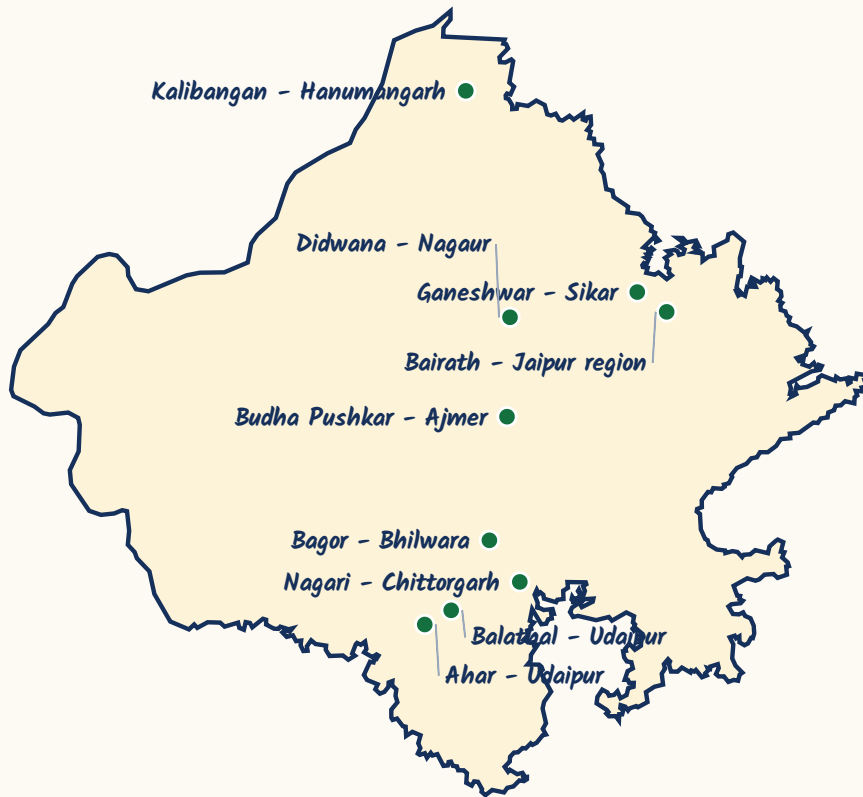
ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2024 - the Bhabru rock edict of Ashoka, which mentions the Buddha, the Dhamma and the Sangha, was found at? Answer: Bairath. Note the follow-up trap - it is now kept in Kolkata.

Two drills you must actually do - pottery and excavators

Everything above collapses into two matching tables. Say these out loud until they are automatic. In a matching question you will not have time to reconstruct them from the story.

Site to district - the whole chapter on one map



Harappan only on the Ghaggar; copper cultures north-east and south

The four diagnostic wares

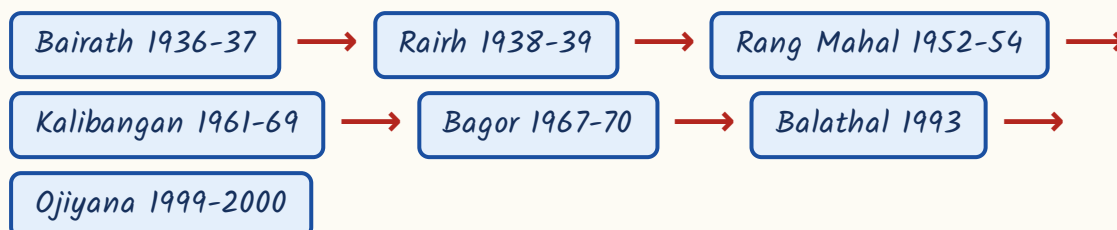
Ware	Full name	Where it is prominent
OCP	Ochre Coloured Pottery	Ganeshwar, Jodhpura, Noh
BRW	Black-and-Red Ware	Ahar, Gilund, Balathal - with white linear designs
PGW	Painted Grey Ware	Noh, Jodhpura
NBPW	Northern Black Polished Ware	Noh, Rairh - the early historic layer

Site to excavator to year - the most-asked table in the chapter

Site	Excavator	Year(s)
Bairath	Daya Ram Sahnii	1936-37
Rairh	K.N. Puri	1938-39
Rang Mahal	Hanna Rydh (Swedish expedition)	1952-54
Bhinmal	R.C. Agrawal	1953-54

Site	Excavator	Year(s)
Ahar	R.C. Agrawal & H.D. Sankalia	1961-62
Kalibangan	B.B. Lal & B.K. Thapar	1961-69
Tilwara	V.N. Misra	1967-68
Bagor	V.N. Misra	1967-70
Balathal	V.N. Misra	from 1993
Ojijana	B.R. Meena	1999-2000
Gilund	B.B. Lal; later V.S. Shinde & G.L. Possehl	-
Ganeshwar	R.C. Agrawal & Vijay Kumar	-

Excavation years in order - RPSC has asked this as an ordering question



YAAD RAKHO

Learn the men, not the sites, and half the matching solves itself. V.N. Misra owns three - Bagor, Tilwara, Balathal. R.C. Agrawal owns three - Ahar, Ganeshwar, Bhinmal. B.B. Lal owns two - Kalibangan and the first dig at Gilund.

CURRENT LINK

Current link, as of September 2026 - every site in this chapter that is centrally protected falls under the Archaeological Survey of India's Jaipur Circle, which is also the circle that dug Ojijana under B.R. Meena in 1999-2000 and which runs the Kalibangan site museum opened in 1983. If a question asks who protects or excavates these mounds, the answer is the ASI, not the state department of archaeology.

REVISION RECAP

1. Ladder order: Didwana - Bagor - Ahar - Kalibangan - Sunari.
2. Ahar = Tambavati = copper; Udaipur; Ayad-Berach; also Aghatpur / Aghatdurg.
3. Ahar culture = Banas culture, c. 2800-1500 BCE, Black-and-Red Ware with white designs, almost no microliths.
4. Balathal - Udaipur, V.N. Misra from 1993, fortified enclosure, oldest leprosy skeleton in India.
5. Ojiyana - Bhilwara, B.R. Meena, 1999-2000, painted bull and cow figurines.
6. Gilund - Rajsamand, on the Banas, first dug by B.B. Lal.
7. Ganeshwar - Sikar (Neem ka Thana), Kantli, 2,000+ copper objects, OCP; supplied copper to the Harappans.
8. Jodhpura sits on the Sabi; Kurada (Nagaur) is a copper-hoard site.
9. Bagor - Bhilwara, Kothari, V.N. Misra 1967-70, largest Mesolithic site of India, domestication c. 5000 BCE.
10. Tilwara - Barmer, on the Luni, Mesolithic, V.N. Misra 1967-68.
11. Kalibangan - Hanumangarh, left bank of Ghaggar, B.B. Lal & B.K. Thapar 1961-69, name means black bangles.
12. Kalibangan firsts: earliest ploughed field, seven fire altars, both citadel and lower town fortified, no covered drainage.
13. Kalibangan bricks - Period I 30x20x10 (3:2:1), Period II 30x15x7.5 (4:2:1); earthquake c. 2600 BCE.
14. Bairath - two Ashokan minor rock edicts; Bhabru edict now in the Asiatic Society, Kolkata; Daya Ram Sahni 1936-37.
15. Bijak-ki-Pahadi - India's oldest free-standing circular Buddhist chaitya-griha.
16. Rairh - Tonk, Dheel, K.N. Puri 1938-39, 3,075 punch-marked coins, Tata Nagar of ancient India.
17. Sunari - Jhunjhunu, Kantli, earliest iron-smelting furnaces in Rajasthan; Noh - Bharatpur, four wares, Jakh Baba.
18. Nagari - ancient Madhyamika, Shivi janapada capital; Rang Mahal - Hanna Rydh, Swedish, 1952-54.
19. Wares: OCP - Ganeshwar; BRW - Ahar; PGW - Noh; NBPW - Noh and Rairh.

RH02

Sources of Rajasthan History

One to two questions a paper on average - but RAS Pre 2024 alone took four or five straight from the author-to-work list. Literary works matched to their authors is the single most reliably repeated item in the whole of Rajasthan History.

This is the driest chapter in the syllabus and one of the easiest to score in. Nobody asks you to interpret a source. They ask who wrote what, which inscription sits in which district, which state issued which coin. It is a filing job, not a thinking job.

Sources of Rajasthan History

Inscriptions - ancient

- Barli - oldest
- Ghosundi / Hathibada
- Yupa pillars - Nandsa, Badva
- Bijaygarh - Bhim ki Lat
- Man Mori, Samoli

Inscriptions - medieval

- Harsha 973
- Atpur 977
- Rajor 960
- Bijolia 1170
- Delhi-Topra 1164
- Chirwa 1273

Prashastis

- Ranakpur 1439
- Kumbhalgarh 1460
- Raisingh 1594
- Raj Prashasti 1676 - largest in India

Coins

- Gadhiya - Indo-Sasanian
- Rupak, Dramma - Chauhan
- Jhadshahi - Jaipur
- Vijayshahi - Jodhpur
- Gajshahi - Bikaner

Archival records

- Hakikat Bahi
- Hukumat ri Bahi
- Kamthana Bahi
- Kharita Bahi
- Pattas, Parwanas, Sanads

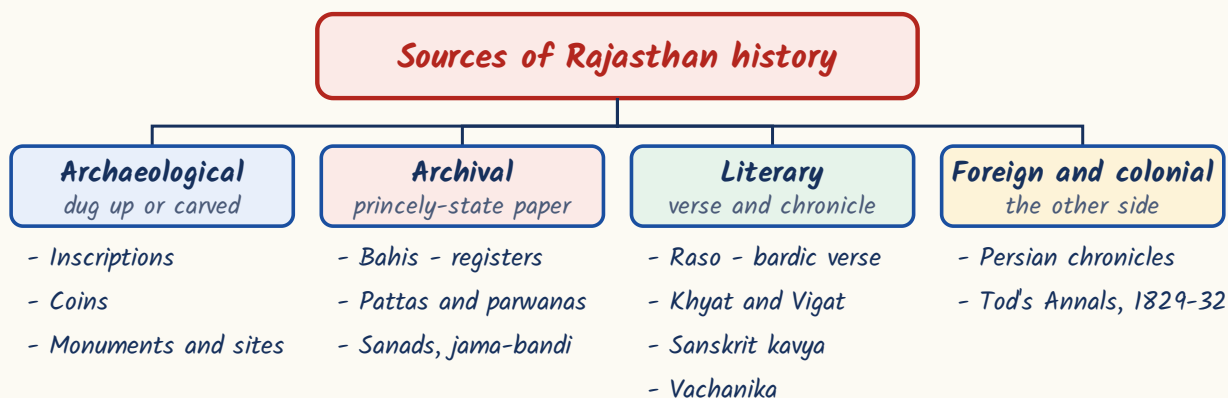
Literary & foreign

- Raso literature
- Khyat - Nainsi
- Sanskrit kavya
- Persian chronicles
- Col. James Tod

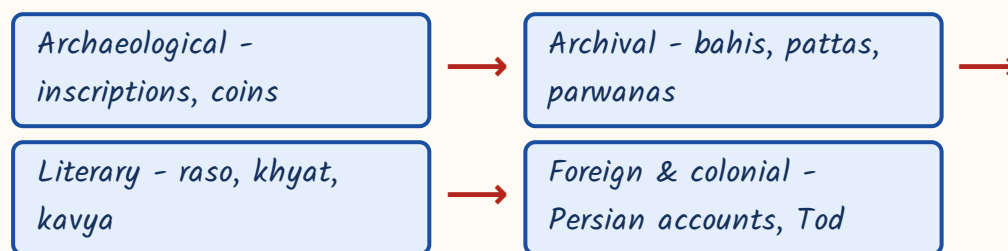
Three baskets - file every source before you memorise it

There are only three kinds of source, and every name in this chapter drops into one of them. Archaeological - things dug up or carved in stone and metal: inscriptions and coins. Archival - the paper record of the princely states: bahis, pattas, parwanas. Literary - what people wrote as literature or history: raso, khyat, vachanika, Persian chronicles, colonial and modern histories. Do the filing first. Then a question that looks unfamiliar still gets you a 50-50 guess.

File every name before you learn it



How a source question is built



- Inscriptions are the most reliable class - dated, contemporary, and hard to tamper with.
- Coins tell you political extent, titles and economy - which is why the state-to-coin list is asked.
- Bahis are administrative, not literary - they record what actually happened day to day.
- Khyats are bardic prose histories - useful, but partisan towards the patron house.
- Persian chronicles give the other side of every battle Rajasthan lost.

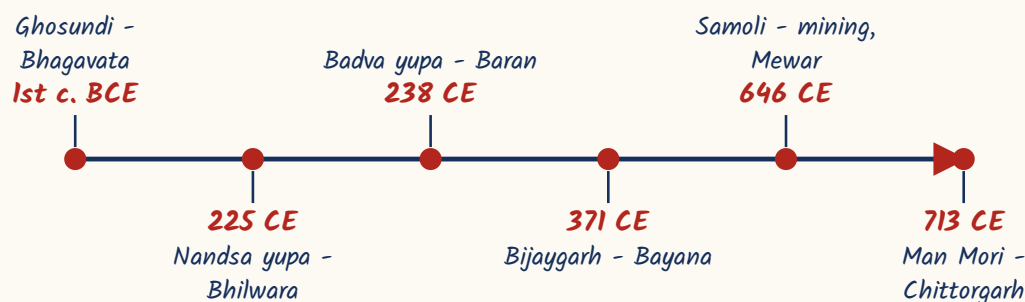
TRAP

Do not confuse a prashasti with a khyat. A prashasti is a praise-inscription on stone, contemporary and dated. A khyat is a prose chronicle written on paper, often long after the event. RPSC has framed options that mix the two categories.

Ancient inscriptions - Barli to the yupa pillars

Start with the oldest and work forward. The one fact everybody must know: the Barli inscription of Ajmer district is Rajasthan's oldest inscription. It is in Brahmi script, in Prakrit, and it refers to Lord Vira, that is Mahavira. G.H. Ojha brought it to light in 1912 and it is kept in the museum at Ajmer.

The ancient inscriptions in date order



The ancient set - place, date, what it tells you

Inscription	District	Date	What it establishes
Barli	Ajmer	Earliest in Rajasthan	Brahmi, Prakrit, refers to Lord Vira (Mahavira)
Ghosundi / Hathibada	Chittorgarh (near Nagari)	1st century BCE	Earliest evidence of Bhagavata worship of Sankarshana and Vasudeva; king Sarvatata's Ashvamedha
Nandsa yupa	Bhilwara	225 CE	Sacrificial pillar - Vedic yajna tradition
Badva yupa	Baran	238 CE	Sacrifice by three Maukhari brothers
Bijaygarh pillar (Bhim ki Lat)	Bayana	VS 428 = 371 CE	Varika ruler Vishnuvardhana's Pundarika yajna
Samoli	Udaipur	646 CE	Shiladitya - earliest evidence of mining in Mewar
Man Mori	Chittorgarh	713 CE	Maurya rulers of Chittor; found by Col. Tod, lost at sea
Mandore / Ghatiyala	Jodhpur	837 / 861 CE	Pratiharas of Mandore; Ghatiyala is of Kakkuka

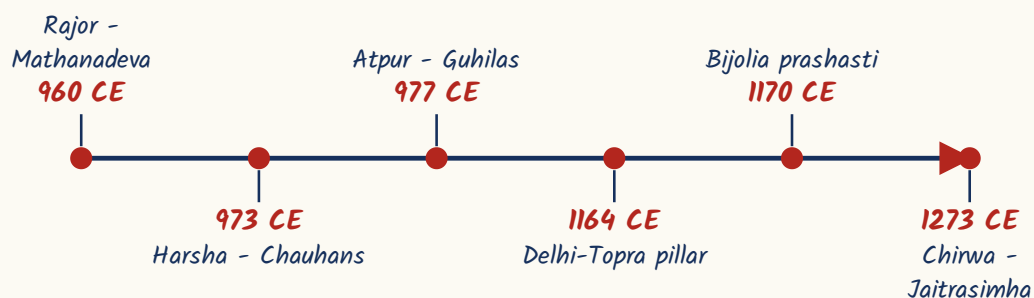
The yupa group - remember them as a set

- Yupa means a sacrificial post; these pillars record Vedic sacrifices, so they prove Brahmanical ritual in 3rd-century Rajasthan.
- Nandsa (Bhilwara) 225 CE - Barnala 227 CE - Badva (Baran) 238 CE - Bichpuria/Uniara (Tonk) 274 CE.
- Badva is the Maukhari one; three brothers performed the sacrifice.
- Nagda or Aparajita inscription, 661 CE, sits between Samoli and Man Mori in the Mewar sequence.
- The Man Mori inscription was carried off towards England and lost at sea - that romantic detail is itself asked.

Medieval inscriptions and the great prashastis

From the 10th century, inscriptions get longer and start giving full genealogies. That is what makes them the backbone of dynastic history. For each one, learn three things only - the year, the dynasty it belongs to, and the one claim it makes.

The medieval inscriptions in date order



The medieval set

Inscription	Year	Dynasty / ruler	The claim it makes
Rajor (Rajorgarh, Alwar)	960 CE	Mathanadeva, Pratihara feudatory	The only record that actually uses the term Gurjara-Pratihara

Inscription	Year	Dynasty / ruler	The claim it makes
Harsha (Harshnath), Sikar	973 CE	Chauhans of Shakambhari	Earliest surviving Chauhan record; genealogy plus the Shiva temple on Harshagiri
Atpur (Ahar), Udaipur	977 CE	Guhilas, Shaktikumar	Genealogy of the Guhilas from Guhadatta
Delhi-Shivalik (Delhi-Topra) pillar	1164 CE	Chauhan Vigraharaja IV	Conquest claimed from the Himalaya to the Vindhyas
Bijolia, Bhilwara	1170 CE	Someshvara's reign, Chauhans	Chauhans of Sambhar and Ajmer called Vatsa-gotra Brahmins; Ajayaraja founded Ajmer
Chirwa, Udaipur	1273 CE	Guhilas - Jaitrasimha, Tejasimha, Samarasimha	Composed by Ratnaprabha Suri
Ranakpur	1439 CE	Rana Kumbha's line	Traces Mewar from Bappa Rawal; Dharanashah built the Chaumukha Adinatha temple
Kumbhalgarh (five slabs)	1460 CE	Rana Kumbha	Composed by Kavi Mahesh
Raisingh Prashasti, Junagarh fort, Bikaner	1594 CE	Bikaner Rathores	Composed by the Jain sage Jaita
Raj Prashasti, Rajsamand	1676 CE	Maharana Raj Singh	25 black-stone slabs - the largest stone inscription in India

- Raj Prashasti was composed by Ranchhod Bhatt Tailang - and 25 slabs and largest in India are both asked.
- The Kirti Stambha Prashasti of Chittorgarh was written by Atri and his son Mahesh - the same Mahesh who did Kumbhalgarh.
- Bijolia gives you two separate facts for two separate chapters - Chauhan origin as Brahmins, and Ajayaraja as founder of Ajmer.
- Delhi-Topra 1164 and Bijolia 1170 sit six years apart - useful for an ordering question.

Coins - two layers, and only two

Coins in Rajasthan come in two layers. An ancient and early-medieval layer, and a princely-state layer of silver rupees named after the ruler who first struck them. The princely layer is where the marks are, because it is perfect matching material.

- Gadhiya coins - Indo-Sasanian type, circulated in western Rajasthan.
- Rupak and Dramma - the Chauhan-period coinage.
- Punch-marked Karshapanas - the oldest layer; 3,075 of them came out of Rairh in Tonk.
- Princely-state silver is named after a ruler - so the name itself tells you the state if you have learnt the list.

Coin to princely state - learn this as one block

Coin	State
Jhadshahi	Jaipur
Vijayshahi, Bhimshahi	Jodhpur
Gajshahi	Bikaner
Akhaishahi, Muhammadshahi	Jaisalmer
Swaroopshahi, Chandori	Mewar (Udaipur)
Gumanshahi	Kota
Ramshahi, Katarshahi	Bundi
Salimshahi	Pratapgarh

The archives - bahis, pattas and parwanas

Every princely state kept registers. A bahi is a register, and the whole body of them is called the Bahiyat. The examiner's whole interest is which bahi recorded what, so learn the four names below by their subject, not by their sound. All of this material is now in the Rajasthan State Archives at Bikaner - that is the standard one-liner answer to where are the records kept.

Bahi to subject

Record	What it contains
Hakikat Bahi	The daily routine of the ruler
Hukumat ri Bahi	Royal orders
Kamthana Bahi	Construction and building works
Kharita Bahi	Correspondence

- Pattas are grants of land or revenue; parwanas are orders; sanads are charters.
- Khatoot and jama-bandi papers of the former states complete the archival set.
- The Rajasthan State Archives, Bikaner is the principal repository of princely-state records.
- The museum at Ajmer, opened in 1908, holds the Barli inscription.

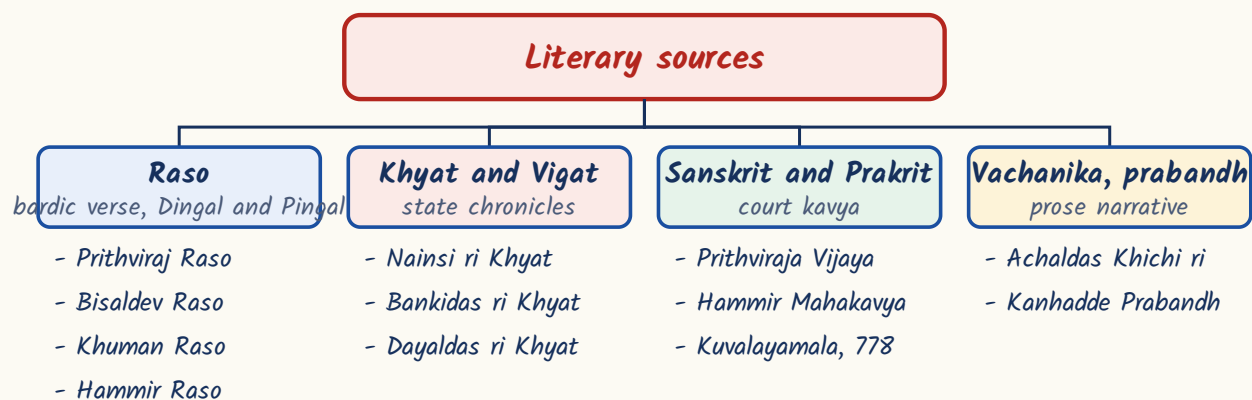
TRAP

Hukumat ri Bahi is royal orders, not land revenue settlement. That exact wrong pairing has been used as a NOT-correctly-matched option. Kamthana is construction - think karm, work.

Literary sources - the list that RPSC actually asks

This is the money section. Author-to-work matching has appeared in every recent paper and RAS Pre 2024 built four separate questions out of it. Do not read this section - drill it. Cover the right column and say the author. Then cover the left column and say the work.

Literary sources by genre



Raso literature - bardic verse in Dingal and Pingal

Raso works and their authors

Work	Author	Subject
Prithviraj Raso	Chand Bardai	Prithviraja III; written in Pingal
Bisaldev Raso	Narpati Nalha	Vigraharaja IV, that is Visaladeva
Khuman Raso	Dalpat Vijay	The Guhilas of Mewar
Hammir Raso	Sarangdhar	Hammir Dev of Ranthambore

Sanskrit, vachanika, khyat and the modern histories

Everything else, by author

Work	Author	Note
Hammir Mahakavya	Nayanchandra Suri	Sanskrit, on Hammir Dev of Ranthambore
Prithviraja Vijaya	Jayanaka	Sanskrit, on Prithviraja III

Work	Author	Note
Kuvalayamala	Uddyotana Suri	Prakrit, 778 CE, composed at Jalore (Jabalipura)
Achaldas Khichi ri Vachanika	Shivdas Gadan	Achaldas Khichi of Gagron vs Hoshang Shah of Malwa
Kanhadde Prabandh	Padmanabh, 1455	Kanhadadeva of Jalore vs Alauddin Khalji
Veli Krishan Rukmani Ri	Prithviraj Rathore	Dingal poetry
Nainsi ri Khyat, Marwar ra Pargana ri Vigat	Muhnnot Nainsi	Vigat is regarded as the first gazetteer of Rajasthan
Vansh Bhaskar	Suryamal Mishran	Dingal; largely on Bundi
Veer Vinod	Kaviraj Shyamaldas	The official history of Mewar
Rajputane ka Itihas	Gaurishankar Hirachand Ojha	The modern standard history

- Other khyats: Bankidas ri Khyat (Marwar), Dayaldas ri Khyat (Bikaner), Mundiyyar ri Khyat and Bhaton ri Khyat (Jaisalmer).
- Muhnnot Nainsi (1610-70) was Diwan of Maharaja Jaswant Singh I of Jodhpur.
- G.H. Ojha called Nainsi the Abul Fazl of Rajputana - a favourite one-liner.
- Kuvalayamala matters beyond history - it records the languages and society of 8th-century Rajasthan.

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2024 - Hammir Mahakavya was composed by whom?

Answer: Nayanachandra Suri. Do not slip into Sarangdhar, who wrote Hammir Raso.

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2024 - Kuvalayamala, composed in 778 CE at Jalore, is the work of? Answer: Uddyotana Suri.

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2024 as a match question - Prithviraj Raso to Chand Bardai, Bisaldev Raso to Narpati Nalha, Khuman Raso to Dalpat Vijay, Hammir Raso to Sarangdhar. The same four have been recycled for years.

YAAD RAKHO

Two Hammir works, two different authors. Hammir Mahakavya = Nayanchandra Suri (Sanskrit, maha = the big Sanskrit one). Hammir Raso = Sarangdhar. And two Suris - Nayanchandra for Hammir, Uddyotana for Kuvalayamala.

Persian accounts, Colonel Tod, and the modern historians

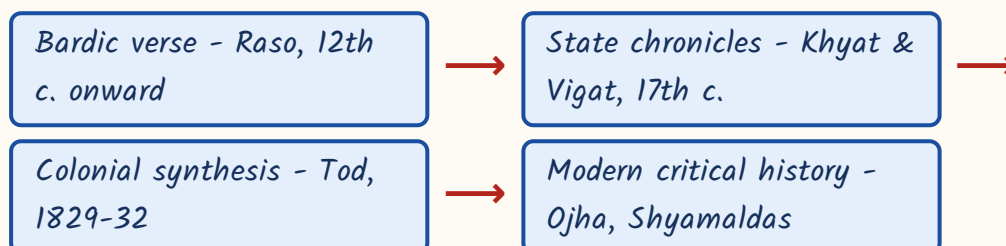
Rajasthan's own sources are court-centred and flattering. The Persian chronicles of Delhi and the Mughals give you the other side - dates of campaigns, the size of armies, what actually happened at a siege. Then in the 19th century a British political agent turned all of it into a single narrative, and modern Indian historians corrected him.

- *Tabaqat-i-Nasiri* - Minhaj-us-Siraj.
- *Tarikh-i-Firozshahi* - Ziauddin Barani.
- *Akbarnama* and *Ain-i-Akbari* - Abul Fazl.
- *Tuzuk-i-Jahangiri* - Jahangir himself.
- *Padshahnama* - Abdul Hamid Lahori.
- Col. James Tod was Political Agent to the Western Rajput States from 1818; his guru was the Jain yati Gyanchandra.
- *Annals and Antiquities of Rajasthan*, London, 1829-32; *Travels in Western India* appeared posthumously.
- Tod is called the father of Rajasthan's history and was known locally as Ghode wale Baba.

Nainsi vs Tod - the two men who built the record

Muhnnot Nainsi (1610-70)	Col. James Tod (from 1818)
Diwan of Jaswant Singh I of Jodhpur	British Political Agent, Western Rajput States
Nainsi ri Khyat; Marwar ra Pargana ri Vigat	<i>Annals and Antiquities of Rajasthan</i> (1829-32)
Wrote in Rajasthani, from state records	Wrote in English, from bardic tradition and his yati guru
Called the Abul Fazl of Rajputana	Called the father of Rajasthan's history; Ghode wale Baba

How Rajasthan's history got written - the four stages



ASKED IN RAS

Repeatedly asked in one form or another - who is called the father of the history of Rajasthan? Answer: Colonel James Tod. And who is the Abul Fazl of Rajputana? Answer: Muhnot Nainsi. RPSC likes putting both names in the same option set.

CURRENT LINK

Current link, as of September 2026 - the Rajasthan State Archives at Bikaner remains the state's principal repository of princely-state records, and the Government Museum at Ajmer, opened in 1908 in Akbar's Daulat Khana, still holds the Barli inscription. Whenever a Rajasthan museum or archive item appears in current affairs, it is usually one of these two; the static answer to where it kept has not changed.

CURRENT LINK

Current link, as of September 2026 - alongside the Bikaner archives, the Rajasthan Oriental Research Institute at Jodhpur remains the state's principal manuscript repository, and its collections are the ones that appear whenever manuscript conservation or digitisation is in the news. The exam answer stays split three ways: princely-state records at the Rajasthan State Archives, Bikaner; manuscripts at the Rajasthan Oriental Research Institute, Jodhpur; the Barli inscription at the Government Museum, Ajmer.

REVISION RECAP

1. Barli (Ajmer) - Rajasthan's oldest inscription; Brahmi, Prakrit, refers to Lord Vira; G.H. Ojha, 1912.
2. Ghosundi / Hathibada (Chittorgarh) - earliest Bhagavata worship of Sankarshana and Vasudeva; king Sarvatata.
3. Yupa pillars: Nandsa 225, Barnala 227, Badva 238 (three Maukhari brothers), Bichpuria 274 CE.

4. Bijaygarh Bayana - Bhim ki Lat - VS 428 = 371 CE, Varika Vishnuvardhana's Pundarika yajna.
5. Samoli 646 CE - earliest mining evidence in Mewar; Man Mori 713 CE - found by Tod, lost at sea.
6. Rajor 960 CE - the only inscription that uses the term Gurjara-Pratihara; Mathanadeva.
7. Harsha 973 CE (Sikar) - earliest Chauhan record; Atpur 977 CE - Guhila genealogy from Guhadatta.
8. Delhi-Topra 1164 - Vigraharaja IV; Bijolia 1170 - Chauhans as Vatsa-gotra Brahmins, Ajayaraja founded Ajmer.
9. Chirwa 1273 - Guhilas, by Ratnaprabha Suri; Ranakpur 1439 - Mewar from Bappa Rawal, Dharanashah.
10. Kumbhalgarh 1460 - Kavi Mahesh; Kirti Stambha Prashasti - Atri and his son Mahesh.
11. Raisingh Prashasti 1594 - Junagarh fort, Bikaner, by the Jain sage Jaita.
12. Raj Prashasti 1676 - Rajsamand, 25 black slabs, Ranchhod Bhatt Tailang, largest stone inscription in India.
13. Coins: Gadhiya - Indo-Sasanian west; Rupak and Dramma - Chauhan; 3,075 punch-marked coins at Rairh.
14. Jhadshahi-Jaipur, Vijayshahi-Jodhpur, Gajshahi-Bikaner, Akhaishahi-Jaisalmer, Swaroopshahi-Mewar, Gumanshahi-Kota.
15. Bahis: Hakikat - ruler's daily routine; Hukumat - orders; Kamthana - construction; Kharita - correspondence.
16. Rajasthan State Archives = Bikaner. Barli inscription = Ajmer museum, 1908.
17. Raso quartet: Prithviraj-Chand Bardai, Bisaldev-Narpati Nalha, Khuman-Dalpat Vijay, Hammir-Sarangdhar.
18. Nainsi - Diwan of Jaswant Singh I; Vigat = first gazetteer of Rajasthan; Abul Fazl of Rajputana.
19. Tod - Political Agent from 1818, Annals and Antiquities 1829-32, father of Rajasthan's history, Ghode wale Baba.

RH03

Early Dynasties of Rajasthan

About 2-3 questions a paper. The Pratiharas and the Ajmer Chauhans are near-certain; the small dynasties - Varika, Mauryas of Chittor, Shivi, Malava - have been asked as one-liners more than once, so do not skip them.

This is the chapter that explains where the Rajput states came from. Tribes and janapadas first, then the Gurjara-Pratiharas as Rajasthan's one imperial power, then the Chauhans of Ajmer who lost at Tarain, and the Guhilas and Paramaras who survived into the medieval period. RPSC mines it for ruler-to-title, ruler-to-work and dynasty-to-capital matching.

Early Dynasties of Rajasthan

Janapadas & republics

- Shivi - Madhyamika/Nagari
- Malava - Nagar, Tonk
- Yaudheyas - Brahmanyadeva
- Arjunayanas
- Rajanyas - Noh
- Nagas of the east

Gurjara-Pratiharas

- Nagabhata I
- Vatsaraja
- Nagabhata II - Kannauj
- Mihir Bhoj - Adivaraha
- Mahendrapala I
- Osian temples

Chauhans of

Shakambhari-Ajmer

- Vasudeva
- Simharaja
- Ajayaraja II - Ajmer
- Arnoraja - Ana Sagar
- Vigraharaja IV
- Prithviraja III - Tarain

Chauhan branches

- Ranthambore - Hammir
- Jalore - Kanhadadeva
- Nadol - Lakshmana
- Sirohi - Deora
- Bundi-Kota - Hada

Guhilas of Mewar

- Guhadatta
- Nagda
- Bappa Rawal
- Atpur inscription 977
- Rawal and Rana lines

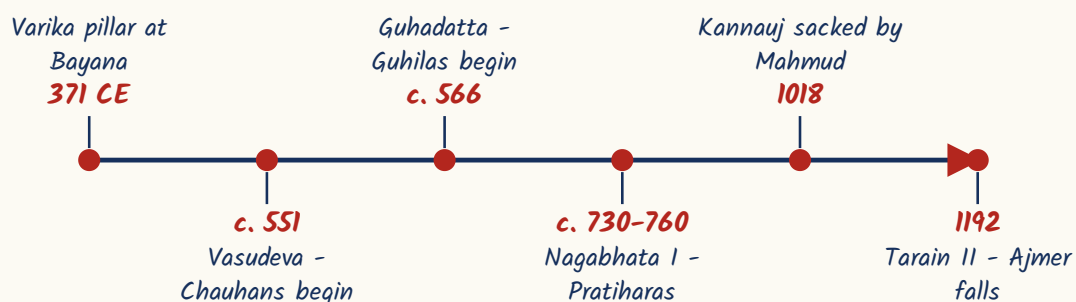
Paramaras & others

- Abu - Chandravati
- Vagad - Arthuna
- Dilwara temples
- Solankis at Kiradu
- Mauryas of Chittor
- Hunas

Before the Rajputs - janapadas, tribal republics and the Nagas

Before dynasties there were tribes, and they left coins. That is the whole point of this section - almost every question here is really a coin-legend question. Learn the legend and the find-spot and you are done.

The dynasties in one line of time



- Shivi or Shibi janapada - capital Madhyamika, which is modern Nagari in Chittorgarh.
- Shivi coins carry the legend Majhamikaya Shibijanapadasa.
- Malava coins read Malavanam Jaya and were found in thousands at Nagar or Karkotanagar in Tonk.
- Yaudheya coins carry Brahmanyadeva, that is Kartikeya.
- Arjunayanas occupied the Bharatpur-Alwar tract; the Rajanyas are known from Noh in Bharatpur.
- The Nagas held eastern Rajasthan; the Hunas under Toramana and Mihirakula raided the north-west in the early 6th century.

Tribe or dynasty to its marker

Tribe / dynasty	Place	Marker
Shivi	Madhyamika - Nagari, Chittorgarh	Legend Majhamikaya Shibijanapadasa
Malava	Nagar / Karkotanagar, Tonk	Legend Malavanam Jaya
Yaudheya	North-western tract	Brahmanyadeva - Kartikeya

Tribe / dynasty	Place	Marker
Rajanya	Noh, Bharatpur	Tribal coinage
Arjunayana	Bharatpur-Alwar	Tribal republic

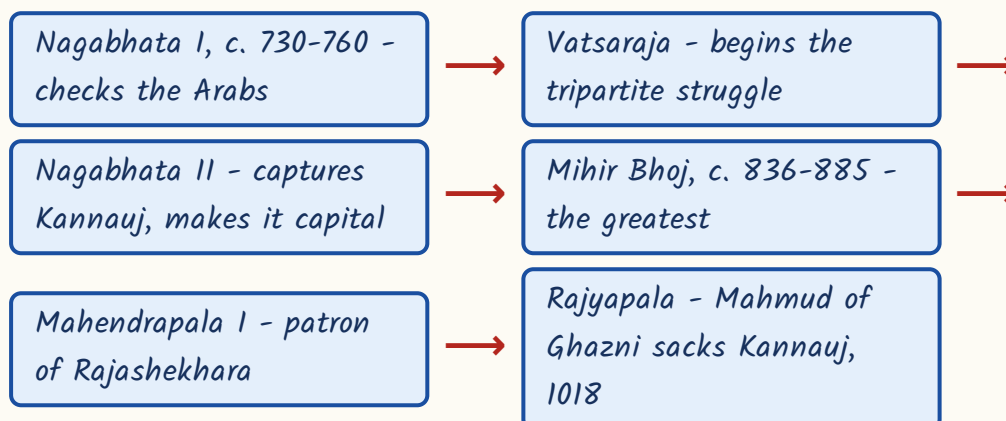
TRAP

Nagari is one place with two identities. As an archaeological mound it is a proto-historic site (RH01). As a political capital it is Madhyamika of the Shivi janapada. The Ghosundi inscription was found nearby. All three facts can be asked about the same dot on the map.

Gurjara-Pratiharas - Rajasthan's one imperial dynasty

The Pratiharas are the only Rajasthan-rooted dynasty that ran a north Indian empire. They start in the Jalore-Bhinmal country in the 8th century, fight the Palas and the Rashtrakutas for Kannauj, win it, and rule from there until Mahmud of Ghazni breaks them in 1018. Learn the sequence of five rulers and their one identifying fact each. That is the whole question set.

Pratihara chronology - learn it in this order



Pratihara ruler to title and identifying fact

Ruler	Title	Identifying fact
Nagabhata I	Nagavaloka	Ruled from Bhinmal / Jalore; checked the Arab advance from Sindh
Vatsaraja	Ranahastin	Opened the tripartite struggle for Kannauj
Nagabhata II	-	Took Kannauj and shifted the capital there
Mihir Bhoj	Adivaraha, on his coins	Gwalior prashasti is his key record
Mahendrapala I	Raghukula-chudamani	Patronised Rajashekhara

- *Rajashekhara wrote Karpuramanjari, Kavyamimamsa, Bala-Ramayana and Bala-Bharata.*
- *The Arab merchant Sulaiman, writing in 851 CE in Silsilat-ut-Tawarikh, called the Pratihara kingdom Juzr.*
- *Sulaiman praised its cavalry and called its ruler the greatest foe of Islam - that ruler was Mihir Bhoj.*
- *The Gwalior inscription praises Nagabhata I as a destroyer of the mlechchhas, that is the Arabs.*
- *Rajyapala did not defeat Mahmud - Kannauj was sacked under him in 1018. That inversion is a standard wrong option.*

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2018 - which Pratihara ruler finally captured Kannauj and made it the capital? Answer: Nagabhata II. Vatsaraja only began the struggle.

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2023 - the Arab merchant who in 851 CE described the Pratihara kingdom as Juzr and its ruler as the greatest foe of Islam? Answer: Sulaiman, in Silsilat-ut-Tawarikh.

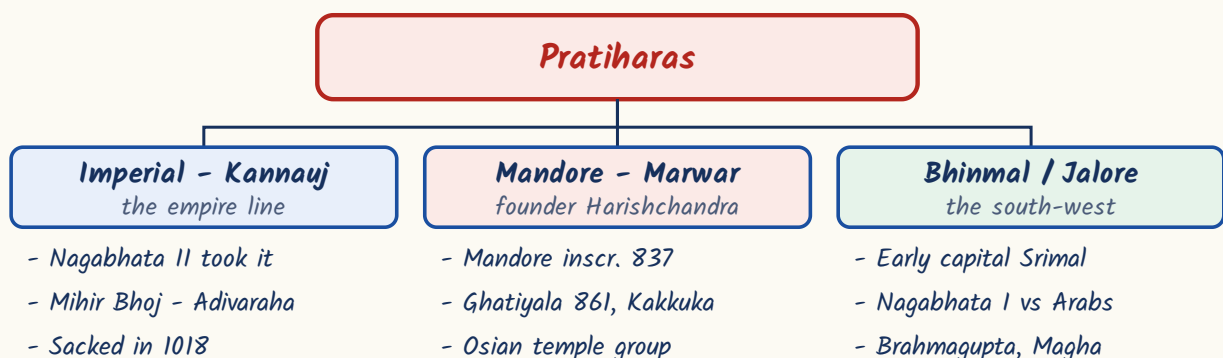
CURRENT LINK

Current link, as of September 2026 - Mihir Bhoj has become a live identity question in north India, with statues and Samrat Mihir Bhoj commemorations in Rajasthan, Uttar Pradesh and Haryana and public disputes over community prefixes. For the exam ignore the politics entirely and hold the three facts: title Adivaraha, capital Kannauj, described as Juzr by Sulaiman.

Pratihara branches and monuments

The Pratiharas were not one line but several. Two branches matter - Mandore in Marwar and Bhinmal-Jalore in the south-west - alongside the imperial line at Kannauj. Their temples are the earliest surviving stone temples in Rajasthan, which is why this section leaks into the architecture chapter.

The Pratiharas were not one line



- Harishchandra is regarded as the founder of the Pratihara line of Mandore.
- The Ghatiyala inscription of 861 CE is of Kakkuka and relates to the Pratiharas of Mandore.
- The Mandore inscription of 837 CE belongs to the same group.
- Osian in Jodhpur district has an 8th-11th century Pratihara temple group, including the Sachiya Mata and Mahavira temples.
- Osian is the traditional origin place of the Oswal Jains.
- Bhinmal, also called Srimal, was an early Pratihara capital.
- Bhinmal is traditionally the birthplace of the astronomer Brahmagupta and of the poet Magha, author of Shishupala Vadha.

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2016 - the group of early temples at Osian, largely Pratihara, is in which district? Answer: Jodhpur.

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2024 - the Rajor inscription of 960 CE records the building of a Shiva temple by whom? Answer: Mathanadeva, a Gurjara-Pratihara feudatory at Rajorgarh in Alwar; the temple was of Lachchhukesvara Mahadeva. This is the only inscription that actually uses the term Gurjara-Pratihara.

The small-print dynasties RPSC keeps returning to

Do not skip this section because the names look obscure. The Varika dynasty has been asked twice - 2013 and 2021 - which tells you RPSC treats obscurity as a virtue. Each of these gets one line, and one line is all you need.

- Varika dynasty of Bayana - Vishnuvardhana raised the Bijaygarh pillar, locally called Bhim ki Lat.
- That pillar is dated VS 428 = 371-72 CE and records a Pundarika yajna; Vishnuvardhana was probably a Gupta feudatory.
- Mauryas of Chittor - Man Mori built the Man Sarovar; the Man Mori inscription is of 713 CE.
- The Kanaswa inscription of 738 CE in Kota, of Dhavala, also records Maurya rule.
- Bappa Rawal is credited with taking Chittor from the Maurya chief Man Mori.
- Rashtrakutas of Hastikundi - modern Hathundi in Pali - were a local branch of that dynasty.
- Solanki or Chalukya rulers of Gujarat such as Kumarapala and Bhima II controlled Abu and Kiradu; the Kiradu temples are in Barmer district.

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2021 - the Bijaygarh pillar inscription of VS 428 records a Pundarika sacrifice by which Varika ruler? Answer: Vishnuvardhana. The same dynasty was asked in 2013 too.

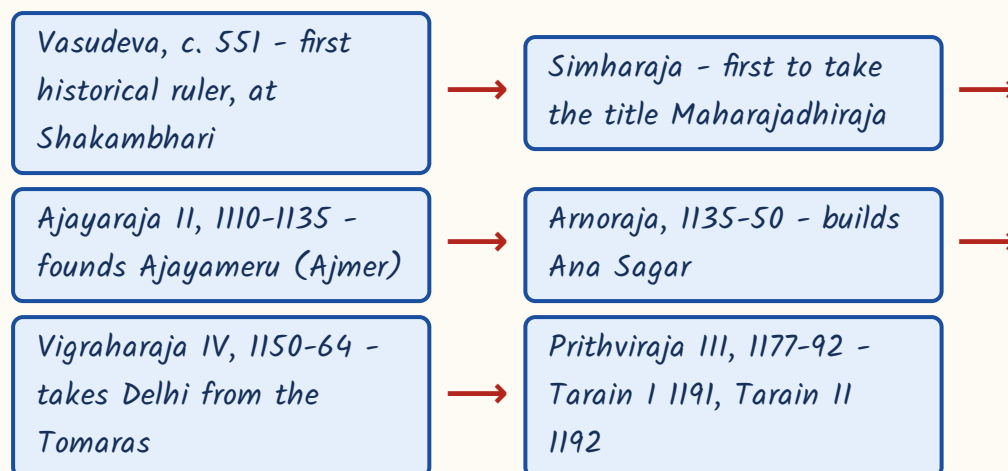
YAAD RAKHO

Bayana carries two separate famous things and they are 1,500 years apart. Bhim ki Lat, the Varika pillar of 371 CE, and the Bayana hoard of Gupta gold coins. If a question says Bayana, check whether it wants the pillar or the coins.

Chauhans of Shakambhari and Ajmer - the main line

The Chauhans, properly Chahamanas, begin at Shakambhari, which is the Sambhar salt-lake country. They shift to Ajmer in the 12th century and end at Tarain. This line gives you rulers who wrote Sanskrit plays and built lakes, and that is exactly the sort of detail RPSC picks.

Chauhan chronology - Sambhar to Tarain



Chauhan ruler to what he is remembered for

Ruler	Remembered for
Vasudeva	First historically attested Chauhan; linked with the Sambhar salt lake
Simharaja	First Chauhan to assume the title Maharajadhiraja
Ajayaraja II	Founded Ajayameru - Ajmer - and shifted the capital; his queen Somaladevi issued coins in her own name
Arnoraja	Built the Ana Sagar lake at Ajmer; defeated Turkish raiders; killed by his son Jagaddeva
Vigraharaja IV (Visaladeva)	Took Delhi from the Tomaras; wrote Harakeli Nataka
Prithviraja III	Beat the Chandela Paramardi in 1182; won Tarain I, lost Tarain II

- The Harsha or Harshnath inscription of 973 CE at Sikar is the earliest surviving record of the Shakambhari Chauhans.
- Vigraharaja IV's court poet Somadeva wrote Lalita-Vigraharaja Nataka in his honour.
- Both plays survive on stone slabs built into the Adhai Din ka Jhonpra at Ajmer.
- Jayanaka wrote Prithviraja Vijaya; Chand Bardai wrote Prithviraj Raso.
- The Bijolia inscription of 1170 says Ajayaraja founded Ajmer and calls the Chauhans Vatsa-gotra Brahmins.

Tarain I vs Tarain II - the one comparison to hold

First Battle of Tarain, 1191	Second Battle of Tarain, 1192
Prithviraja III wins	Muhammad Ghori wins
Ghori is wounded and withdraws	Prithviraja III is defeated and the Chauhan power at Ajmer ends
No change of capital	Opens the way to Turkish rule in north India

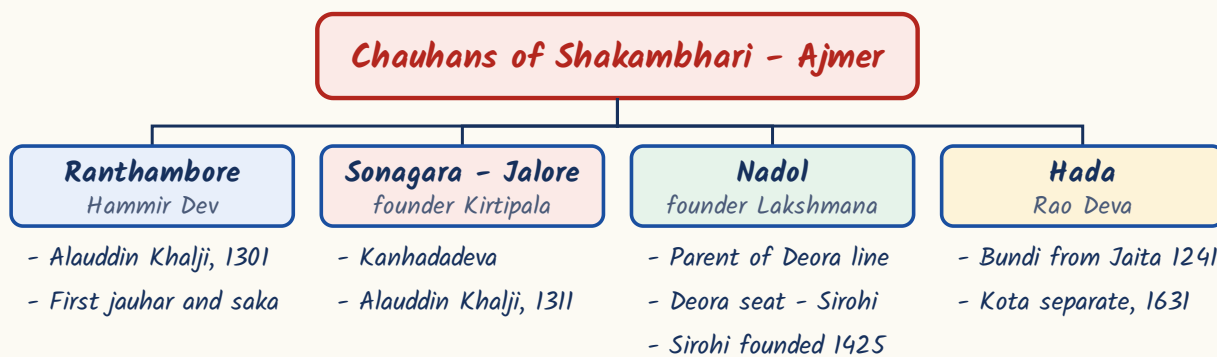
TRAP

Prithviraja III never shifted his capital permanently from Ajmer to Delhi. Delhi was taken by Vigraharaja IV from the Tomaras and held as Chauhan territory; the capital stayed Ajmer. The shifted-to-Delhi statement is a planted false option.

Chauhan branches - who ruled where

After the main line falls, the branches carry on and they are the ancestors of several later princely states. Learn this as a family map: branch name, seat, founder, and the one event attached to it.

The Chauhan branches - the family map



Chauhan branch to seat

Branch	Seat	Founder / key figure	Key event
Main line	Shakambhari, then Ajmer	Vasudeva	Tarain II, 1192
Ranthambore	Ranthambore	Hammir Dev	Defeated by Alauddin Khalji, 1301 - the first jauhar and saka of Rajasthan
Sonagara	Jalore	Kirtipala	Kanhadadeva defeated by Alauddin Khalji, 1311
Nadol	Nadol	Lakshmana, brother of Vakpatiraja I	Parent of the Deora line
Deora	Sirohi	-	Sirohi town founded 1425 by Rao Sahasmal
Hada	Bundi, later Kota	Rao Deva	Took Bundi from Jaita Meena in 1241

- Hammir Mahakavya by Nayanchandra Suri is the source for Ranthambore.
- Kanhadde Prabandh by Padmanabh is the source for Jalore.
- Kota became a separate state under Madho Singh, recognised by Shah Jahan in 1631.
- So Bundi and Kota are both Hada Chauhan - the Hadoti name comes from them.

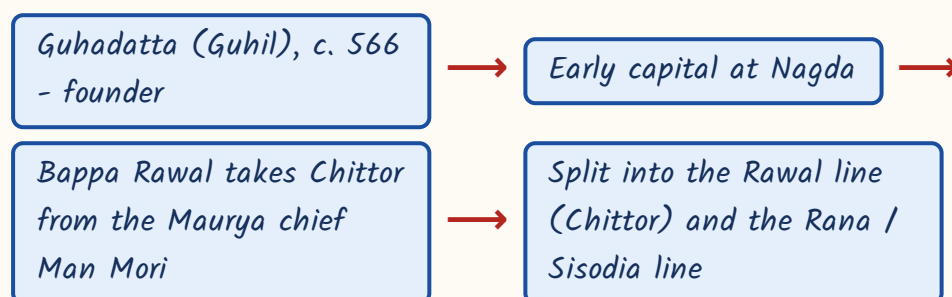
TRAP

Hada Chauhans ruled Bundi and Kota, not Jalore. Jalore is the Sonagara branch. That exact wrong pairing has been used as a NOT-correctly-matched option.

Guhilas of Mewar - the early phase

The Guhilas are the ancestors of the Sisodias, so this section is the doorway into the Mewar chapter. Here you only need the origin story and the inscriptions that prove it. The detailed Mewar history - Ratan Singh, Kumbha, Sanga, Pratap - belongs to the next chapter.

Guhila beginnings



- The Samoli inscription of 646 CE names Shiladitya and gives the earliest evidence of mining in Mewar.
- The Nagda or Aparajita inscription of 661 CE belongs to the same early Guhila group.
- The Atpur or Ahar inscription of 977 CE, of Shaktikumar, gives the Guhila genealogy from Guhadatta.
- The Chirwa inscription of 1273 CE names Jaitrasimha, Tejasimha and Samarasimha; it was composed by Ratnaprabha Suri.
- Bappa Rawal is also called Kalbhoj.

YAAD RAKHO

Two inscriptions, two dynasties, four years apart - and both are genealogies. Harsha 973 CE = Chauhans. Atpur 977 CE = Guhilas. Harsha comes first, alphabetically and chronologically. That pair is match-question bait.

Paramaras, Solankis and the Dilwara temples

Two Paramara branches sat on Rajasthan's south-western and southern edges. Neither was large, but both left buildings, and the buildings are what get asked. The Dilwara temples at Mount Abu are the crossover point between this chapter and the architecture chapter - learn the two main shrines with their builders and dates once, and use them in both.

Dynasty to seat - the early capitals on the map



Pratiharas in the west, Chauhans in the centre and east

- Paramaras of Abu - founder Dhumraj, capital Chandravati.
- Dharavarsha of Abu was a contemporary of Prithviraja III.
- Paramaras of Vagad, that is the Dungarpur-Banswara country, had their capital at Arthuna.
- Vimal Vasahi at Dilwara, 1031 CE, was built by Vimal Shah, minister of Bhima I of Gujarat.
- Luna Vasahi at Dilwara, 1230 CE, was built by the brothers Vastupala and Tejapala.
- Solanki rulers of Gujarat held Abu and Kiradu at various times; Kiradu's temples are in Barmer.

Dynasty to capital - a standing match question

Dynasty	Capital / seat
Paramaras of Abu	Chandravati

Dynasty	Capital / seat
Paramaras of Vagad	Arthuna
Guhilas of Mewar (early)	Nagda
Chauhans of Shakambhari	Sambhar, then Ajmer
Pratiharas (early)	Bhinmal / Jalore
Pratiharas (imperial)	Kannauj
Shivi janapada	Madhyamika (Nagari)

CURRENT LINK

Current link, as of September 2026 - two seats from this chapter are inside the Hill Forts of Rajasthan, inscribed by UNESCO in 2013: Ranthambore, the fort of the Chauhan Hammir Dev, and Chittorgarh, taken by Bappa Rawal from the Maurya chief Man Mori. The other four in that serial inscription are Kumbhalgarh, Amber, Jaisalmer and Gagron. If an option links an early-dynasty seat to UNESCO, these are the only two that qualify.

REVISION RECAP

1. Shivi capital Madhyamika = Nagari, Chittorgarh; coin legend Majhamikaya Shibijanapadasa.
2. Malava coins - Malavanam Jaya - found in thousands at Nagar / Karkotanagar, Tonk.
3. Yaudheya coins carry Brahmanyadeva (Kartikaya); Rajanyas at Noh; Arjunayanas in Bharatpur-Alwar.
4. Pratihara order: Nagabhata I - Vatsaraja - Nagabhata II - Mihir Bhoj - Mahendrapala I - Rajyapala (1018).
5. Nagabhata I stopped the Arabs, title Nagavaloka; Vatsaraja title Ranahastin began the tripartite struggle.
6. Nagabhata II took Kannauj; Mihir Bhoj's title was Adivaraha; Gwalior prashasti is Bhoj's key record.
7. Sulaiman, 851 CE, Silsilat-ut-Tawarikh - kingdom called Juzr, ruler the greatest foe of Islam.
8. Mahendrapala I patronised Rajashekhara - Karpuramanjari, Kavyamimamsa, Bala-Ramayana, Bala-Bharata.

9. Mandore branch founder Harishchandra; Ghatiyala inscription 861 CE of Kakkuka; Osian temples in Jodhpur.
10. Rajor inscription 960 CE - Mathanadeva - the only record using the term Gurjara-Pratihara.
11. Varika Vishnuvardhana - Bijaygarh pillar, Bhim ki Lat, VS 428 = 371-72 CE, Pundarika yajna, Gupta feudatory.
12. Chauhans: Vasudeva first, Simharaja first Maharajadhiraja, Harsha inscription 973 CE the earliest record.
13. Ajayaraja II founded Ajmer; Arnoraja built Ana Sagar; Vighraharaja IV wrote Harakeli Nataka and took Delhi.
14. Somadeva wrote Lalita-Vighraharaja Nataka; both plays survive at Adhai Din ka Jhonpra, Ajmer.
15. Prithviraja III - Paramardi 1182, Tarain I 1191 won, Tarain II 1192 lost; Jayanaka wrote Prithviraja Vijaya.
16. Branches: Ranthambore-Hammir 1301, Jalore-Kanhadadeva 1311 (Sonagara, founder Kirtipala), Nadol-Lakshmana, Sirohi-Deora, Bundi-Hada.
17. Rao Deva took Bundi from Jaita Meena, 1241; Kota separate under Madho Singh, recognised 1631 by Shah Jahan.
18. Guhilas: Guhadatta c. 566, capital Nagda, Bappa Rawal (Kalbhoj) takes Chittor from Man Mori; Atpur 977 CE genealogy.
19. Paramaras of Abu - Chandravati, founder Dhumraj; Paramaras of Vagad - Arthuna.
20. Dilwara: Vimal Vasahi 1031 by Vimal Shah; Luna Vasahi 1230 by Vastupala and Tejapala.

RH04

Mewar: Guhil-Sisodia Dynasty

Rajasthan History gives 14-16 questions a paper, and Mewar is the most reliably tapped house inside it - expect 2-3, usually on Kumbha's works and titles, the three sakas of Chittor, or Haldighati.

Mewar is the richest single chapter in Rajasthan history and RPSC knows it.

The paper never asks you to discuss Mewar's greatness. It asks who built what, who fought whom, and in what order. Kumbha and Pratap alone can carry two questions in one paper.

Mewar (Guhil-Sisodia)

Rawal line

- Guhil c.566 CE, Nagda
- Bappa Rawal = Kalbhaj
- Allat shifts to Ahar
- Jaitrasimha - Chittor capital
- 1303: first saka

Sanga to Udai Singh

- Khanwa 1527
- Second saka 1535
- Panna Dhaj
- Udaipur founded 1559
- Third saka 1568

The Sisodia turn

- Rana Hammir
- Singoli 1336
- Rana Lakha - Jawar mines
- Rana Mokal

Maharana Pratap

- Gogunda 1572
- Haldighati 1576
- Dewair 1582
- Chavand 1585

Maharana Kumbha

- Sarangpur 1437
- Vijay Stambh
- Kumbhalgarh (Mandan)
- Sangeet Raj, Rasik Priya

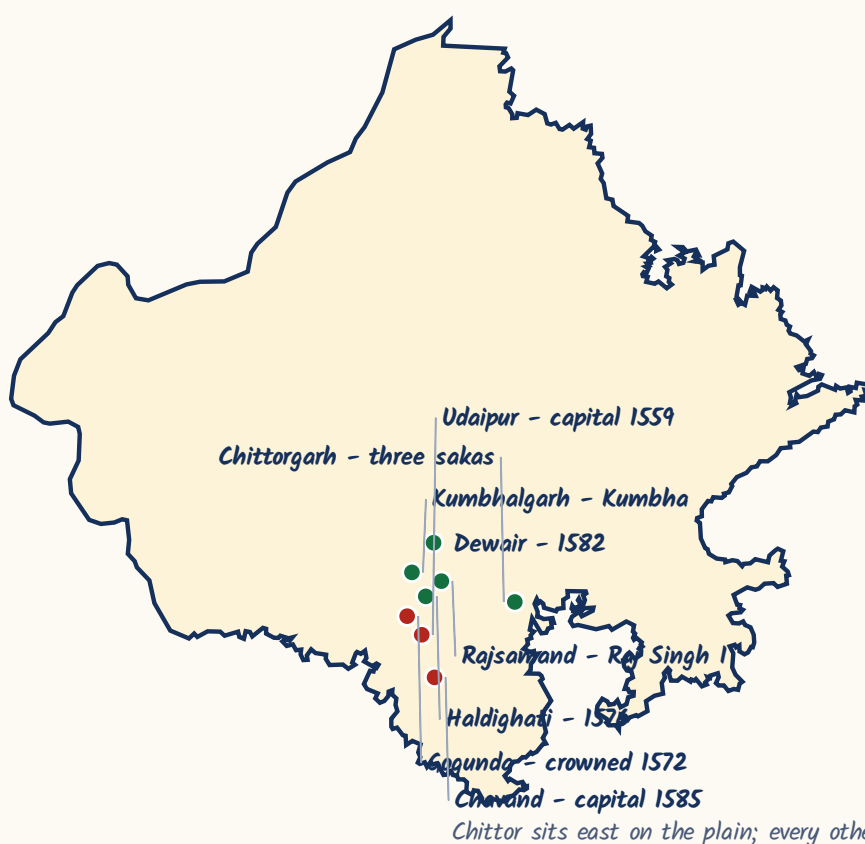
Udaipur Maharanas

- Treaty of 1615
- Rajsamand & Rajprashasti
- Jaisamand
- Fateh Singh, Bhupal Singh

The frame - get this straight before any name

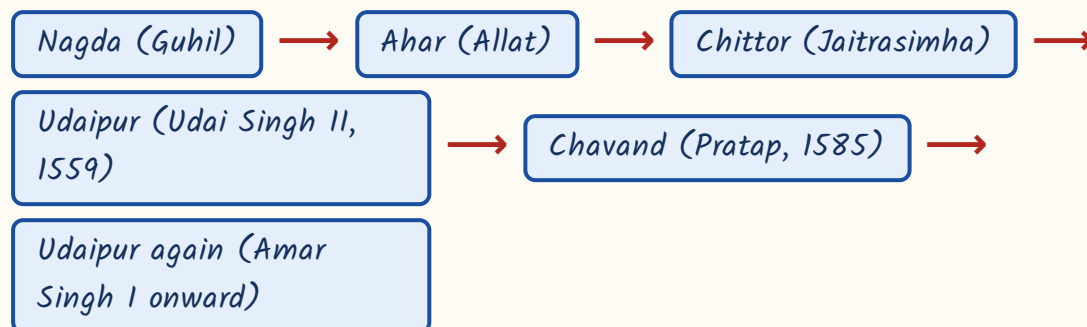
Mewar means southern Rajasthan - the country around Chittorgarh and Udaipur. The ruling house is the Guhil dynasty; from Rana Hammir onwards its ruling branch is called Sisodia. Early rulers are styled Rawal, later ones Rana and then Maharana. And one line RPSC likes: the ruler of Mewar did not claim to rule in his own name. He ruled as the Diwan (deputy) of Eklingji, the family deity. The god is the king; the Maharana is only his manager.

Mewar on the ground - the places of this chapter

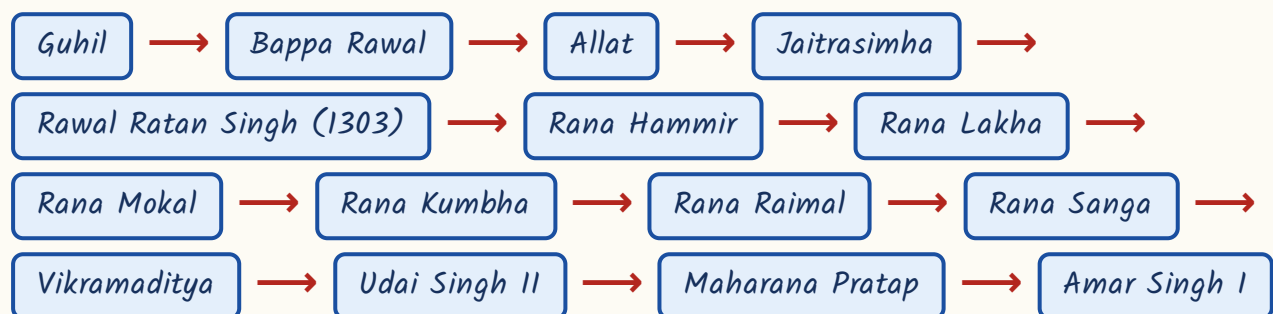


- Guhil (Guhaditya) founded the dynasty c. 566 CE; earliest capital Nagda (Nagahrada), near Udaipur.
- Eklingji at Kailashpuri is the tutelary deity - the Maharanas ruled as 'Diwan of Eklingji'.
- Allat shifted the capital from Nagda to Ahar - hence the 'Aharya' branch of the Guhils.
- Jaitrasimha (1213-1253) repulsed Iltutmish at Nagda and made Chittor the capital - the golden age of the Rawal line.
- Title ladder: Rawal, then Rana, then Maharana. Hammir is the hinge - first 'Rana', first Sisodia.
- Do not mix Nagda (Mewar's first capital) with Nagaur (Marwar, Akbar's 1570 darbar).

Capitals of Mewar in order - a favourite ordering question



The ruler chain you must be able to recite



The Rawal line - Bappa Rawal to the first saka of Chittor

Bappa Rawal is where Mewar's own story really starts. The sources identify him with the name Kalbhoj, and that identification is itself an exam question. He is credited with taking Chittor from the Mori (Maurya) ruler Man Mori around 734 CE. Remember his two titles - they get matched.

- Bappa Rawal = Kalbhoj, c. 734 CE; wrested Chittor from the Mori ruler Man Mori.
- Titles of Bappa Rawal: 'Hindu Suraj' and 'Rajguru'.
- He did NOT shift the capital to Ahar - that was Allat. This exact pairing is planted as a false statement.

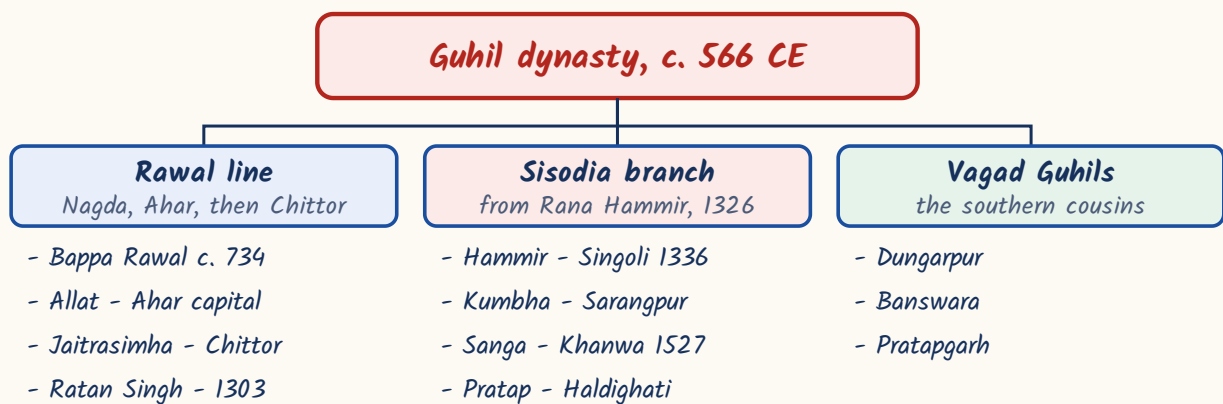
Now the first saka. A saka is the full ritual of last resort - the women perform jauhar, the men ride out in saffron to die. Chittor has three sakas and RPSC asks them as a set, so learn them as a set. And keep Rawal Ratan Singh of 1303 apart from Rana Ratan Singh II, Sanga's son - two different men, two different centuries.

- First saka, 1303 - Alauddin Khilji against Rawal Ratan Singh.
- The jauhar of 1303 is associated with Rani Padmini.
- After the capture Alauddin renamed Chittor 'Khizrabad', after his son Khizr Khan.

Rana Hammir - where Guhil becomes Sisodia

After 1303 Chittor was out of Guhil hands. Hammir got it back. That single recovery is why the dynasty's later branch is named after him, and why his reign is the pivot of the whole chapter.

The Guhil house and its branches



- Rana Hammir (1326-1364) recovered Chittor from Maldeo of Jalore.
- Defeated Muhammad bin Tughlaq at the Battle of SINGOLI, 1336.
- Founder of the SISODIA branch; first Mewar ruler to style himself 'Rana'.
- Title: 'Vishamghati Panchanan'.

- Rana Lakha (1382-1421) - the Jawar zinc-silver mines were discovered in his reign.
- Pichola lake was built in Lakha's reign, by a Banjara - not by a Maharana.
- Rana Mokal was Lakha's son by Hansabai of Marwar - that Marwar tie matters later.

TRAP

Lake-builder pairs are a standing negative question. Pichola belongs to Rana Lakha's reign, NOT to Raj Singh I. Raj Singh built Rajsamand; Jai Singh built Jaisamand.

Maharana Kumbha - learn this section cold

Kumbha (1433-1468) is the highest-yield single ruler in Rajasthan history. He is three things at once - a winning general, a compulsive fort-builder, and a working scholar of music. RPSC has asked his victory, his architect, his titles and his books in separate papers. Treat every proper noun in this section as an answer key.

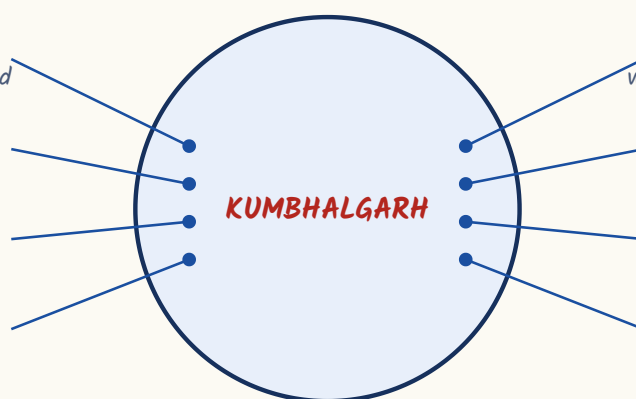
Kumbhalgarh - everything asked about one fort

Built by Rana Kumbha
one of the 32 forts he raised

Wall about 36 km
second-longest in the world

Pratap born here
9 May 1540

Rajsamand district
Aravalli, north of Udaipur



Architect Mandan
who also wrote Prasad Mandan

Badal Mahal
the palace inside the fort

Kumbha killed here
by his son Uda, 1468

UNESCO Hill Fort
one of the six listed in 2013

- Defeated Mahmud Khilji of Malwa at SARANGPUR, 1437.
- Raised the VIJAY STAMBH at Chittorgarh to mark that victory - 9 storeys, about 37 m.
- Built 32 of Mewar's 84 forts.
- KUMBHALGARH - architect MANDAN; its wall runs about 36 km, the second-longest continuous wall in the world.
- Kumbhalgarh also holds the Badal Mahal and is the birthplace of Maharana Pratap.
- Murdered at Kumbhalgarh in 1468 by his own son Uda (Udai Singh I).

Kumbha's titles - straight matching material

Title	Sense
Abhinav Bharatacharya	The new Bharata - master of music and dramaturgy
Hindu Suratrana	Hindu sultan

Title	Sense
Haalguru	Lord of hill forts
Rajguru	Royal preceptor
Danguru	Master of giving
Chhapguru	Master of the chhap

Kumbha's own works

Work	What it is
Sangeet Raj	His major treatise on music
Sangeet Mimansa	Musicological work
Sudprabandh	Musical / literary composition
Kamraj Ratisar	Work on kama-shastra
Rasik Priya	Commentary on Jayadeva's Gita Govinda

Kumbha's court - scholar to work

Scholar	Works
Mandan	Prasad Mandan, Roop Mandan, Rajvallabh, Devata Murti Prakaran
Natha	Vastu Manjari
Govind	Kalanidhi, Dwar Deepika
Kanha Vyas	Ekling Mahatmya
Atri and Mahesh	Kumbhalgarh Prashasti

Vijay Stambh vs Kirti Stambh - the trap RPSC sets every few years

Vijay Stambh	Kirti Stambh
Built by Rana Kumbha, 15th century	12th century, well before Kumbha
Hindu victory tower	JAIN tower, dedicated to Adinatha
Commemorates Sarangpur (1437) over Mahmud Khilji	Built by the merchant Jijaji Rathore
9 storeys, about 37 m	The smaller of the two towers at Chittorgarh

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2013 - the Vijay Stambh commemorates Kumbha's victory over whom? Answer: Mahmud Khilji of Malwa. The same paper asked Rasik Priya (commentary on Gita Govinda) and Sangeet Raj as Kumbha's works. In RAS Pre 2016 the architect of Kumbhalgarh (Mandan) and the title 'Abhinav Bharatacharya' were both asked. Four questions, one ruler.

TRAP

Prasad Mandan, Roop Mandan and Rajvallabh are works of MANDAN the architect, not of Kumbha. 'Which of these is NOT a work of Kumbha' is a real question format - the odd one out will be a Mandan title.

Rana Sanga, and the three sakas of Chittor

Sanga (Sangram Singh I, 1509-1528) is the last Rajput ruler who genuinely tried to build an all-India confederacy. Before Babur he was winning. Learn his four wins, then his one defeat - the exam usually wants the sequence. Saka order by invader is easier still: Khilji, then Gujarat, then Mughal.

- Khatoli, 1517 - against Ibrahim Lodi.
- Bari (Dholpur), 1518 - again against the Lodis.
- Gagron, 1519 - against Mahmud Khilji II of Malwa.
- Bayana, February 1527 - against Babur's advance force.
- KHANWA, 17 March 1527 - defeated by Babur. Sanga died in 1528.

The three sakas of Chittor - learn them as a block

Saka	Year and invader	Mewar side	Remembered for
First	1303, Alauddin Khilji	Rawal Ratan Singh	Jauhar linked to Rani Padmini; fort renamed Khizrabad

Saka	Year and invader	Mewar side	Remembered for
Second	1535, Bahadur Shah of Gujarat	Vikramaditya was Rana	Jauhar led by Rani Karnavati
Third	23 Oct 1567 - 23 Feb 1568, Akbar	Udai Singh II had withdrawn	Jaimal of Merta and Patta (Fatta) of Kelwa fell defending it

- After the second saka Banbir usurped the Mewar throne in 1536.
- Panna Dhai saved the infant Udai Singh II from Banbir by sacrificing her own son Chandan.
- Udai Singh II founded UDAIPUR in 1559 and made it the new capital.
- Akbar set up statues of Jaimal and Patta at the gate of Agra Fort - that detail is itself asked.

Maharana Pratap

Pratap's dates and places are asked more often than the details of his battles. Fix the five places first - born, crowned, fought, won, died - and everything else hangs off them.

- Born 9 May 1540 at Kumbhalgarh.
- Coronation at GOGUNDA in 1572.
- Battle of Haldighati, 18 June 1576.
- Battle of Dewair, 1582.
- Chavand made capital in 1585; died there on 19 January 1597.

Haldighati is misremembered by most students as Pratap versus Akbar. It was not. Akbar was not present. The Mughal army was commanded by a Rajput - Man Singh I of Amber - with Asaf Khan. And Pratap's own army had an Afghan contingent under Hakim Khan Sur. That crossing-over is exactly what the exam tests.

Haldighati, 18 June 1576 - who was actually there

Man Singh I

commanded FOR the Mughals

Akbar

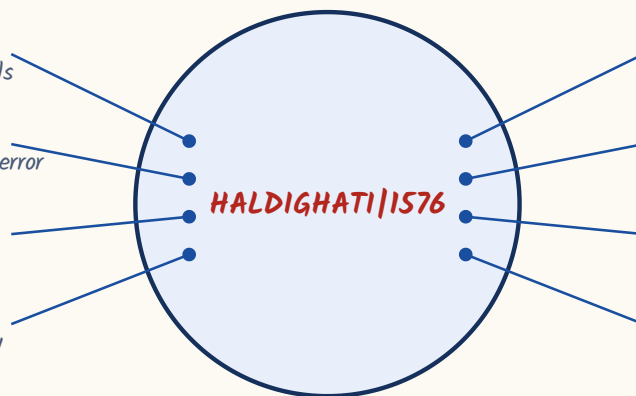
was NOT present - the top error

Jhala Man (Bida)

wore Pratap's insignia

Outcome

indecisive; Pratap gets away



Asaf Khan

with the Mughal force

Hakim Khan Sur

Afghans, on Pratap's side

Chetak

Pratap's horse

Colonel Tod's name

the Thermopylae of Mewar

- Mughal command: Man Singh I of Amber, with Asaf Khan.
 - Hakim Khan Sur led the Afghan contingent on Pratap's side.
 - Jhala Man (Bida) wore Pratap's insignia to draw the enemy and let him escape.
 - Pratap's horse: Chetak.
 - Colonel Tod called Haldighati the 'Thermopylae of Mewar'.
-
- DEWAIR (1582) was the decisive win - Tod called it the 'Marathon of Mewar'.
 - Bhamashah financed the struggle out of his own wealth.
 - Punja Bhil led the Bhils who fought alongside Pratap.
 - After Dewair Pratap recovered most of Mewar - but not Chittor, Ajmer or Mandalgarh.

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2021 - who commanded the Mughal army at Haldighati?

Answer: Man Singh I of Amber. Learn the commander, not the legend.

YAAD RAKHO

Pratap's five places in life-order: Kumbhalgarh (born) - Gogunda (crowned) - Haldighati (fought) - Dewair (won) - Chavand (capital and death). K-G-H-D-C.

TRAP

'Pratap recaptured Chittorgarh after Dewair' is a planted false statement. He never took Chittor back.

CURRENT LINK

Current link (as of August 2026): the Rajasthan government cleared a MAHARANA PRATAP TOURIST CIRCUIT of over Rs 206 crore covering Chavand, Haldighati, Gogunda, Kumbhalgarh, Dewair and Udaipur, alongside a tribal circuit (Beneshwar Dham, Mangarh Dham) in a package of over Rs 306 crore. Useful twice - a current-affairs fact, and Pratap's geography in one line.

After Pratap - the 1615 settlement and the Sagar footnote

Amar Singh I fought on for years and then made terms. Mewar was the last of the big Rajput states to settle with the Mughals, and it settled on unusually soft conditions. The four clauses of the 1615 treaty are asked directly and in the negative form - 'which was NOT a provision'. The commonest wrong option is a marriage clause, and Mewar never had one: it is the one major Rajput state that never gave a daughter to the Mughals.

- Treaty of 1615 - Amar Singh I with Jahangir, negotiated by Prince Khurram (the future Shah Jahan).
 - Clause 1: no matrimonial alliance with the Mughals.
 - Clause 2: the Rana need not attend court in person - Prince Karan Singh went instead.
 - Clause 3: Chittor returned, but never to be repaired or refortified.
 - Clause 4: Mewar to supply 1,500 horse to imperial service.
-
- Sagar, a son of Udai Singh II, went over to the Mughals.
 - Akbar had already invested Sagar with the title of Rana; the Mughals then set him up at Chittor as a rival Rana - the so-called Chittor branch.
 - It was a Mughal counter-claim, not a real dynasty; the arrangement lapsed with the 1615 settlement.

The Udaipur Maharanas - builders, inscriptions and the last act

From Karan Singh onwards Mewar stops being a war story and becomes a building-and-patronage story. That suits RPSC, which loves builder-to-building matching. Take this section as a matching table, not as narrative history.

- Karan Singh built Jagmandir on Lake Pichola and sheltered the rebel Prince Khurram there.
- Jagat Singh I built the Jagdish temple, Udaipur (1651); his reign is the golden age of Mewar painting under Sahibdin.
- Raj Singh I (1652-1680) built RAJSAMAND lake as a famine-relief work.
- The RAJPRASHASTI of Ranchhod Bhatt, on 25 slabs at Nauchowki, is the largest stone inscription in India.
- Raj Singh married Charumati of Kishangarh, installed Shrinathji at Sihad (Nathdwara) in 1672 and opposed Aurangzeb's jaziya.
- Maharana Jai Singh built JAISAMAND (Dhebar) lake.
- Amar Singh II concluded the DEBARI agreement (1708) with Ajit Singh of Marwar and Sawai Jai Singh II of Amber - a joint Rajput front.
- Sangram Singh II built Saheliyon ki Bari, Udaipur.
- Jagat Singh II presided over the HURDA conference, 17 July 1734.
- Bhim Singh signed Mewar's treaty with the British on 13 January 1818.
- Col. James Tod became the first Political Agent in Mewar; the Krishna Kumari episode belongs to Bhim Singh's reign.
- Maharana Fateh Singh refused to attend Lord Curzon's Delhi Durbar of 1903 - the one act of his reign that gets asked.
- Bhupal Singh, the last Maharana, became the first Rajpramukh of the United State of Rajasthan on 18 April 1948.

Builder to building - revise this as a matching set

Structure / lake	Builder or reign
Vijay Stambh and Kumbhalgarh	Rana Kumbha
Kirti Stambh (Jain)	Merchant Jijaji Rathore, 12th century
Pichola lake	Reign of Rana Lakha, built by a Banjara
Udaipur city	Udai Singh II, 1559
Jagmandir	Karan Singh

Structure / lake	Builder or reign
Jagdish temple	Jagat Singh I, 1651
Rajsamand lake and Rajprashasti	Raj Singh I
Jaisamand (Dhebar) lake	Maharana Jai Singh
Saheliyon ki Bari	Sangram Singh II

ASKED IN RAS

RAS Pre 2016 ran a match-the-following of work to author. Mewar supplies two of the standard pairs - Sangeet Raj to Kumbha, Rajprashasti to Ranchhod Bhatt. Keep those two apart from each other and you will not lose the mark.

CURRENT LINK

Current link (as of 2026): Nathdwara in Rajsamand, where Raj Singh I installed Shrinathji in 1672, now also carries the 'Statue of Belief' (Vishwas Swaroopam) - a 369-foot seated figure of Shiva unveiled in 2022 and billed as the tallest Shiva statue in the world. Note how much of this chapter sits in one district: Rajsamand holds Kumbhalgarh, Haldighati, Dewair, the Rajsamand lake with the Rajprashasti, and Nathdwara.

Every Mewar battle on one page

Chronological ordering is a small but permanent slice of the paper - about 3% - and battles are the easiest place to lose that mark. Learn the table by its year column. The drill that works: Singoli 1336, Sarangpur 1437, Khanwa 1527, Haldighati 1576. That is exactly how the ordering question is built.

Mewar's battles - year, sides, outcome

Battle and year	Mewar side	Opponent	Outcome
Singoli, 1336	Rana Hammir	Muhammad bin Tughlaq	Mewar wins; Chittor secured
Sarangpur, 1437	Rana Kumbha	Mahmud Khilji of Malwa	Mewar wins; Vijay Stambh raised
Khatoli, 1517	Rana Sanga	Ibrahim Lodi	Mewar wins
Bari (Dholpur), 1518	Rana Sanga	Lodi forces	Mewar wins
Gagron, 1519	Rana Sanga	Mahmud Khilji II of Malwa	Mewar wins
Bayana, Feb 1527	Rana Sanga	Babur's advance force	Mewar wins
KHANWA, 17 March 1527	Sanga's Rajput confederacy	Babur	Mewar defeated; Mughal power settled
Haldighati, 18 June 1576	Maharana Pratap	Mughals under Man Singh I	Indecisive; Pratap escapes - 'Thermopylae of Mewar'
Dewair, 1582	Maharana Pratap	Mughal garrisons	Decisive Mewar win - 'Marathon of Mewar'

- Pairing errors RPSC plants: Kumbha with Khanwa (that is Sanga), Hammir with Sarangpur (that is Kumbha).
- Only two of these are outright Mewar defeats in the exam's eyes - Khanwa, and the sakas of Chittor.

REVISION RECAP

1. Guhil c.566 CE at Nagda; Allat moved to Ahar; Jaitrasimha made Chittor the capital and stopped Itutmish.
2. Bappa Rawal = Kalbhaj; took Chittor from Man Mori; titles Hindu Suraj and Rajguru.
3. Maharanas ruled as Diwan of Eklingji - the deity is the nominal sovereign.
4. Sakas of Chittor: 1303 Alauddin (Ratan Singh, Padmini, Khizrabad), 1535 Bahadur Shah (Karnavati), 1567-68 Akbar (Jaimal and Patta).

5. Hammir: Singoli 1336 over Muhammad bin Tughlaq; founder of the Sisodia branch; first 'Rana'; Vishamghati Panchanan.
6. Rana Lakha - Jawar zinc-silver mines; Pichola built in his reign.
7. Kumbha: Sarangpur 1437, Vijay Stambh (9 storeys, c.37 m), 32 of 84 forts, Kumbhalgarh by Mandan with a 36-km wall.
8. Kumbha wrote Sangeet Raj, Sangeet Mimansa, Sudprabandh, Kamraj Ratisar, Rasik Priya; killed by his son Uda in 1468.
9. Kirti Stambh is Jain, Adinatha, 12th century, by Jijaji Rathore - keep it away from Kumbha.
10. Sanga won Khatoli 1517, Bari 1518, Gagron 1519, Bayana 1527; lost Khanwa to Babur on 17 March 1527.
11. Panna Dhai gave up her son Chandan to save Uda Singh II from Banbir; Udaipur founded 1559.
12. Pratap: born Kumbhalgarh 1540, crowned Gogunda 1572, Haldighati 1576, Dewair 1582, Chavand 1585, died 1597.
13. Haldighati - Mughal side under Man Singh I; Hakim Khan Sur and Jhala Man on Pratap's side; Chetak; 'Thermopylae of Mewar'.
14. Treaty of 1615 - Amar Singh I and Jahangir via Khurram: no marriage tie, no personal attendance, Chittor back but unrepaired, 1,500 horse.
15. Sagar was the Mughals' rival Rana at Chittor - a counter-claim that died with the 1615 treaty.
16. Raj Singh I: Rajsamand as famine relief, Rajprashasti by Ranchhod Bhatt on 25 slabs, Shrinathji at Nathdwara 1672, opposed jaziya.
17. Jaisamand by Maharana Jai Singh; Debari agreement 1708; Saheliyon ki Bari by Sangram Singh II; Hurda conference 1734.
18. Bhim Singh's British treaty 13 January 1818; Tod first Political Agent in Mewar.
19. Fateh Singh boycotted the 1903 Delhi Durbar; Bhupal Singh became the first Rajpramukh on 18 April 1948.

RH05

Marwar, Dhundhar, Bikaner, Jaisalmer, Hadoti & Other States

The single largest slice of Rajasthan History - expect 3-5 questions a paper. RAS 2024 alone carried three Marwar questions (Rao Siha, Rao Chunda-Mandore, Rao Jodha-1459) and RAS 2023 asked Jaipur's planner.

This is the biggest chapter in the subject, and the one students turn into an undifferentiated blur of Rajput names. Do not read it as one list. Read it house by house. Each house has a founder, a fort, one or two rulers who mattered to the Mughals or the British, and a builder or two - and RPSC asks exactly those four slots.

The princely houses of Rajputana

Marwar (Rathore)

- Rao Siha
- Rao Jodha - Mehrangarh 1459
- Rao Maldeo - Gori Sumel
- Chandrasen
- Jaswant Singh, Durgadas

Hadoti (Hada Chauhan)

- Bundi - Rao Deva 1241
- Rao Surjan - Ranthambore 1569
- Kota split 1631
- Zalim Singh Jhala
- Gagron jal-durg

Dhundhar (Kachhwaha)

- Dulha Rai, Kokil Dev
- Bharmal - Akbar
- Man Singh I
- Mirza Raja Jai Singh I
- Sawai Jai Singh II - Jaipur 1727

Jat and eastern states

- Bharatpur - Suraj Mal, Lohagarh
- Alwar - Pratap Singh Naruka 1775
- Dholpur - Bamrolia Jat
- Karauli - Jadaun
- Tonk - Amir Khan 1817

Desert houses

- Bikaner - Rao Bika 1488
- Rai Singh - Junagarh
- Ganga Singh - Gang Canal
- Jaisalmer - Rawal Jaisal
- Three sakas of Jaisalmer

Southern and smaller houses

- Sirohi - Deora Chauhan
- Dungarpur, Banswara, Pratapgarh - Guhil (Vagad)
- Kishangarh - Bani Thani
- Shekhawati - Rao Shekha

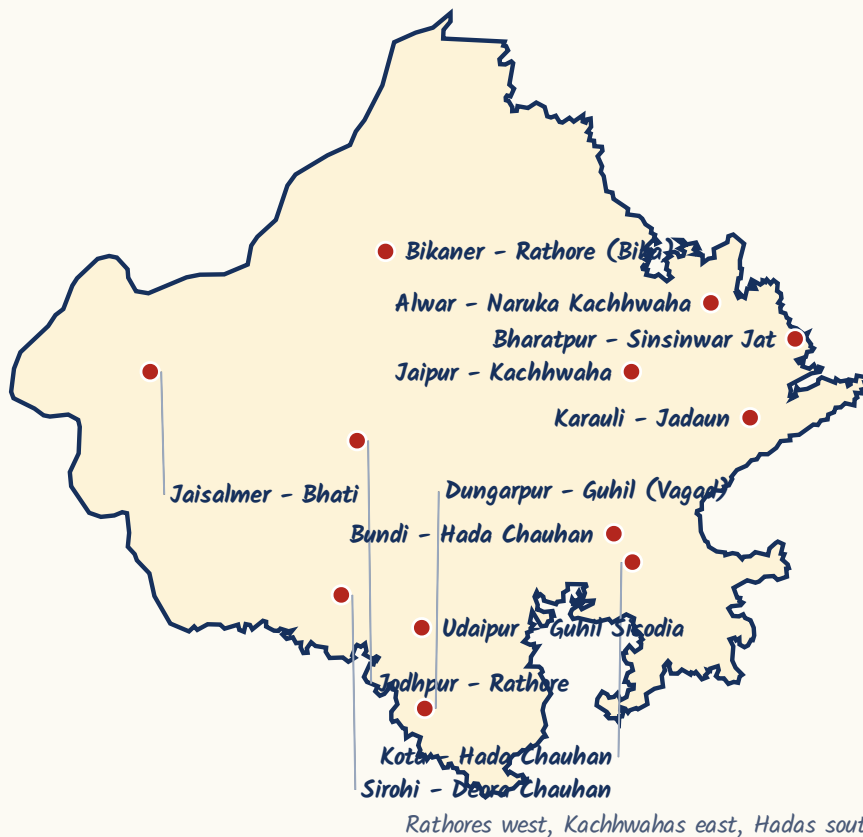
The map of houses – read this before any ruler's name

Before you memorise a single ruler, fix which clan sits where. Half the questions in this chapter are clan-to-state or founder-to-state matching, and if the clan map is clear the matching answers itself. Note the pattern: Rathores in the west, Kachhwahas in the east, Hada Chauhans in the south-east, and Jats and a Pathan house on the Agra side.

Clan to state to seat – the spine of the chapter

House / clan	State	Capital or chief fort
Rathore	Marwar	Mandore, then Jodhpur - Mehrangarh
Rathore (Bika branch)	Bikaner	Bikaner - Junagarh
Kachhwaha	Dhundhar	Amber, then Jaipur
Kachhwaha (Naruka branch)	Alwar	Bala Qila
Bhati	Jaisalmer	Lodrava, then Jaisalmer - Sonar Qila
Hada Chauhan	Bundi and Kota (Hadoti)	Taragarh, Bundi
Deora Chauhan	Sirohi	Sirohi
Guhil (Vagad branch)	Dungarpur, Banswara, Pratapgarh	Dungarpur
Jadaun / Yaduvanshi	Karauli	Karauli
Sinsinwar Jat	Bharatpur	Lohagarh
Bamrolia Jat	Dholpur	Dholpur
Pathan (Amir Khan's line)	Tonk	Tonk

State to capital - where each house actually sat

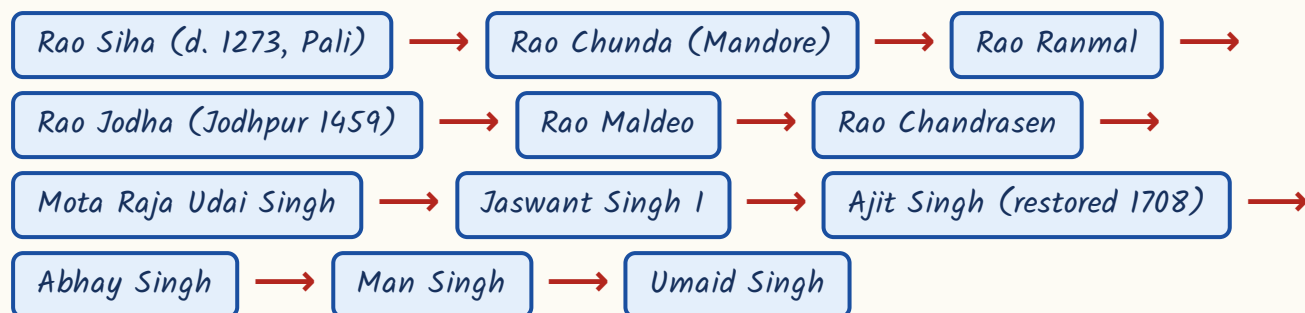


- Kota is Hada Chauhan, not Rathore - this exact swap is used as a wrong pair.
- Karauli is Yaduvanshi (Jadaun); Sirohi is Deora Chauhan; Tonk is the only Muslim princely state of Rajputana.
- Bikaner and Kishangarh are both Rathore offshoots of Jodhpur - founded by sons of Jodhpur rulers.

Marwar - the Rathores of Jodhpur

Marwar is the largest of the states and the one that fought the Mughals longest at the level of ordinary politics. Its story has a clear shape: found a base at Pali, capture Mandore, build Jodhpur, lose to Sher Shah, resist Akbar, then submit, then rebel again under Aurangzeb, and finally be restored in 1708. Hold that arc and the names slot in.

Rathore ruler chain - Marwar



- Rao Siha (d. 1273), around Pali, is the founder of the Rathores of Marwar.
- Rao Chunda obtained MANDORE and made it his capital.
- Rao Ranmal was killed at Chittor in 1438 - the Mewar connection turning sour.
- Rao Jodha founded JODHPUR and laid Mehrangarh's foundation on Chidiyatunk hill, 12 May 1459.
- Mehrangarh's other names: Garh Chintamani and Mayurdhwaj.

- Rao Maldeo (1532-62) - the 'Hashmat Wala Raja' of the Persian chroniclers, the strongest Rajput ruler of his day.
- Defeated by Sher Shah Suri at GIRI SUMEL (Sammel), January 1544.
- His commanders Jaita and Kumpa fell in that battle.
- Sher Shah's famous line after it: 'for a handful of bajra I nearly lost the empire of Hindustan'.

- Rao Chandrasen (1562-81) - the 'Pratap of Marwar', also called the forgotten hero.
 - He walked out of Akbar's NAGAUR darbar (1570) rather than submit.
 - Carried on the fight from BHADRAJUN and SIWANA.
 - Mota Raja Udai Singh (1583-95) was the first Rathore of Marwar to accept Mughal suzerainty.
 - His daughter Jagat Gosain (Jodhabai) married Prince Salim and was the mother of Shah Jahan.
-
- Amar Singh Rathore of Nagaur - 'Katar ka Dhani'; fought the Battle of Matira ri Rad (the Battle of the Watermelon, 1644) against Bikaner.
 - Maharaja Jaswant Singh I (1638-78) fought Aurangzeb at DHARMAT (1658) on Dara Shikoh's side.
 - Jaswant Singh died at Jamrud in 1678 - and his death triggered the Rajput war.
 - His court held MUHNOT NAINSI, author of 'Nainsi ri Khyat' and 'Marwar ra Pargana ri Vigat'.
-
- DURGADAS RATHORE - the 'Redeemer of Marwar'; he shielded the infant Ajit Singh for thirty years against Aurangzeb.
 - Durgadas's chhatri stands at Ujjain, on the Shipra.
 - Ajit Singh was finally recognised as ruler of Marwar in 1708.
 - Khejarli sacrifice, 1730, in Abhay Singh's reign - Amrita Devi Bishnoi and 363 people died protecting khejri trees.
 - The Amrita Devi Bishnoi Wildlife Protection Award is named after her.
-
- Maharaja Man Singh of Jodhpur (1803-43) patronised the NATH sect and built the Mahamandir.
 - The Battle of Gingoli (1807) grew out of the Krishna Kumari dispute.
 - Maharaja Umaid Singh built UMAID BHAWAN palace, begun 1929.

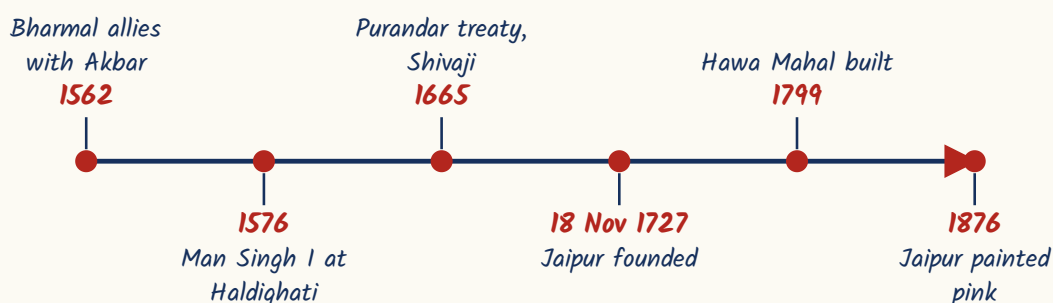
ASKED IN RAS

RAS Pre 2024 mined Marwar three times over - the founder of the Rathore dynasty (Rao Siha), who obtained Mandore and made it the capital (Rao Chunda), and who founded Jodhpur and Mehrangarh in 1459 (Rao Jodha). The same paper ran the negative version: 'which statement about Rao Jodha is NOT correct' - the false one being that he founded Bikaner. Bikaner was his son Bika.

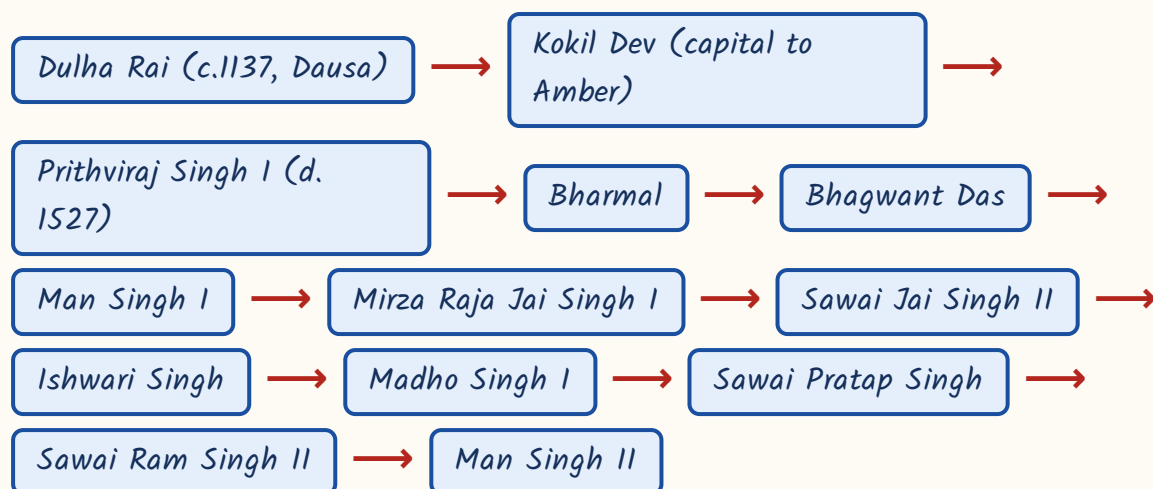
Dhundhar - the Kachhwahas of Amber and Jaipur

Dhundhar took the opposite road from Marwar. Where Marwar resisted and paid for it, Amber allied early and rose inside the Mughal system - the highest Rajput mansab, the governorship of Bengal, the negotiator who brought Shivaji to terms. Then in the eighteenth century it turned scientific and built a planned city. Two very different kinds of fame, both examinable.

Amber to Jaipur - the Kachhwaha rise



Kachhwaha ruler chain - Amber to Jaipur



- Dulha Rai (c. 1137), based at Dausa, founded the Kachhwaha state of Dhundhar.
- Kokil Dev shifted the capital to AMBER.
- Prithviraj Singh I (reigned to 1527) fought beside Rana Sanga at Khanwa.
- The estates settled on Prithviraj's sons and kinsmen became the 'Barah Kotri' - the twelve great chieftainships of the house.
- Raja Bharmal was the first Rajput ruler to ally with Akbar; his daughter Harkha Bai married Akbar in 1562 at Sambhar.
- Bharmal's son Bhagwant Das carried the alliance forward into the next generation.
- Raja MAN SINGH I held the highest mansab of 7,000 under Akbar.
- Governor of Kabul, Bihar and Bengal; commanded the Mughal army at Haldighati, 1576.
- Built the Amber palace and the Govind Dev temple at Vrindavan.
- Brought the SHILA DEVI idol from Bengal and installed it at Amber.

- MIRZA RAJA JAI SINGH I signed the TREATY OF PURANDAR with Shivaji on 11 June 1665.
 - Under it Shivaji surrendered 23 of his 35 forts.
 - His court poet was Bihari, author of the 'Bihari Satsai'.
 - He died at Burhanpur in 1667.
-
- SAWAI JAI SINGH II (1700-43) received the title 'Sawai' from Aurangzeb.
 - Founded JAIPUR on 18 November 1727, to the plan of VIDYADHAR BHATTACHARYA.
 - Built five Jantar Mantars - Jaipur, Delhi, Ujjain, Mathura, Varanasi.
 - Compiled the astronomical tables 'Zij-i-Muhammad Shahi'; also built Nahargarh.
 - Jaipur became a UNESCO World Heritage City in 2019.
-
- Sawai Ishwari Singh won the Battle of Rajmahal (1747) and built the ISAR LAT (Sargasuli); he lost Bagru in 1748 and died in 1750.
 - Madho Singh I founded Sawai Madhopur in 1763.
 - Sawai Pratap Singh built HAWA MAHAL (1799) - architect Lal Chand Ustad, 953 jharokhas.
 - Pratap Singh wrote poetry under the pen-name 'Brajnidhi' and fought the Marathas at Tunga (1787).
-
- Sawai Ram Singh II (1835-80) had Jaipur painted pink in 1876 to welcome the Prince of Wales.
 - He built Albert Hall and the Ram Prakash Theatre, founded Maharaja College and Rajasthan's first girls' school.
 - Man Singh II was the last ruler of Jaipur and the first Rajpramukh of Rajasthan.

Marwar vs Amber - two answers to the same Mughal question

Marwar (Rathore)	Amber (Kachhwaha)
Maldeo defied the Mughals' predecessors and fell at Giri Sumel (1544)	Bharmal allied with Akbar in 1562 - the first Rajput chief to do so
Chandrasen walked out of the Nagaur darbar (1570)	Man Singh I rose to a mansab of 7,000 and governed Bengal
Submitted only under Mota Raja Udai Singh (1583)	Supplied the Mughals' commander at Haldighati (1576)
Rebelled again in 1679-81; restored only in 1708	Negotiated for the Mughals at Purandar (1665)

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2023 - who prepared the plan of Jaipur, founded in 1727?

Answer: Vidyadhar Bhattacharya. Note the pairing RPSC likes: Jai Singh II founds, Vidyadhar plans, Lal Chand Ustad builds the Hawa Mahal for Pratap Singh.

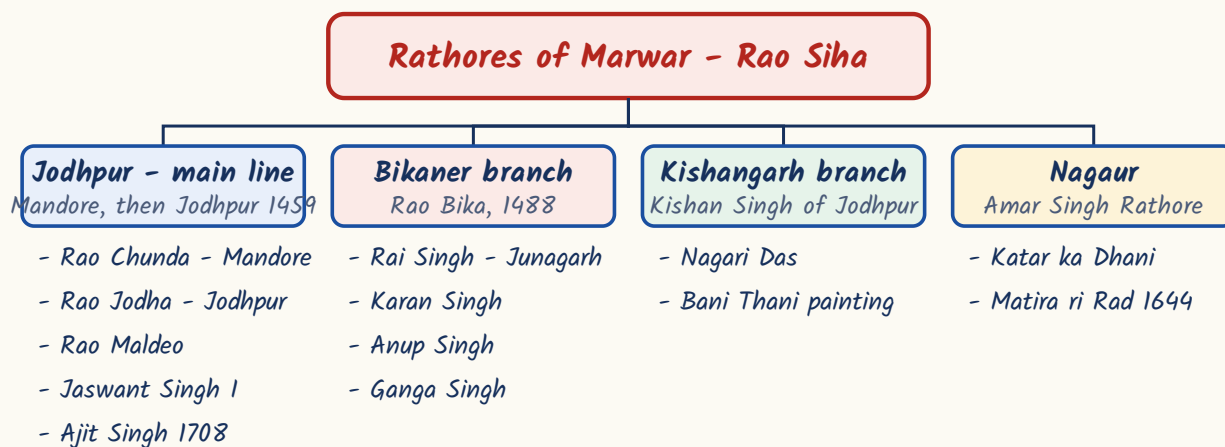
CURRENT LINK

Current link (as of March 2026): the Walled City of Jaipur, inscribed by UNESCO in 2019, is under scrutiny over construction inside its core and buffer zones; the state has to file a conservation report by December 2026 or risk a reactive monitoring mission and the 'World Heritage in Danger' list. Heritage havelis in the walled city have fallen from about 1,200 in 1991 to roughly 800.

Bikaner - the desert Rathores

Bikaner is a Jodhpur offshoot. Rao Bika, a son of Rao Jodha, went north into the Jangal country and founded his own state. The house then supplies two very examinable figures - Rai Singh the fort-builder and Ganga Singh the moderniser.

The Rathore branches - one root, four seats



- Rao Bika, son of Rao Jodha, founded BIKANER in 1488, on Akshaya Tritiya.
 - He also built the Karni Mata temple at Deshnok.
 - Rai Singh (1574-1612), a general of Akbar, built JUNAGARH fort (1589-94).
 - Karan Singh received the title 'Jangaldhar Badshah'.
 - Anup Singh founded the ANUP SANSKRIT LIBRARY.
 - Surat Singh captured Bhatner in 1805 and renamed it Hanumangarh.
-
- Maharaja GANGA SINGH (1887-1943) is called the 'Bhagirath of Rajasthan'.
 - He brought the GANG CANAL, opened in 1927 - Rajasthan's oldest canal system.
 - Raised the Ganga Risala camel corps; sat in the Imperial War Cabinet.
 - Signed the Treaty of Versailles for India in 1919 and was the first Chancellor of the Chamber of Princes.

TRAP

Ganga Singh was NOT the first Rajpramukh of Rajasthan - that was Man Singh II of Jaipur, and the first Rajpramukh of the earlier United State of Rajasthan was Bhupal Singh of Mewar. This is the standard 'NOT correct' option on Ganga Singh.

Jaisalmer - the Bhatias and their three sakas

Jaisalmer is short and high-yield. One founder, one capital shift, three sakas. Learn the third one carefully - it is called the 'ardh saka', a half saka, because the jauhar could not be completed.

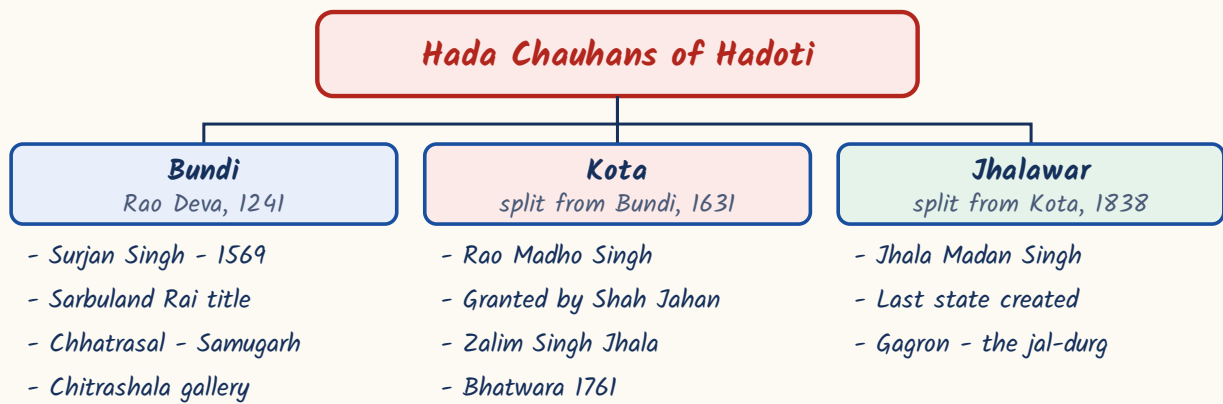
- Rawal Jaisal shifted the capital from LODRAVA and founded Jaisalmer.
- First saka - under Mulraj and Ratan Singh, against Alauddin Khilji.
- Second saka - against Firoz Shah Tughlaq.
- Third saka, the 'ardh saka' (c. 1550), under Rawal Lunkaran - the jauhar could not be completed.
- Jaisalmer's fort, the Sonar Qila, is one of the UNESCO Hill Forts of Rajasthan.

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2023 as a two-statement question on Jaisalmer - that Rawal Jaisal shifted the capital from Lodrava, and that the third saka was the incomplete 'ardh saka'. Both true. Statement-based questions are about 19% of the paper now, so expect this format on the smaller states.

Hadoti - Bundi, Kota and Jhalawar

Hadoti is the south-eastern corner - the Hada branch of the Chauhans. One state becomes three: Bundi first, Kota carved out of it by Shah Jahan, and Jhalawar carved out of Kota by the British. That sequence of splits is itself a question.

Hadoti - one state becomes three

- Rao Deva founded BUNDI in 1241 after defeating the Meena chief Jaita.
- Rao Surjan Singh surrendered RANTHAMBORE to Akbar in 1569 and received the title 'Rao Raja'.
- Rao Ratan Singh received the title 'Sarbuland Rai' from Jahangir.
- Rao Chhatrasal built the Chhatra Mahal and fell at Samugarh (1658).
- Rao Umed Singh built the Chitrashala - the painting gallery of Bundi.
- KOTA was separated from Bundi in 1631 by Shah Jahan, for Rao Madho Singh.
- Zalim Singh Jhala, Kota's great administrator, won the Battle of BHATWARA (1761) against Jaipur.
- JHALAWAR was carved out of Kota in 1838 for Jhala Madan Singh.
- Jhalawar was the last princely state created in Rajputana.
- GAGRON fort (Jhalawar) sits at the confluence of the Ahu and the Kali Sindh.
- It is the classic JAL-DURG - the water fort - of Rajasthan, and a UNESCO Hill Fort.
- Achaldas Khichi died defending Gagron against Hoshang Shah of Malwa.

The Jat and eastern states – Bharatpur, Alwar, Dholpur, Karauli,

Tonk

These are the eighteenth and nineteenth century states on the Agra-Delhi side, and none of them is Rajput-Rathore. Two are Jat, one is a Kachhwaha offshoot, one Yaduvanshi, one Pathan. Each needs exactly one founder and one anchor fact.

- BHARATPUR is a Jat state of the Sinsinwar clan; Churaman and Badan Singh laid its foundations.
- Maharaja SURAJ MAL (d. 25 December 1763) is called the 'Plato of the Jat community'.
- Suraj Mal built LOHAGARH fort and the Deeg palaces.
- ALWAR was founded on 25 December 1775 by Rao Raja Pratap Singh Naruka - the Narukas are a Kachhwaha offshoot.
- Alwar's fort is the Bala Qila; Bakhtawar Singh signed with Wellesley in 1803 after the Battle of Laswari.
- DHOLPUR went to the Jat Rana Kirat Singh of Gohad in 1805-06 - a Bamrolia Jat house.
- KARAULI is Yaduvanshi (Jadaun); Arjun Pal established its capital in 1348.
- TONK, founded in 1817 by the Pindari leader Amir Khan, was the ONLY Muslim princely state of Rajputana.

The southern and smaller houses

Finish the chapter with the houses that appear once every few papers. You need clan, founder and one hook for each - no more. Note the Vagad group in the south: Dungarpur, Banswara and Pratapgarh are all Guhil, cousins of Mewar.

- SIROHI is Deora Chauhan; Rao Sahastramal founded Sirohi city in 1425, his father Rao Sobha having founded Shivpuri in 1405.
- Sirohi was the LAST Rajputana state to sign a treaty with the British, in 1823.
- Karauli, by contrast, was the first to sign (1817) - remember the pair as first and last.
- DUNGARPUR, BANSWARA and PRATAPGARH belong to the Guhil (Vagad) branch - the Mewar family's southern cousins.
- Banswara separated from Dungarpur; Pratapgarh is also called Deolia-Pratapgarh.
- KISHANGARH was founded by Kishan Singh, a son of Mota Raja Udai Singh of Jodhpur.
- Kishangarh produced Savant Singh (the poet Nagari Das) and the Bani Thani painting.
- SHEKHAWATI is named after Rao Shekha (1433-88), a Kachhwaha of Amarsar.

One-page revision - founders, battles, epithets

Founder to state - the commonest matching set

Founder	State / city	Year
Rao Siha	Rathores of Marwar (Pali region)	d. 1273
Rao Deva	Bundi	1241
Rao Jodha	Jodhpur and Mehrangarh	1459
Rao Bika	Bikaner	1488

Founder	State / city	Year
Rao Madho Singh	Kota (split from Bundi)	1631
Sawai Jai Singh II	Jaipur	1727
Madho Singh I	Sawai Madhopur	1763
Pratap Singh Naruka	Alwar	1775
Amir Khan	Tonk	1817
Jhala Madan Singh	Jhalawar (split from Kota)	1838

Battles of the other states – and who fought whom

Battle and year	Sides	Outcome
Giri Sumel, 1544	Rao Maldeo vs Sher Shah Suri	Marwar defeated; Jaita and Kumpa killed
Matira ri Rad, 1644	Amar Singh Rathore of Nagaur vs Bikaner	The 'Battle of the Watermelon'
Dharmat, 1658	Jaswant Singh I (for Dara) vs Aurangzeb	Jaswant Singh defeated
Samugarh, 1658	Rao Chhatrasal of Bundi killed	Mughal succession war
Bhatwara, 1761	Kota under Zalim Singh Jhala vs Jaipur	Kota wins
Rajmahal, 1747 / Bagru, 1748	Ishwari Singh of Jaipur	Won Rajmahal, lost Bagru
Tunga, 1787	Sawai Pratap Singh vs the Marathas	Jaipur holds
Gingoli, 1807	Jodhpur vs Jaipur, over Krishna Kumari	Marwar-Dhundhar rupture
Laswari, 1803	Marathas vs the British	Alwar signs with Wellesley after it

YAAD RAKHO

Epithet drill - Maldeo is 'Hashmat Wala Raja', Chandrasen is the 'Pratap of Marwar', Durgadas is the 'Redeemer of Marwar', Suraj Mal is the 'Plato of the Jats', Ganga Singh is the 'Bhagirath of Rajasthan', Karan Singh of Bikaner is 'Jangaldhar Badshah'. RPSC asks these as a match-the-following almost verbatim.

TRAP

Two Jai Singhs, two Amar Singhs, two Man Singhs. Mirza Raja Jai Singh I (Purandar, 1665) is not Sawai Jai Singh II (Jaipur, 1727). Amar Singh Rathore of Nagaur (Katar ka Dhani) is not Amar Singh I of Mewar (treaty of 1615). Man Singh I of Amber (Haldighati) is not Maharaja Man Singh of Jodhpur (Nath sect, Mahamandir).

CURRENT LINK

Current link (still the position in 2026): the six Hill Forts of Rajasthan inscribed by UNESCO in 2013 map almost one to one onto this chapter's houses - Chittorgarh and Kumbhalgarh for Mewar, Amber for the Kachhwahas, Jaisalmer for the Bhatias, Ranthambore (surrendered to Akbar by Bundi's Rao Surjan Singh in 1569) and Gagron in Jhalawar. Jaisalmer's Sonar Qila is one of the world's few living forts, still inhabited, and seepage from modern water supply inside it is a standing conservation worry.

REVISION RECAP

1. Marwar: Rao Siha founder, Rao Chunda took Mandore, Rao Jodha built Jodhpur and Mehrangarh on 12 May 1459.
2. Mehrangarh is also Garh Chintamani and Mayurdhwaj; Chidiyatunk is its hill.
3. Maldeo, 'Hashmat Wala Raja', lost Giri Sumel to Sher Shah in January 1544; Jaita and Kumpa died there.
4. Chandrasen resisted from Bhadrajun and Siwana; Mota Raja Udai Singh was the first Rathore to submit, in 1583.

5. Jaswant Singh I fought at Dharmat 1658 and died at Jamrud 1678; Muhnot Nainsi was his minister.
6. Durgadas Rathore protected Ajit Singh for thirty years; Ajit Singh restored 1708; chhatra at Ujjain.
7. Khejarli 1730: Amrita Devi Bishnoi and 363 others; the state wildlife award carries her name.
8. Dhundhar: Dulha Rai founder, Kokil Dev moved to Amber, Prithviraj Singh I's settlement created the Barah Kotri.
9. Bharmal allied with Akbar in 1562 (Sambhar); Man Singh I held mansab 7,000 and brought Shila Devi from Bengal.
10. Mirza Raja Jai Singh I - Purandar 1665, 23 of 35 forts, poet Bihari, died Burhanpur 1667.
11. Sawai Jai Singh II - 'Sawai' from Aurangzeb, Jaipur 1727 planned by Vidyadhar, five Jantar Mantars, Zij-i-Muhammad Shahi.
12. Hawa Mahal 1799 by Sawai Pratap Singh, architect Lal Chand Ustad, 953 jharokhas; Isar Lat by Ishwari Singh.
13. Ram Singh II painted Jaipur pink in 1876 for the Prince of Wales; Man Singh II was the first Rajpramukh of Rajasthan.
14. Bikaner: Rao Bika 1488, Junagarh by Rai Singh, Anup Sanskrit Library by Anup Singh, Bhatner renamed Hanumangarh 1805.
15. Ganga Singh - Gang Canal 1927, Ganga Risala, Versailles 1919, first Chancellor of the Chamber of Princes.
16. Jaisalmer: Rawal Jaisal moved from Lodrava; three sakas, the third an incomplete 'ardh saka' under Lunkaran.
17. Hadoti: Bundi 1241 by Rao Deva; Ranthambore surrendered 1569 by Rao Surjan; Kota split 1631; Jhalawar 1838, the last new state.
18. Gagron at the Ahu-Kali Sindh confluence is the Jal-durg; Achaldas Khichi died defending it.
19. Bharatpur - Sinsinwar Jats, Suraj Mal, Lohagarh and Deeg; Alwar - Naruka Kachhwaha, 1775; Tonk - Amir Khan, 1817, the only Muslim state.
20. Sirohi signed last with the British (1823); Kishangarh gave us Nagari Das and the Bani Thani; Shekhawati is named for Rao Shekha.

RH06

Rajasthan & the Mughals; Medieval Administration and Revenue System

About 2-3 questions a paper. The politics half gives one, the administrative-revenue vocabulary gives one or two, almost always as match-the-following or a 'NOT correctly matched' pair.

Two halves that look unrelated but are not. The first half is politics - how the Rajput states came into the Mughal order and how some of them went out of it again. The second half is the machinery those states actually ran on: parganas, khalsa land, batai shares, patwaris. The second half is where RPSC scores you, because it is pure vocabulary and it repeats.

Rajasthan under the Mughals

Conquest and alliance

- Khanwa 1527
- Bharmal 1562
- Chittor 1568
- Ranthambore 1569
- Nagaur darbar 1570

Treaties and wars

- Mewar treaty 1615
- Jaziya 1679
- Rajput war 1679-81
- Prince Akbar's revolt
- Ajit Singh restored 1708

Mughal institutions

- Subah of Ajmer 1580
- Seven sarkars
- Mansab: zat and sawar
- Dagh and chehra
- Watan jagir

Units and officials

- Pargana, tapa, hawala
- Pradhan, Diwan, Bakshi
- Hakim, Amil, Faujdar
- Patwari, Chaudhary

Land categories

- Khalsa
- Jagir
- Bhom
- Sasan / Dharmarth
- Doli, Inam

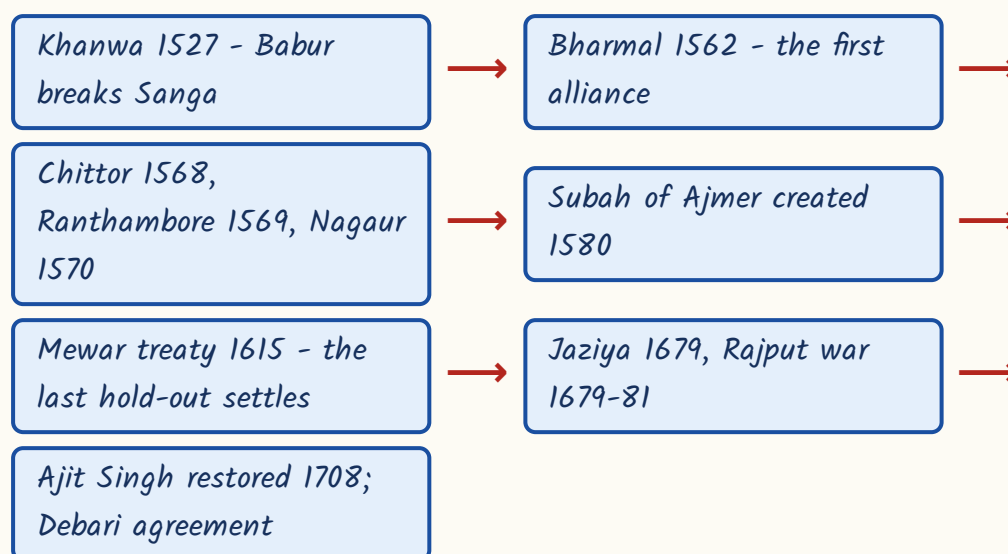
Revenue and cesses

- Batai - Latta and Kunta
- Bighori, Muqata, Hal
- Zabti, Kankut
- Bhaichara
- Lag-Bag, Bethbegar

Two hundred years in one line

Start with the shape of the story, not the dates. Babur breaks Rajput power at Khanwa in 1527. Akbar then does something cleverer than conquest - he offers the Rajput chiefs service, rank and their own homelands back, and most of them take it. Jahangir closes the last hold-out, Mewar, in 1615. Then Aurangzeb reverses the policy, and the alliance breaks apart in a war that runs from 1679 to 1681 and drags on in Marwar until 1708. Learn that arc and every date in this chapter has a place to sit.

The Rajput-Mughal relationship, start to finish



- Khanwa, 17 March 1527 - Babur defeats Rana Sanga's confederacy.
- Sanga's allies included Medini Rai of Chanderi, a Marwar contingent under Rao Ganga, and the Afghan claimant Mahmud Lodi.
- Mahmud Lodi is the name RPSC picks out - an Afghan pretender fighting on the Rajput side.

YAAD RAKHO

Four dates carry this chapter: 1527 Khanwa, 1568 Chittor, 1615 Mewar treaty, 1679 jaziya. Anchor everything else to those four.

Akbar's Rajput policy - how it actually worked

Akbar's policy was not simply marriage. It was a package: accept Mughal overlordship, take a mansab, serve in the imperial army - and in return keep your ancestral territory as a watan jagir, keep your religion, and rise as high as your ability allows. That is why a Rajput could command Mughal armies against another Rajput at Haldighati. The states that took the deal prospered; the ones that refused were besieged.

- The policy opens in 1562 with Raja BHARMAL of Amber - the first Rajput chief to accept Mughal service and give a daughter in marriage.
- The marriage of Harkha Bai to Akbar took place at SAMBHAR.
- Bharmal's family rose fastest of all - his grandson Man Singh I reached a mansab of 7,000.
- Watan jagirs left Rajput chiefs in possession of their own homelands - the heart of the bargain.
- CHITTOR besieged 23 October 1567 - 23 February 1568; Jaimal of Merta and Patta of Kelwa fell; Akbar later set up their statues at the gate of Agra Fort.
- RANTHAMBORE surrendered in 1569 by Rao Surjan Singh Hada of Bundi, who was given the title 'Rao Raja'; Kalinjar fell the same year.
- The NAGAUR darbar of 1570 drew in Bikaner and Jaisalmer; Rao Chandrasen of Marwar walked out rather than submit.
- MEWAR alone among the major states never gave a daughter in marriage to the Mughals.

Akbar in Rajasthan - the milestone table

Year	Event	Who it involved
1562	First Rajput alliance and marriage at Sambhar	Raja Bharmal of Amber
1567-68	Siege and fall of Chittor	Jaimal of Merta, Patta of Kelwa
1569	Surrender of Ranthambore	Rao Surjan Singh Hada of Bundi
1570	Nagaur darbar	Bikaner and Jaisalmer submit; Chandrasen withdraws
1576	Haldighati	Man Singh I commands for the Mughals
1580	Subah of Ajmer created	Seven sarkars, covering most of Rajasthan
1583	Marwar accepts Mughal suzerainty	Mota Raja Udai Singh

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2018 - where did Akbar's marriage with Harkha Bai, daughter of Raja Bharmal, take place? Answer: Sambhar. Note the pattern: RPSC prefers the place over the person, because the person is common knowledge.

TRAP

Chandrasen of Marwar was NOT the first Rathore to accept Mughal suzerainty - he is the one who refused. The first was Mota Raja Udai Singh, in 1583. This inversion is planted in statement-based questions.

Jahangir to Aurangzeb - settlement, then rupture

Jahangir finished what Akbar could not: he brought Mewar in, and on terms mild enough for Mewar to keep its honour. Aurangzeb then undid the whole arrangement. He reimposed the jaziya, and when Jaswant Singh I of Marwar died leaving a posthumous heir, he tried to take Marwar into direct control. That is the trigger for the Rajput war.

- MEWAR TREATY OF 1615 - Jahangir with Maharana Amar Singh I, negotiated by Prince Khurram.
 - Chittor restored, but never to be repaired; no matrimonial alliance; Prince Karan Singh to attend court in the Rana's place; 1,500 horse to be supplied.
 - Amar Singh I was the first Mewar ruler to accept Mughal suzerainty.
 - The Rathore entry into the Mughal system runs through Mota Raja Udai Singh (1583) and his daughter Jagat Gosain, mother of Shah Jahan.
 - The last Rajput-Mughal marriage was Ajit Singh's daughter to Farrukhsiyar in 1715.
-
- AURANGZEB reimposed the JAZIYA in 1679.
 - Jaswant Singh I's death in 1678 opened the Marwar succession dispute - the trigger for the RAJPUT WAR of 1679-81, involving Marwar and Mewar.
 - In 1681 Aurangzeb's own son, Prince Akbar, rebelled with Rajput support and fled to the Marathas; Durgadas Rathore escorted his children.
 - The war ended with a treaty with Mewar's Jai Singh in 1681; Marwar fought on until Ajit Singh's restoration in 1708 and the Debari agreement.

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2023 - the Mewar-Mughal treaty of 1615 was concluded during whose reign? Answer: Jahangir. Expect the follow-up in negative form: 'which was NOT a provision of the 1615 treaty' - the false option is always a marriage clause.

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2021 - the Mughal army at Haldighati (1576) was commanded by Man Singh I of Amber. This sits squarely in the Rajput-policy story: a Rajput mansabdar leading Mughal troops against a Rajput ruler is the policy working exactly as designed.

The Mughal frame in Rajasthan - subah, mansab, dagh

Now switch from politics to structure. Akbar did not leave Rajasthan outside his empire; he made it a subah. And the Rajput chiefs inside it were not vassal kings on paper - they were mansabdars inside the MANSABDARI system, ranked officers of the empire whose ranks were neither hereditary nor transferable.

- Akbar created the SUBAH OF AJMER in 1580, one of the twelve original subahs.
- It had SEVEN sarkars: Ajmer, Jodhpur, Chittor, Ranthambore, Nagaur, Sirohi, Bikaner.
- It covered roughly modern Rajasthan - but parts of eastern Rajasthan lay in the Agra and Delhi subahs.
- Man Singh I of Amber held the highest Rajput mansab under Akbar - 7,000.

Subah of Ajmer, 1580 - its seven sarkars



Eastern Rajasthan lay in the Agra and Delhi subahs, not in Ajmer

Zat vs Sawar - do not blur these

Zat	Sawar
Fixes the holder's personal rank and status	Fixes the cavalry contingent he must maintain
Determines his salary	Determines his troop obligation
Higher zat = higher place in the imperial order	Higher sawar = larger horse contingent

- **DAGH** = branding of horses. **CHEHRA** (huliya) = the descriptive roll of a soldier.
- Both were enforced by Akbar to stop fraud at musters - borrowed horses, hired men, padded lists.
- **Du-aspa / sih-aspa** let a noble keep extra troopers without raising his zat rank.
- **Mansabs** were neither hereditary nor transferable - a favourite statement to test.

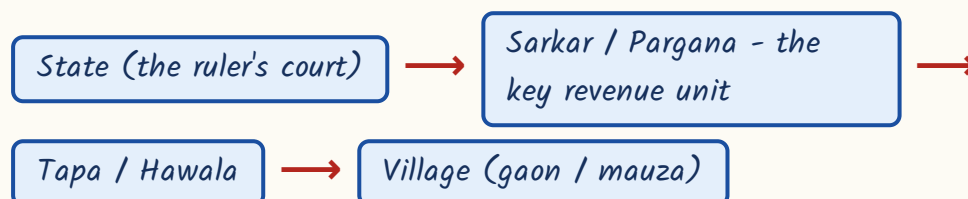
YAAD RAKHO

Dagh is for horses, chehra is for men. Horse gets a brand, man gets a description. If you can hold that one line you have a guaranteed mark.

How a Rajput state was actually run

Below the ruler the state was a pyramid, and the important layer in the middle is the **PARGANA** - a group of villages, and the real revenue unit. Everything administrative in this chapter attaches to one of four levels: the court, the pargana, the village, or the fort. Learn the officials by the level they sit at, not as one alphabetical list.

Administrative hierarchy of a Rajput state



Central officials - the court level

Official	Department
Pradhan	Prime minister, head of the administration

Official	Department
Diwan	Revenue and finance
Bakshi	Military department - pay and muster
Khan-i-Saman	Stores and household
Kotwal	Law and order, prices and weights in towns
Khajanchi	Treasury
Dyodhidar	Palace security
Waqia-navis	News writer

Pargana and village officials

Level	Official	Function
Pargana	Hakim	Head of the pargana - administrative and judicial
Pargana	Amil / Amalguzar	Revenue collection
Pargana	Faujdar	Police and military duties
Pargana	Potdar	Accounts
Pargana	Khufia-navis	Secret reports
Pargana	Kanungo and Chaudhary	Records and local liaison
Village	Patwari	Land records and revenue
Village	Chaudhary / Muqaddam	Headman
Village	Talwati	Weighing and measuring the produce
Village	Kanwari	Crop protection

TRAP

Dyodhidar is a PALACE official, not a pargana one. 'Which of these was NOT connected with pargana administration' is a real question and Dyodhidar is its answer. Keep the court list and the pargana list physically separate in your memory.

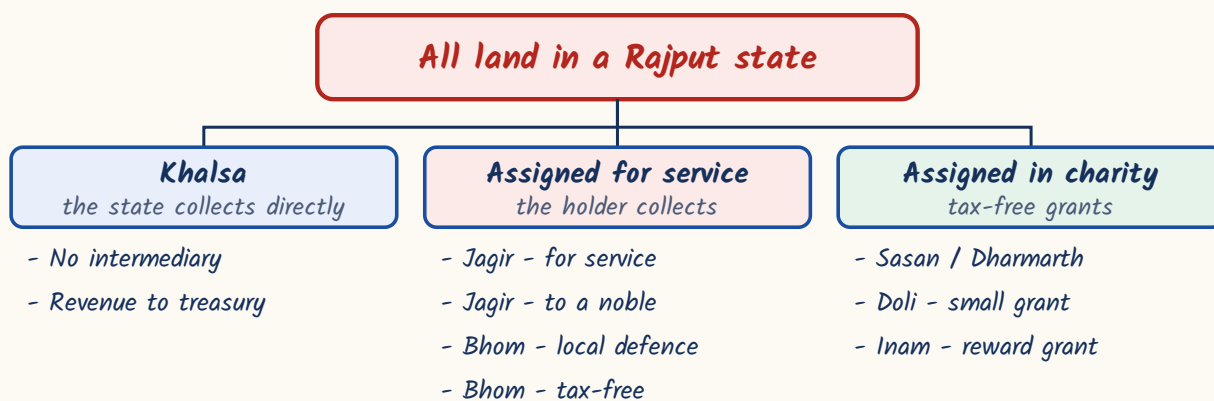
CURRENT LINK

Current link (as of 2026): the medieval vocabulary is gone but the office is not. Rajasthan's land records are now online - jamabandi and khasra through the state's Apna Khata / e-Dharti portal and plot maps through Bhu-Naksha, under the centre's Digital India Land Records Modernisation Programme - yet the record is still written and kept by the PATWARI, with the girdawar above him. Sarkar and pargana have vanished; patwari, khasra and jamabandi have not.

Land and revenue - the vocabulary RPSC actually asks

First understand the logic, then the words. All land in a state fell into one of two broad situations: either the ruler collected from it directly, or he had assigned that right to somebody else - a noble for service, a Bhomia for local defence, a temple or a Brahmin for charity. Once you see that, the six land categories are just six answers to the question 'who collects here, and why'.

Who collects here, and why - the land categories



Land categories in medieval Rajasthan

Category	Meaning
Khalsa	Under the direct control of the state
Jagir	Assigned to a noble in return for military or administrative service
Bhom	Hereditary and tax-free, held by Bhomias for local defence and police duty
Sasan / Dharmarth	Tax-free religious grant
Doli	Small tax-free charitable grant
Inam	Reward grant

Now assessment - how much the state took. The default across Rajasthan was BATAI, crop-sharing, with the state's share usually one-third. Batai has two working forms and this is the single most examinable distinction in the chapter: in Latta the crop is cut first and then divided; in Kunta the standing crop is appraised before it is cut. Cut-then-divide versus look-and-estimate.

Latta vs Kunta - the two forms of Batai

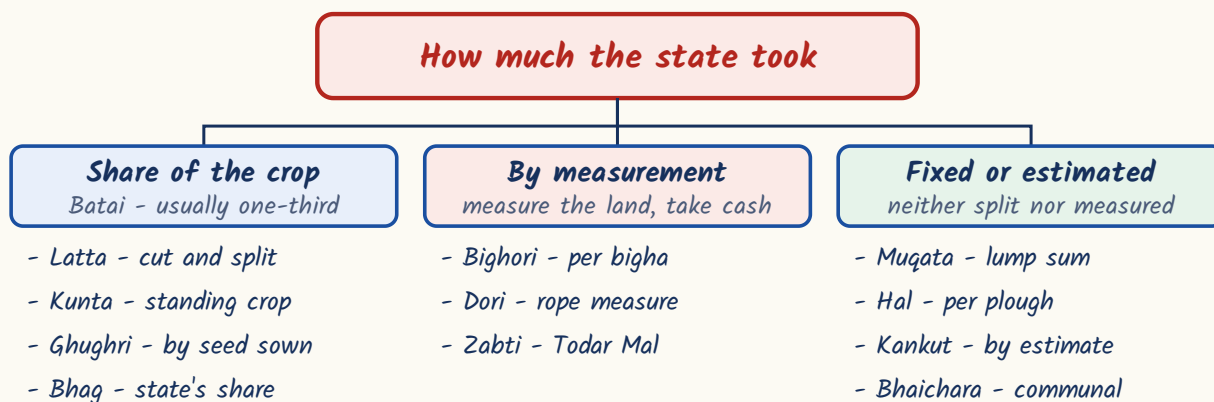
Latta (Lata)	Kunta
The crop is harvested first	The crop is still standing
The cut crop is physically divided	The yield is appraised or estimated
Division happens after the harvest	Assessment happens before the harvest

The other assessment systems - term to basis

Term	Basis of assessment
Bighori / Beghodi	Cash rate per bigha, graded by soil fertility
Mugata / Mukata	Fixed lump-sum payment
Dori	Assessment by measurement with a rope
Ghughri	Share based on the seed sown
Hal / Halibakshi	Per plough - roughly 15-30 bighas to a plough
Kankut	Estimate of the grain yield

Term	Basis of assessment
Zabti	Akbar's measurement-based cash system, under Todar Mal
Bhaichara	Joint village-brotherhood assessment; the community shares the burden

Assessment systems sorted by principle



TRAP

Two standing errors. First: Zabti is measurement-based cash assessment, NOT a share of the standing crop - that is Kunta. Second: IQTA is a Delhi Sultanate term and was never a land category in medieval Rajasthan; when it appears in the options it is the odd one out.

Cesses, forced labour, ranks and records

Land revenue was never the whole of what a peasant paid. On top of it sat a crowd of customary levies, and on top of those sat unpaid labour. Both have names, and both get asked - usually in the 'NOT correctly matched' format, where a cess is given the wrong definition.

What the peasant actually paid

Land revenue

Batai - the state's third

Lag-bag

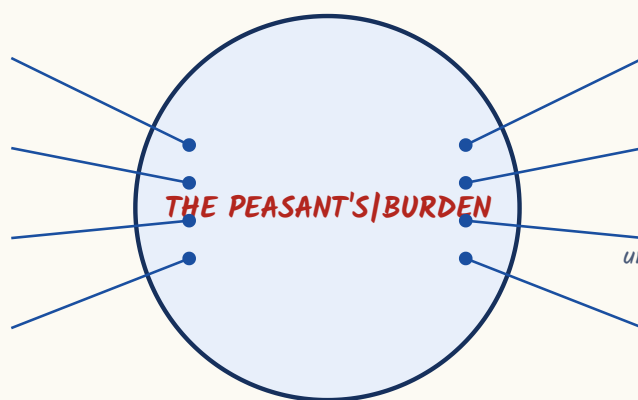
cesses beyond land revenue

Ghar-ginti

a house tax

Dastoor

illegal exaction by the staff



Bighori

cash rate per bigha of land

Chanwari lag

levy on a daughter's wedding

Bethbegar

unpaid labour, NOT a cash cess

Hiranya

state's share taken in cash

- **LAG-BAG** = the cesses and customary levies beyond land revenue - Nyauta lag, Chanwari lag on daughters' weddings, Ghar-ginti house tax.
- **BETHBEGAR** = unpaid forced labour exacted from peasants and artisans. It is labour, not a cash cess - the commonest planted error.
- **Udrang** = fixed share taken from hereditary holders; **Bhag** = the state's share of produce; **Hiranya** = the state's share taken in cash.
- **Dastoor** = illegal exaction by revenue staff; **Barani** = unirrigated land.

Feudal ranks - state by state

State	Ranks of the nobility
Mewar	Solah (16) Umrao, Battis (32) Sardar, and Gol
Marwar	Rajvi, Sardar, Ganayat, Mutsaddi
Jaipur	The Barah (12) Kotri, headed by the Rajawat

- Infantry were the Pyade.
- Cavalry were graded Yak-aspa, Du-aspa, Sih-aspa and Nim-aspa - one, two, three horses, or a half share.
- Bargir = state-equipped trooper; Siledar = trooper who brought his own horse and arms.
- Ahadi = the ruler's own standing troops; Jamiyat = a noble's contingent.
- The Rajput states kept bahi-khata record series - Hakikat Bahi, Kamthana Bahi, and Pattas and Parwanas.
- Muhnot Nainsi's 'Marwar ra Pargana ri Vigat' is the classic revenue gazetteer of a Rajput state - pargana by pargana.
- That work is why Nainsi is asked in two different chapters: as a chronicler and as a revenue source.

CURRENT LINK

Current link (as of January 2025 and still standing in 2026): Rajasthan's own administrative map has been redrawn twice in three years. Nine of the districts and three of the divisions created in 2023 were annulled by the cabinet decision of 28 December 2024, leaving the state with 41 districts and 7 divisions. Worth noticing alongside this chapter - the pargana and sarkar are gone, but the habit of re-cutting revenue units to suit administration is not, and the state's land records still run through the patwari.

REVISION RECAP

1. Khanwa 17 March 1527 - Babur over Sanga; Mahmud Lodi, the Afghan claimant, fought on the Rajput side.
2. Akbar's policy opens in 1562 with Bharmal of Amber; the marriage of Harkha Bai took place at Sambhar.
3. Chittor fell 23 Feb 1568 (Jaimal and Patta, statues at Agra Fort); Ranthambore surrendered 1569 by Rao Surjan Singh Hada.
4. Nagaur darbar 1570 - Bikaner and Jaisalmer submit, Chandrasen walks out.

5. Mewar alone never gave a daughter to the Mughals; Marwar submitted in 1583 under Mota Raja Udai Singh.
6. Mewar treaty 1615 with Jahangir: Chittor back but unrepaired, no marriage tie, Karan Singh to court, 1,500 horse.
7. Aurangzeb reimposed jaziya in 1679; Jaswant Singh I's death (1678) triggered the Rajput war of 1679-81.
8. Prince Akbar's revolt 1681; Mewar treaty 1681; Marwar settled only with Ajit Singh's restoration in 1708.
9. Subah of Ajmer created 1580 with seven sarkars - Ajmer, Jodhpur, Chittor, Ranthambore, Nagaur, Sirohi, Bikaner.
10. Zat = personal rank and pay; Sawar = cavalry to be maintained; mansabs neither hereditary nor transferable.
11. Dagh brands the horse, chehra describes the man; du-aspa and sih-aspa add troopers without raising zat.
12. Hierarchy: state - sarkar/pargana - tapa/hawala - village; the pargana is the key revenue unit.
13. Court: Pradhan, Diwan, Bakshi, Khan-i-Saman, Kotwal, Khajanchi, Dyodhidar, Waqia-navis.
14. Pargana: Hakim heads it, Amil collects, Faujdar polices, Potdar keeps accounts, Khufia-navis reports secretly.
15. Village: Patwari keeps records, Chaudhary/Muqaddam heads the village, Talwati weighs, Kanwari guards the crop.
16. Land: Khalsa direct, Jagir for service, Bhom hereditary and tax-free for defence, Sasan religious, Doli charitable, Inam reward.
17. Batai takes about one-third; Latta divides the cut crop, Kunta appraises the standing crop.
18. Bighori per bigha, Muqata lump-sum, Dori by rope, Ghughri by seed, Hal per plough, Kankut by estimate, Zabti by measurement in cash.
19. Lag-Bag are the extra cesses; Bethbegar is unpaid forced labour; Bhaichara spreads the burden across the village.
20. Feudal ranks: Mewar's Solah Umrao and Battis Sardar, Marwar's Rajvi and Ganayat, Jaipur's Barah Kotri.

RH07

Rajputana under the British; 19th-Century Conditions & Reform

About 1-2 questions a paper. The Walerkrit Rajputana Hitkarini Sabha alone gave three questions in RAS Pre 2024. The 1817-18 treaties and the social-reform years are the other two magnets.

This chapter answers one question: how did twenty-odd independent Rajput states end up as 'Rajputana Agency' on a British map? Then it asks a second: what did that century do to society inside those states. RPSC loves it because every fact here is a date attached to a place or a person — treaty years, abolition years, society years. Pure matching material.

Rajputana under the British

Entry

- Marathas & Pindaris
- Surji-Anjangaon 1803
- Treaties 1817-18
- Karauli first, Sirohi last

Machinery

- Rajputana Agency 1832
- AGG — Ajmer then Mount Abu 1845
- Political Agents
- Ajmer-Merwara = direct rule

Social evils ended

- Sati 1822 Bundi
- Infanticide 1833 Kota
- Tyag 1841 Jodhpur
- Dakan 1853 Mewar

Reform bodies

- Walter Sabha 1888 Ajmer
- Desh Hitaishini 1877 Udaipur
- Sarva Hitkarini 1907 Churu

Education & faith

- Mayo College 1875
- Dayanand & Arya Samaj
- Har Bilas Sharda

Stress

- Chhappaniya Akal 1899-1900
- Mer/Merwara 1820-22
- Railways from 1874

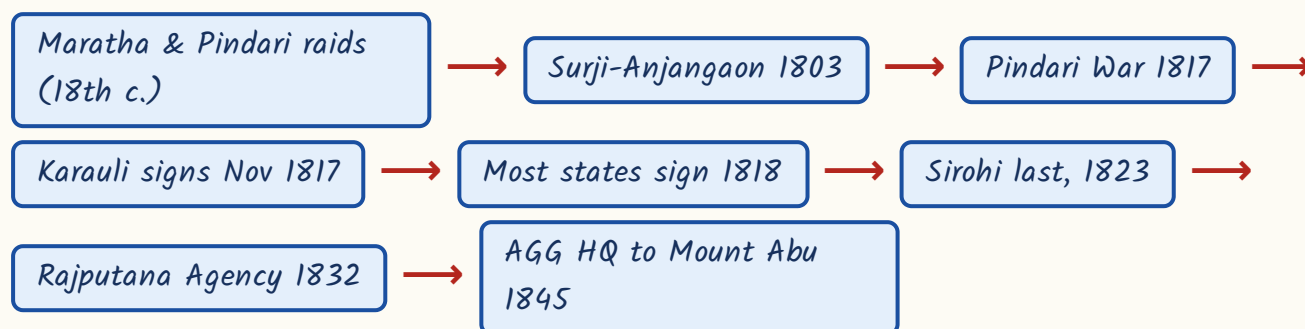
How the British walked in — Marathas first, then the Pindaris

Do not start this chapter with the British. Start with the Marathas. Through the eighteenth century the Scindias and Holkars raided Rajputana every year for tribute. Behind them came the Pindaris — irregular horsemen who plundered and left. The Rajput states were broke, exhausted and fighting each other.

So when the British offered protection, the states did not lose a war. They signed. That is the single most important idea in this chapter. The treaties of 1817-18 were bought with Maratha and Pindari pressure, not with British artillery.

- Treaty of Surji-Anjangaon, 30 December 1803, with Daulat Rao Scindia — this is the doorway.
- Ajmer itself passed to the British in 1818, ceded by Scindia.
- Governor-General at the time of the treaties: Lord Hastings.
- Negotiator on the British side for most of them: Sir Charles Metcalfe.
- The Third Anglo-Maratha and Pindari War (1817-18) is the immediate trigger.

From Maratha raids to British paramountcy



What did a state give up, and what did it keep? Learn this as a clean two-line answer. It gives away external relations and accepts British paramountcy. It keeps internal autonomy — its own courts, its own revenue, its own succession. Several states also agreed to pay tribute, called *khiraj*.

One caution on wording. These are subsidiary alliances in the Wellesley sense, but Rajputana signed under Hastings. If an option offers Lord Wellesley as the Governor-General, reject it.

The treaty order — the part RPSC actually asks

Two facts carry almost all the marks here. Karauli was first. Sirohi was last. Everything in between is a bonus. Learn the ends first, the middle later — and note that the two biggest states, Jodhpur and Udaipur, both signed in January 1818.

Subsidiary treaties with the British, in order of signing

State	Month & year
Karauli	November 1817 — FIRST
Tonk	November 1817
Kota	December 1817
Jodhpur (Marwar)	January 1818
Udaipur (Mewar)	January 1818
Bundi	February 1818
Bikaner	March 1818
Jaipur	April 1818
Jaisalmer	December 1818
Sirohi	1823 — LAST

- Tonk was created by the British in 1817 for the Pindari leader Amir Khan.
- Tonk was the only Muslim-ruled state of Rajputana.
- Jhalawar (1838), carved out of Kota, was the LAST princely state the British created in Rajputana.
- Sirohi's 1823 treaty is the usual 'NOT correctly matched' bait — options print 'Sirohi - 1818'.

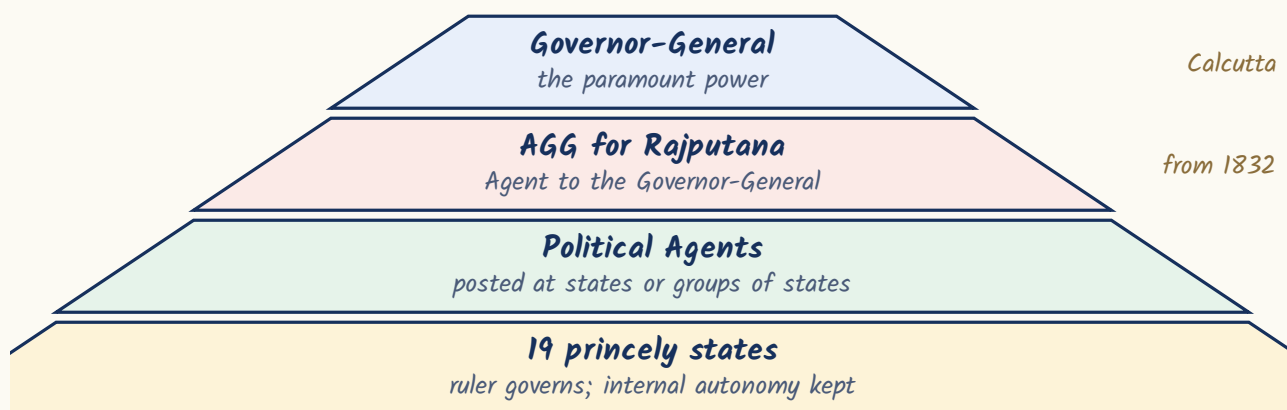
TRAP

Do not confuse the two 'last' facts. Sirohi = last state to SIGN a treaty (1823). Jhalawar = last state to be CREATED (1838).

The machinery of control — Agency, AGG, and Ajmer-Merwara

A treaty is paper. The British needed an office. That office is the Rajputana Agency, set up in 1832. Its head is the Agent to the Governor-General, the AGG. Under him sat Political Agents posted at individual states or groups of states.

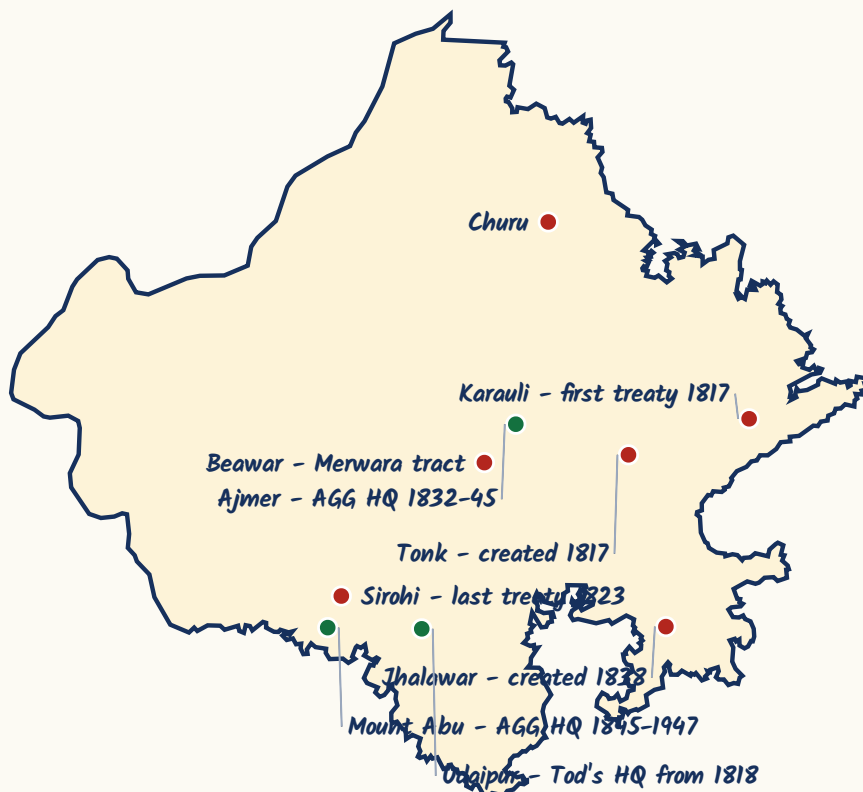
Who stood above whom in British Rajputana



- Rajputana Agency constituted: 1832.
- Head: Agent to the Governor-General (AGG) for Rajputana.
- HQ at Ajmer, 1832-1845.
- HQ shifted to Mount Abu in 1845 and stayed there till 1947.
- Mount Abu was leased by the British from Sirohi state — that is why a hill station became the AGG's seat.

Now separate two things that students keep merging. Princely Rajputana was indirectly ruled — the ruler governed, the Political Agent watched. Ajmer-Merwara was British territory, ruled directly by a Chief Commissioner. It was never a princely state.

The British map of Rajputana



Ajmer and Mount Abu were British seats; everything else was a princely capital

Princely Rajputana vs Ajmer-Merwara

Princely states (19 of them)	Ajmer-Merwara
Indirect rule — ruler governs	Direct British rule
Watched by AGG and Political Agents	Administered by a Chief Commissioner
Merged into Rajasthan 1948-49 in stages	Merged into Rajasthan on 1 Nov 1956
Became Part 'B' state territory in 1950	Was a Part 'C' state in 1950

TRAP

A favourite negative option: 'Ajmer-Merwara was administered by a princely ruler under its own treaty.' False. It was Chief Commissioner's territory, a Part 'C' state after 1950.

One more piece of pacification: the Mer tract of the Aravallis, Merwara. The Mers revolted in 1820-21. Colonel Hall put it down and the Merwara Battalion was raised in 1822 to police the hills permanently.

Colonel James Tod — the man who named 'Rajasthan'

Tod is a source-chapter name that keeps leaking into this chapter, so fix him here. He was Political Agent to the Western Rajput States from 1818, with headquarters at Udaipur. He wrote 'Annals and Antiquities of Rajast'han' — the book that gave the region its romantic image and, effectively, its modern name.

- James Tod — Political Agent, Western Rajput States, from 1818; HQ Udaipur.
- Work: 'Annals and Antiquities of Rajast'han'.
- He was an administrator-historian, not an educationist.

TRAP

Mayo College was NOT founded by James Tod. That pairing is planted in 'NOT correctly matched' questions almost every time Tod appears.

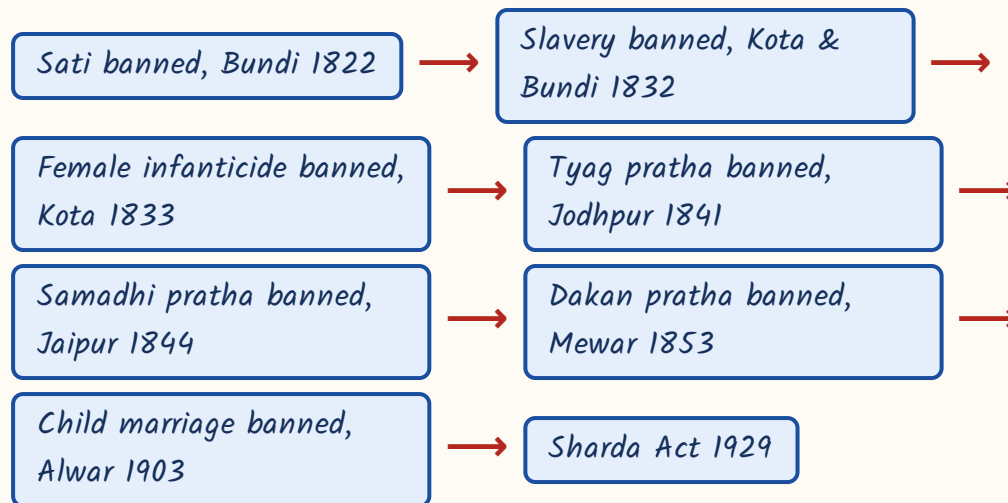
The social evils and the year each one fell

This is the highest-density table in the chapter. The pattern to internalise: in Rajputana the princely states banned these practices themselves, often BEFORE the British legislated for British India. Bundi outlawed sati in 1822 — seven years before Bentinck's Regulation of 1829. Remember that comparison; it is the point of the whole section.

Social practice — year abolished — state — ruler

Practice	Year	State	Ruler / note
Sati	1822	Bundi	Rao Vishnu Singh — first in Rajputana
Slavery (dasa pratha)	1832	Kota and Bundi	Declared illegal in both
Female infanticide (kanya vadh)	1833	Kota	Maharao Ram Singh — first ban
Female infanticide — rules framed	1839	Jodhpur	Follow-up to the Kota ban
Tyag pratha (Charan/Bhat wedding extortion)	1841	Jodhpur	Maharaja Man Singh
Samadhi pratha	1844	Jaipur	State prohibition
Dakan pratha (branding women as witches)	October 1853	Mewar	Maharana Swaroop Singh
Anmel vivah and child marriage	1903	Alwar	By state Act

Chronological order of reform measures — RPSC asks this as an ordering question



Two of these need a sentence of explanation, because a bare name teaches nothing. Tyag pratha was ritual extortion — Charans and Bhats would demand huge payments at weddings and threaten self-harm if refused. Dakan pratha was the practice of branding a woman a witch, usually to seize her land or settle a village quarrel, and then hounding or killing her.

- 1844 is the year usually given for the general prohibition of sati across the Rajputana states.
- Har Bilas Sharda of Ajmer piloted the Child Marriage Restraint Act, 1929 — the 'Sharda Act'.
- Kanyavarodh — the killing or confinement of daughters — is the umbrella term for infanticide practices.
- Bentinck's all-India Regulation against sati is 1829; Bundi 1822 is seven years earlier.

YAAD RAKHO

Four dates, four states, in rising order: 22-Bundi (sati), 33-Kota (infanticide), 41-Jodhpur (tyag), 53-Mewar (dakan). Say it as 'Bundi-Kota-Jodhpur-Mewar' and the years follow.

The reform societies — Walter Sabha above all

If you learn one institution from this chapter, learn the Walterkrit Rajputana Hitkarini Sabha. RPSC asked three separate questions on it in 2024 — its year, its founder and what it did NOT do. Colonel C.K.M. Walter, the AGG of Rajputana, founded it at Ajmer in 1888. It was originally called simply the Rajputana Hitkarini Sabha; 'Walterkrit' means 'created by Walter'.

Its whole purpose was to stop Rajput families from ruining themselves on ceremony. Marriage spending, death feasts, dowry, polygamy, child marriage. It was a social body working through the princes — not a political one.

- Curb marriage expenditure and the death feast (nukta / mrityu bhoj).
- End dowry and polygamy.
- Fix minimum marriage age: 14 for girls, 18 for boys.
- It did NOT campaign for widow remarriage.
- It did NOT seek political representation for the people.

Reform bodies of 19th-century Rajputana

Body	Year	Place	Founder / patron
Desh Hitaishini Sabha	1877	Udaipur	Maharana Sajjan Singh
Walterkrit Rajputana Hitkarini Sabha	1888	Ajmer	Colonel C.K.M. Walter, AGG
Sarva Hitkarini Sabha	1907	Churu	Swami Gopal Das (with Pt. Kanhaiyalal, Pt. Shriram)

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2024 — the Walterkrit Rajputana Hitkarini Sabha, founded in 1888, had its headquarters at? Answer: Ajmer.

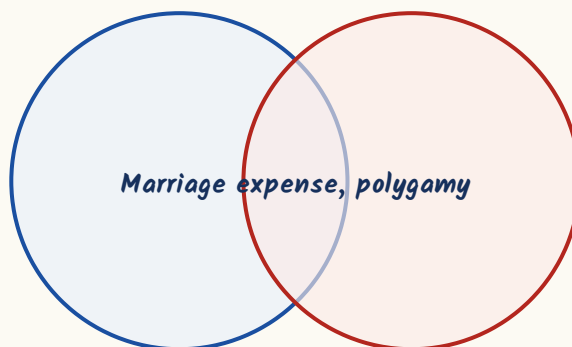
ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2024 — who founded the Walterkrit Rajputana Hitkarini Sabha? Answer: Colonel C.K.M. Walter, the AGG of Rajputana.

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2024 as a negative question — which was NOT an objective of the Walter Sabha? Answer: securing political representation for the people of the states. It was purely social.

Watch the Desh Hitaishini Sabha carefully. It attacked the same evils — marriage expenditure and polygamy — but eleven years earlier, at Udaipur, under Maharana Sajjan Singh. Similar aims, different year and different town. That is exactly what a matching question is built on.

Two reform sabhas that look alike**Desh Hitaishini Sabha****Walterkrit Hitkarini Sabha**

Udaipur 1877 under Maharana Sajjan Singh; Ajmer 1888 under Colonel C.K.M. Walter

Education, religion, famine and the railway

The British answer to 'how do we civilise the princes' was a boarding school. Mayo College opened at Ajmer in 1875, named after Viceroy Lord Mayo, and was built for the sons of princes and nobles. It is nicknamed the 'Eton of the East'.

- Mayo College — Ajmer, 1875, named after Lord Mayo.
- Purpose: educate Rajput princes and nobles in English lines.
- Nickname: 'Eton of the East'.

CURRENT LINK

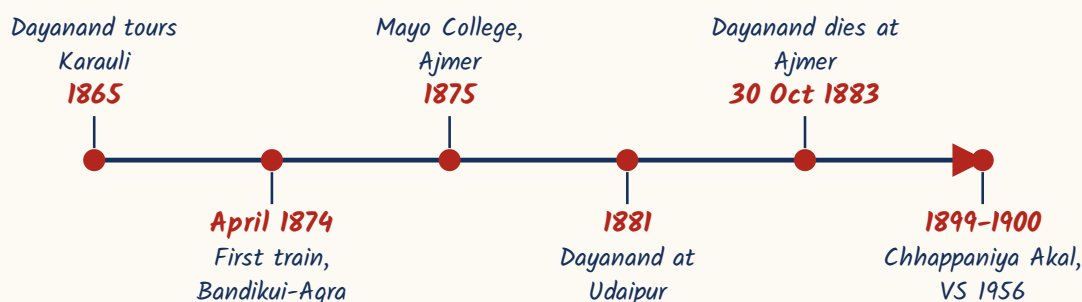
Current link (as of September 2026): Mayo College completed 150 years in 2025 and held sesquicentennial celebrations through the year. An anniversary year is exactly when RPSC picks up an institution — keep 1875 and Lord Mayo ready.

The other current running through the century is religious reform. Swami Dayanand Saraswati, founder of the Arya Samaj, toured Rajputana repeatedly and found patrons among the princes. His Rajasthan connection is examinable in two specific places.

- Dayanand's tours: Karauli 1865; later Ajmer, Bharatpur and Udaipur in 1881.
- He revised the Satyarth Prakash at Naulakha Mahal, Udaipur, as Maharana Sajjan Singh's guest.
- He died at AJMER on 30 October 1883.
- His Paropkarini Sabha continues at Ajmer — Ajmer is the answer both for his death and for that Sabha.

Finally, the two material shocks of the period. Famine, and the railway. The Chhappaniya Akal — the famine of Vikram Samvat 1956, that is 1899-1900 — was the worst in Rajputana's recorded history, and 'chhappaniya' has since become the Rajasthani word for total ruin. The railway arrived a generation earlier: the first train in Rajputana ran from Bandikui to Agra Fort in April 1874, on the metre-gauge line that grew into the Rajputana-Malwa Railway.

The late nineteenth century in Rajputana



YAAD RAKHO

Chhappan = 56. Vikram Samvat 1956 = CE 1899-1900. If you can convert the name to the number, you never lose this date.

CURRENT LINK

Current link (as of September 2026): the line that starts with Har Bilas Sharda of Ajmer is still live. In October 2024 the Supreme Court, in the child marriage case brought by the Society for Enlightenment and Voluntary Action, issued detailed directions to states for enforcing the Prohibition of Child Marriage Act, 2006 - community-level monitoring, child marriage prohibition officers and prevention over prosecution. If a paper pairs a reformer with a statute, the Ajmer link is Har Bilas Sharda and the Child Marriage Restraint Act, 1929.

REVISION RECAP

1. Surji-Anjangaon, 30 Dec 1803, with Daulat Rao Scindia opens Rajputana; Ajmer to the British in 1818.
2. Karauli (Nov 1817) first to sign a subsidiary treaty; Sirohi (1823) last.
3. Metcalfe negotiated; Lord Hastings was Governor-General.
4. Treaty bargain: external relations and paramountcy to the British, internal autonomy kept, khiraj paid.
5. Tonk created 1817 for Pindari chief Amir Khan — the only Muslim state of Rajputana.
6. Jhalawar 1838, carved from Kota — last state created by the British here.
7. Rajputana Agency 1832; AGG at Ajmer till 1845, then Mount Abu (leased from Sirohi) till 1947.
8. Ajmer-Merwara = direct British rule, Chief Commissioner, Part 'C' state 1950, into Rajasthan 1 Nov 1956.
9. James Tod — Political Agent, Western Rajput States, 1818, HQ Udaipur; 'Annals and Antiquities of Rajast'han'.
10. Sati 1822 Bundi (Rao Vishnu Singh); slavery 1832 Kota and Bundi.
11. Female infanticide 1833 Kota (Maharao Ram Singh); Jodhpur rules 1839.
12. Tyag pratha 1841 Jodhpur (Man Singh); samadhi pratha 1844 Jaipur; dakan pratha Oct 1853 Mewar (Swaroop Singh).
13. Anmel vivah and child marriage banned by Alwar Act 1903; Sharda Act 1929 by Har Bilas Sharda of Ajmer.
14. Walter Sabha 1888, Ajmer, Colonel C.K.M. Walter — social not political; marriage age 14 girls / 18 boys.
15. Desh Hitaishini Sabha 1877 Udaipur (Sajjan Singh); Sarva Hitkarini Sabha 1907 Churu (Swami Gopal Das).
16. Mayo College Ajmer 1875, after Lord Mayo, 'Eton of the East'.
17. Dayanand revised Satyarth Prakash at Naulakha Mahal Udaipur; died Ajmer 30 Oct 1883.
18. Chhappaniya Akal = VS 1956 = 1899-1900, worst famine on record.
19. Mer revolt 1820-21 crushed by Colonel Hall; Merwara Battalion raised 1822. First train: Bandikui-Agra Fort, April 1874.

RH08

1857 in Rajasthan; Peasant and Tribal Movements

About 2 questions a paper, and they are predictable. Bijolia has been asked in 2016 and 2024, the Eki movement in 2023, Neemuchana in 2021. Every one of those was a leader-place-year question. Three separate revolts sit inside one chapter. In 1857 the sepoys rose and the princes stood with the British. From 1897 the peasants rose against the thikanas. From 1883 the Bhils and Meenas rose against both. Learn them as three stories, not one list — the leaders, the places and the years never overlap.

1857 & the People's Movements

1857 cantonments

- Nasirabad 28 May
- Neemuch 3 June
- Erinpura 21 Aug
- Kota 15 Oct
- Deoli
- Kherwara & Beawar — quiet

Peasant — north

- Neemuchana 1925 Alwar
- Sikar/Shekhawati 1935
- Dudhwa Khara 1946
- Dabra 1947

1857 people

- Khushal Singh, Auwa
- Lala Jaidayal & Mehrab Khan, Kota
- Monck Mason & Major Burton killed
- AGG G.P. Lawrence

Tribal

- Govind Giri, Samp Sabha 1883
- Mangarh 1913
- Motilal Tejawat, Eki 1921
- Meena Mahasabha 1933

Peasant — Mewar side

- Bijolia 1897-1941
- Begun 1921-23
- Bundi/Dabi 1923

Leaders to fix

- Vijay Singh Pathik
- Manikya Lal Verma
- Ram Narayan Chaudhary
- Nayanuram Sharma

Why 1857 looked different in Rajputana

Understand the shape before the dates. In Rajputana the revolt of 1857 was a SEPOY revolt, not a princes' revolt. The British had six cantonments in the region. The sepoys in them mutinied. But almost every ruler stayed loyal to the British — and that is why the rising here was crushed comparatively fast.

The shape of 1857 in Rajputana

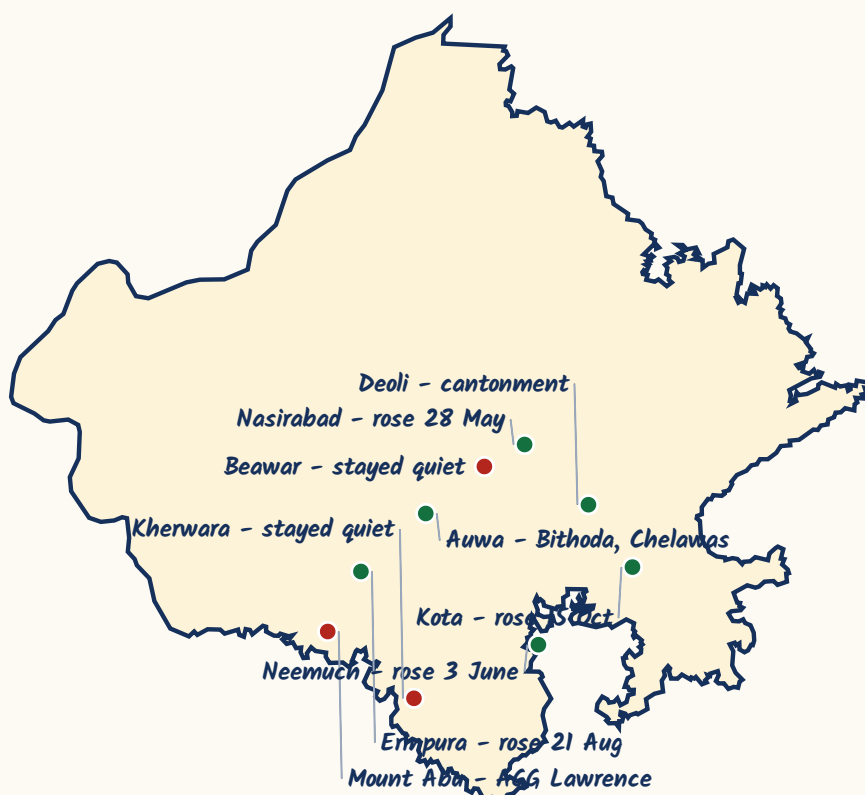


There were six cantonments. Learn them by name, because a standard question asks which one did NOT revolt.

- Nasirabad (Ajmer) — revolted.
- Neemuch — revolted.
- Erinpura (Pali) — revolted.
- Deoli (Tonk) — revolted.
- Kherwara (Udaipur) — did NOT revolt.
- Beawar — did NOT revolt.

On the British side the man in charge was George Patrick Lawrence, Agent to the Governor-General for Rajputana, sitting at Mount Abu. The Ajmer treasury was moved for safety during the crisis.

1857 - the six cantonments and the two big risings



Neemuch lies just beyond the present state border, in Madhya Pradesh

Rulers who sided with the British in 1857

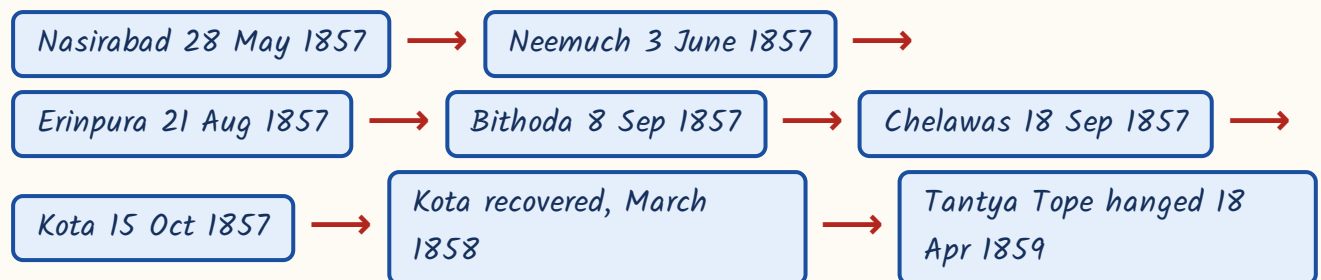
State	Ruler
Jaipur	Ram Singh II
Jodhpur	Takht Singh
Udaipur	Swaroop Singh
Bikaner	Sardar Singh
Kota	Ram Singh
Karauli	Narendra Singh

Kherwara and Beawar are counted among the six but never mutinied. Questions phrase this as 'which cantonment is counted among the six but saw no mutiny' — the answer they want is Kherwara.

The chronology of 1857 in Rajasthan

This is an ordering question waiting to happen. Fix the sequence by month: May, June, August, September, October. Then March next year for the recovery of Kota, and April 1859 for Tantya Tope.

1857-59 in Rajasthan, in order



- Nasirabad, 28 May 1857 — the 15th and 30th Native Infantry mutinied and marched to Delhi. This is where the revolt in Rajasthan begins.
- Neemuch, 3 June 1857 — the sepoys moved on Delhi via Chittor; Mohammad Ali Beg is remembered here.
- Erinpura, 21 August 1857 — the Jodhpur Legion rose with the cry 'Chalo Delhi, Maro Firangi'.

YAAD RAKHO

NNEK — Nasirabad, Neemuch, Erinpura, Kota. Four letters, four centres, correct order. Auwa's two battles sit between Erinpura and Kota.

Auwa and Kota — the only two places the British really lost control

Auwa is a thikana of Marwar. Its Thakur, Khushal Singh Champawat, gave shelter to the Erinpura mutineers and then beat the Jodhpur state army in the field. Two battles: Bithoda on 8 September 1857 and Chelawas on 18 September 1857.

At Auwa the rebels killed Monck Mason, the Political Agent of Jodhpur, and hung his head at the fort gate. That single act is why Auwa is remembered — and why it is the standard 'which officer was killed where' question.

Kota is the bigger episode. On 15 October 1857 the Kota troops rose under Lala Jaidayal, a Kayastha, and Mehrab Khan. They killed Major Burton, the Political Agent. The rebels held the city for about six months. General H.G. Roberts recovered Kota only in March 1858.

The two big centres — who, what, when

Centre	Leader(s)	British officer killed	Key dates
Auwa (Marwar)	Thakur Khushal Singh Champawat	Monck Mason, PA Jodhpur	Bithoda 8 Sep, Chelawas 18 Sep 1857
Kota	Lala Jaidayal, Mehrab Khan	Major Burton, PA Kota	Rose 15 Oct 1857; recovered Mar 1858

TRAP

Never swap the two officers. Monck Mason died at Auwa. Major Burton died at Kota. A common wrong pair printed in negative questions is 'Deoli - killing of Major Burton'.

After the main risings came Tantya Tope. He entered Rajasthan through Banswara and Pratapgarh, was defeated near Bhilwara and again near Sikar, and was finally hanged at Sipri on 18 April 1859.

Why the peasants rose — lag, begar and the thikana

Now shift forty years forward. The peasant movements have nothing to do with 1857. Their cause is economic: the jagirdar or thikanedar taxed the cultivator for everything.

'Lag' means a cess. 'Bag' means a levy in kind. 'Begar' or 'bethbegar' means forced unpaid labour. Bijolia alone had 84 kinds of lag on 84 villages. When the state added yet another one, the village stopped paying — and that is a movement.

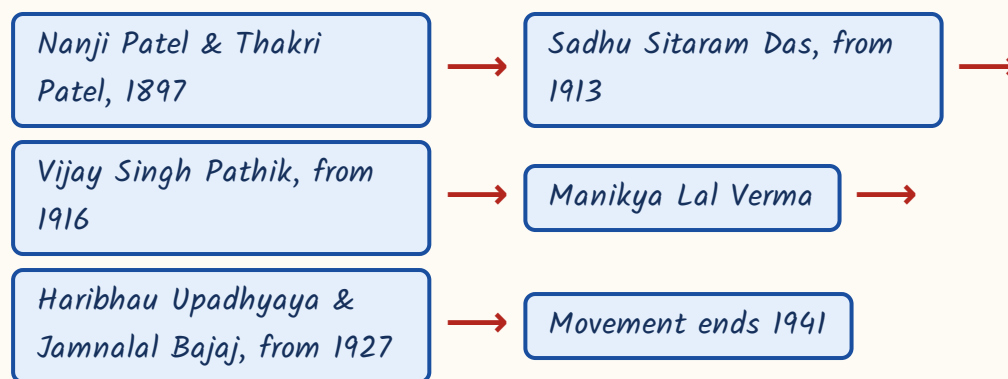
- Chanwari lag (1903) — a tax on every marriage in the village. This is the spark at Bijolia.
- Talwar Bandhai — a levy taken when a new thikanedar succeeded.
- Begar / bethbegar — unpaid forced labour on the thikana's land.
- The demand in every one of these movements is the same: abolish the illegal cesses and the begar.

Bijolia — India's longest peasant movement

Bijolia is the centrepiece of this chapter. Understand the setting: Bijolia was a first-class thikana of Mewar state, and it lies in today's Bhilwara district. The movement ran from 1897 to 1941 — forty-four years, the longest peasant movement in modern India.

Its leadership changed four times, and RPSC asks the sequence. Learn it as a chain, not as a set.

Bijolia — the leadership chain, 1897 to 1941



Vijay Singh Pathik is the name that carries this chapter into the next one. His real name was Bhoop Singh Gurjar, and he was born at Guthawali in Bulandshahr — an outsider who became Rajasthan's leading peasant organiser. He founded the Rajasthan Seva Sangh at Wardha in 1919 and edited Rajasthan Kesari.

- 84 villages, 84 types of lag — the famous 'chaurasi' framing.
- Publicised nationally by 'Pratap' of Kanpur, edited by Ganesh Shankar Vidyarthi.
- Also carried by 'Abhyudaya' and 'Bharat Mitra' of Allahabad.
- Gandhi sent Mahadev Desai to study the movement on the ground.
- Manikya Lal Verma began his public life here, wrote the song 'Panchhida', and later led the Mewar Prajamandal.

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2016 and again in 2024 — when did the Bijolia peasant movement begin? Answer: 1897. The paired statement question adds that it ran to 1941 and that Vijay Singh Pathik led it from 1916.

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2024 — the real name of Vijay Singh Pathik? Answer: Bhoop Singh.

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2018 — which two Hindi newspapers carried the Bijolia peasants' cause to a national audience? Answer: Abhyudaya and Bharat Mitra.

The other peasant movements — one table, learn it cold

Begun is Bijolia's twin — same region, same grievances, a few years later. Ram Narayan Chaudhary led it from 1921 to 1923. In the Govindpura firing of July 1923 two peasants, Rupaji and Kripaji Dhakad, were killed. The settlement that ended it was so favourable to the peasants that the British officer Trench sneered at it as the 'Bolshevik Agreement'.

Bijolia vs Begun — the two Mewar-side movements

Bijolia	Begun (Bengu)
1897-1941, the longest in India	1921-1923, short and sharp
Bhilwara district; thikana of Mewar	Chittorgarh side; thikana of Mewar
Pathik, Sitaram Das, Manikya Lal Verma	Ram Narayan Chaudhary
Trigger: Chanwari lag, 1903	Martyrs: Rupaji and Kripaji, Govindpura 1923
National publicity via Pratap, Abhyudaya	Settlement mocked as the 'Bolshevik Agreement'

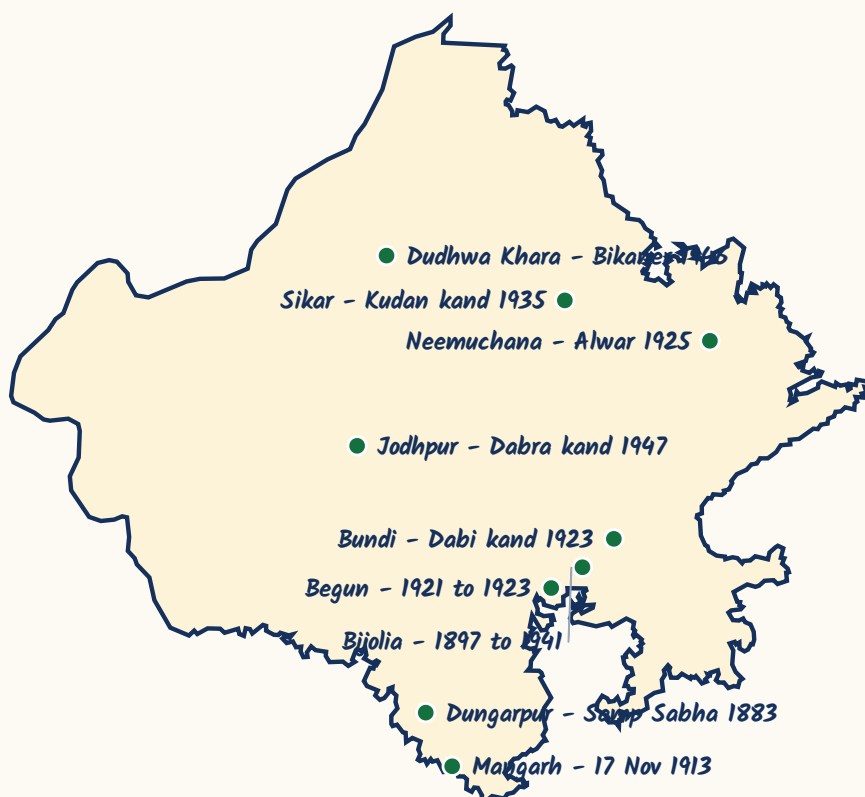
Peasant movements — movement, leader, place, year

Movement	Leader	Place / state	Year
Bijolia	Vijay Singh Pathik (after Sitaram Das)	Bijolia thikana, Mewar — Bhilwara	1897-1941
Begun (Bengu)	Ram Narayan Chaudhary	Begun, Mewar	1921-1923
Barad / Bundi	Pandit Nayanuram Sharma	Dabi, Bundi state	Dabi kand 2 Apr 1923

Movement	Leader	Place / state	Year
Neemuchana	Peasants of the Alwar hills	Neemuchana, Alwar state	14 May 1925
Sikar / Shekhawati Jat	Sikarwati Jat Kisan Panchayat; Thakur Deshraj	Kudan, Sikar	Kudan kand 25 Apr 1935
Dudhwa Khara	Kumbharam Arya, Raghuvar Dayal Goyal	Bikaner state	From 1946
Marwar Kisan Sabha	Marwar Kisan Sabha leadership	Dabra, Jodhpur state	Dabra kand 13 Mar 1947

Two of these produced martyrs whose names get matched in questions. At Dabi in Bundi, Nanakji Bhil was killed on 2 April 1923 — that incident is called 'Rajasthan ka Jallianwala Bagh'. In the Raisinghnagar firing of the Dudhwa Khara movement, Birbal Singh died.

Peasant and tribal movements - where they happened



Peasants in the Mewar and Shekhawati belts; the Bhil risings in the far south

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2021 — the Neemuchana firing, which Gandhi condemned in Young India as 'double-dyed dyerism', took place in which state? Answer: Alwar. The troops were Maharaja Jai Singh's, on 14 May 1925.

YAAD RAKHO

Martyr-to-place: Rupaji and Kripaji = Begun. Nanakji Bhil = Dabi, Bundi. Birbal Singh = Raisinghnagar, Bikaner. Three names, three places — this is a direct matching set.

The tribal movements — Bhil, Eki, Meena, Mer

The tribal movements start earlier and are religious-reformist before they are political. Govind Giri — usually called Govind Guru — was born in 1858 at Bansiya, also given as Bedsa, in Dungarpur. In 1883 he founded the Samp Sabha, an organisation for the moral and social uplift of the Bhils. He preached 33 rules and lit a dhuni, a sacred fire, on Mangarh hill.

The Samp Sabha's followers were called Bhagats — so this is also known as the Bhagat movement. It grew into a demand for an end to forced labour and heavy levies, and the British read that as sedition.

On 17 November 1913, British forces under Major S. Bailey opened fire on the Bhils gathered on Mangarh hill, on the Banswara-Gujarat border. About 1,500 Bhils were killed. Mangarh is called the 'Adivasi Jallianwala Bagh' — and it happened six years BEFORE Jallianwala Bagh itself.

Mangarh – the whole event on one page

Govind Giri

born 1858, Dungarpur

33 rules and a dhuni

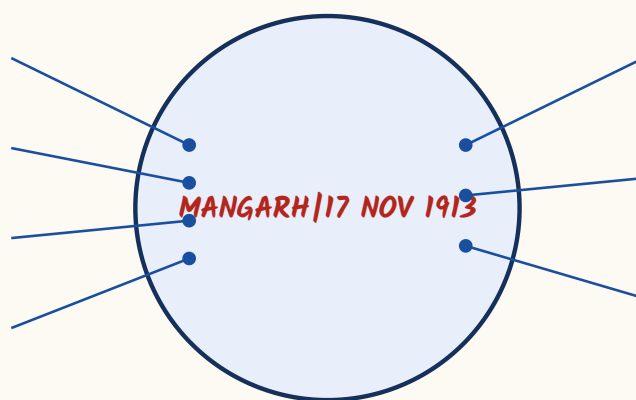
the sacred fire on the hill

About 1,500 Bhils

killed on the hill

Adivasi Jallianwala

six years before 1919



Samp Sabha

founded 1883; the Bhagats

Major S. Bailey

commanded the firing

On the border

Banswara and Gujarat

The second tribal movement is the Eki movement, also called the Bhomat movement. Its leader was Motilal Tejawat, an Oswal of Kolyari village in Jhadol, Udaipur state. He began in 1921. His slogan was 'Na Hakim, Na Hukum' — no officer, no order. The Bhils called him 'Bavji' and he is remembered as 'Adivasiyon ka Masiha'.

- Tejawat's charter of 21 demands was called 'Mewar ki Pukar'.
- The Neemda (Nimda) firing of 7 March 1922 broke the movement's back.
- The Palchitariya firing of 1923 finished it.
- Tejawat surrendered in 1929 on Gandhi's advice.

Tribal movements — movement, leader, place, year

Movement	Leader	Place	Year
Bhagat / Bhil movement — Samp Sabha	Govind Giri (Govind Guru)	Founded in Dungarpur; base at Mangarh hill	1883
Mangarh massacre	Govind Giri's followers; firing by Major S. Bailey	Mangarh, Banswara-Gujarat border	17 Nov 1913
Eki / Bhomat movement	Motilal Tejawat	Kolyari, Jhadol — Udaipur state	From 1921
Neemda firing	Motilal Tejawat's Bhils	Neemda, Mewar	7 Mar 1922

Movement	Leader	Place	Year
Meena movement	Meena Kshatriya Mahasabha	Jaipur state; Bagawas conference	1933; Bagawas 28 Oct 1946
Mer revolt	Suppressed by Colonel Hall	Merwara, Aravalli tract	1820-21

The Meena movement is a different kind of fight — a fight against a label. The Meenas were listed under the Criminal Tribes Act of 1924 and the Jaipur Jarayam Pesha Act of 1930, which forced them to report to the police. The Meena Kshatriya Mahasabha was formed in 1933 to resist this. At the Bagawas conference on 28 October 1946 about 26,000 Meena chowkidars resigned in protest. The Act was repealed in 1952.

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2023 — Motilal Tejawat, leader of the Eki movement, belonged to which community and village? Answer: an Oswal of Kolyari. The paired statement question adds the slogan 'Na Hakim, Na Hukum' and the Neemda firing of 1922.

TRAP

Two 'Jallianwala Bagh' labels, two different events. Dabi kand (Bundi, 2 Apr 1923, Nanakji Bhil) = 'Rajasthan ka Jallianwala Bagh'. Mangarh (17 Nov 1913) = 'Adivasi Jallianwala Bagh'.

TRAP

The Eki movement was NOT launched by the Mewar Prajamandal — the Prajamandal came only in 1938, seventeen years later. That false option appears in negative questions.

CURRENT LINK

Current link (as of September 2026): Mangarh Dham remains in the news. The Prime Minister described it as a national monument at a public event on 1 November 2022, but in August 2026 the Union Culture Ministry told Parliament that national monument status under the AMASR Act, 1958 could not be granted because modern construction at the site has removed its archaeological integrity. Mangarh is also central to Janjatiya Gaurav Diwas each 15 November.

CURRENT LINK

Current link (as of September 2026): the communities once listed under the Criminal Tribes Act are now called Denotified, Nomadic and Semi-Nomadic Tribes. The Union Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment runs the SEED scheme - the Scheme for Economic Empowerment of DNT communities, launched in 2022 - covering coaching, health insurance, livelihood and housing support. Pair it with the two dates from this chapter: the Jaipur Jarayam Peshwa Act of 1930 and the repeal of 1952.

REVISION RECAP

1. Six cantonments in 1857: Nasirabad, Neemuch, Erinpura, Deoli, Kherwara, Beawar — the last two stayed quiet.
2. Revolt begins Nasirabad, 28 May 1857; 15th and 30th Native Infantry march to Delhi.
3. Neemuch 3 June 1857; Erinpura 21 August 1857 — Jodhpur Legion, 'Chalo Delhi, Maro Firangi'.
4. Auwa: Thakur Khushal Singh Champawat; Bithoda 8 Sep, Chelawas 18 Sep 1857; Monck Mason killed.
5. Kota: 15 Oct 1857, Lala Jaidayal and Mehrab Khan; Major Burton killed; recovered by Gen. H.G. Roberts, March 1858.
6. AGG in 1857 was George Patrick Lawrence at Mount Abu; the princes stayed loyal.
7. Tantya Tope entered via Banswara-Pratapgarh; hanged at Sipri, 18 April 1859.
8. Bijolia 1897-1941 — longest peasant movement in India; Mewar thikana in Bhilwara district; 84 villages, 84 lag.

9. Bijolia chain: Nanji-Thakri Patel 1897, Sitaram Das 1913, Pathik 1916, Manikya Lal Verma, Upadhyaya-Bajaj 1927.
10. Vijay Singh Pathik = Bhoop Singh Gurjar; Rajasthan Seva Sangh, Wardha 1919; editor of Rajasthan Kesari.
11. Chanwari lag 1903 = marriage tax at Bijolia; Talwar Bandhai = succession levy.
12. Begun 1921-23, Ram Narayan Chaudhary; Rupaji-Kripaji killed at Govindpura 1923; 'Bolshevik Agreement'.
13. Dabi kand, Bundi, 2 April 1923 — Nanakji Bhil killed — 'Rajasthan ka Jallianwala Bagh'; leader Pt. Nayanuram Sharma.
14. Neemuchana, Alwar, 14 May 1925 — Gandhi's 'double-dyed dyerism' in Young India.
15. Sikarwati Jat Kisan Panchayat; Kudan kand 25 April 1935; Thakur Deshraj and the Jat Mahasabha.
16. Dudhwa Khara from 1946 in Bikaner — Kumbharam Arya; Birbal Singh died at Raisinghnagar. Dabra kand, Jodhpur, 13 Mar 1947.
17. Govind Giri, b. 1858 Dungarpur; Samp Sabha 1883; 33 rules; dhuni on Mangarh hill.
18. Mangarh massacre 17 Nov 1913, firing under Major S. Bailey, about 1,500 Bhils dead — 'Adivasi Jallianwala Bagh'.
19. Motilal Tejawat, Oswal of Kolyari (Jhadol); Eki/Bhomat from 1921; 'Na Hakim, Na Hukum'; 'Mewar ki Pukar' = 21 demands; Neemda firing 7 Mar 1922, Palchitariya 1923; surrendered 1929 on Gandhi's advice.
20. Meenas under Criminal Tribes Act 1924 and Jaipur Jarayam Pesha Act 1930; Mahasabha 1933; Bagawas 28 Oct 1946; repealed 1952.

RH09

Prajamandals, Press, Freedom Fighters & Integration of Rajasthan

About 2-3 questions a paper, more than any other chapter here. The integration sequence alone was asked in 2013, 2018, 2023 and 2024. Newspapers were asked in 2013, 2016, 2018, 2021 and 2024. Prajamandals in 2016 and 2023.

This is the single highest-yield chapter in Rajasthan History. It has three examinable blocks — which Prajamandal was founded where and by whom, which newspaper was edited by whom, and the seven stages by which twenty-two units became one Rajasthan. All three are pure matching. All three come back paper after paper.

Freedom Movement & Integration

Umbrella bodies

- Rajputana Madhya Bharat Sabha 1918
- Rajasthan Seva Sangh 1919
- AISPC 1927
- Deshi Rajya Lok Parishad 1931

Revolutionaries

- Arjun Lal Sethi
- Kesari Singh Barhath
- Jorawar Singh Barhath
- Pratap Singh Barhath
- Rao Gopal Singh Kharwa

Prajamandals

- Jaipur 1931 — first
- Marwar 1934
- Bikaner 1936
- Mewar 1938
- Sirohi 1939
- Dungarpur 1944

Gandhians

- Jai Narayan Vyas
- Manikya Lal Verma
- Gokul Bhai Bhatt
- Heera Lal Shastri
- Bhogilal Pandya

Press

- Mazahrul-Saroor 1849
- Rajasthan Kesari 1920
- Naveen Rajasthan 1922
- Tyag Bhumi 1927
- Agnibaan

Integration — 7 stages

- Matsya 18 Mar 1948
- Rajasthan Union 25 Mar 1948
- Sanyukt 18 Apr 1948
- Vrihad 30 Mar 1949
- Sanyukt Vrihad 15 May 1949
- Rajasthan 26 Jan 1950
- Punargathit 1 Nov 1956

What a Prajamandal was — get the idea before the list

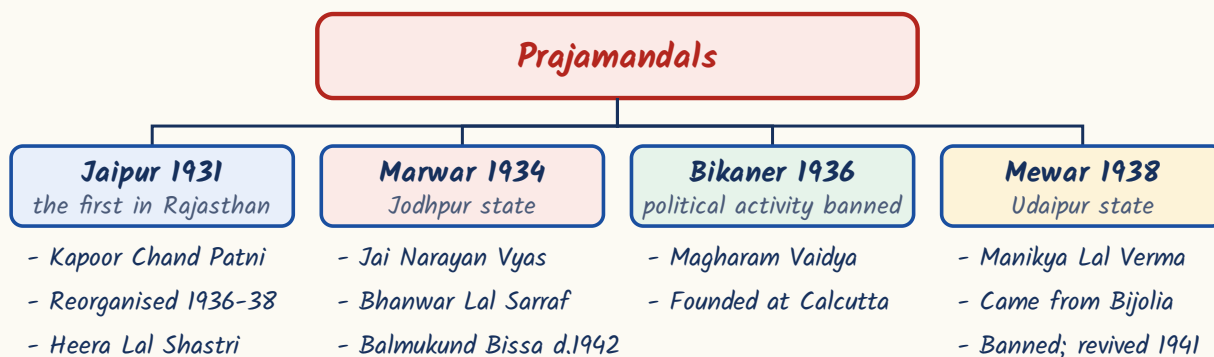
The Congress worked in British India. It did not, as a rule, agitate inside princely states. So the people of Jaipur, Jodhpur, Udaipur and the rest needed their own organisation. That organisation is the Prajamandal — literally 'people's circle'.

A Prajamandal asked for responsible government under the ruler, civil liberties, and an end to feudal levies. It was usually banned, its leaders jailed, and it revived. Its work fed straight into the integration of 1948-49 — the same men who led Prajamandals became the first Prime Ministers of the unions.

- Jaipur Prajamandal (1931) is the FIRST Prajamandal of Rajasthan.
- Founder: Kapoor Chand Patni.
- It was reorganised in 1936-38 under Heera Lal Shastri, with Jamnalal Bajaj's backing.
- Bundi's Prajamandal was also founded in 1931 — but Jaipur is the answer to 'first'.

Two founders you must not swap. Mewar's Prajamandal (1938) was founded by Manikya Lal Verma — the same man who came out of Bijolia. Marwar's (1934) is associated with Jai Narayan Vyas along with Bhanwar Lal Sarraf. Bikaner's (1936) was founded by Magharam Vaidya, and here is the detail RPSC likes: it had to be founded OUTSIDE the state, at Calcutta, because Bikaner banned political activity.

The four Prajamandals RPSC keeps asking



Prajamandal, founder, year — the full state-by-state table

Learn this in two halves. The 1930s half contains the big states and gets asked most. The 1940s half is thinner and mostly matters for Dungarpur and Jaisalmer.

Prajamandals, part I — 1931 to 1938

State	Year	Founder / leading name
Jaipur	1931	Kapoor Chand Patni (first in Rajasthan); reorganised by Heera Lal Shastri
Bundi	1931	Kantilal, Rishidutt Mehta
Marwar (Jodhpur)	1934	Jai Narayan Vyas, Bhanwar Lal Sarraf
Bikaner	1936	Magharam Vaidya — founded at Calcutta
Dholpur	1936	—
Mewar (Udaipur)	1938	Manikya Lal Verma
Alwar	1938	Hari Narayan Sharma
Bharatpur	1938	Gopilal Yadav
Karauli	1938	—
Shahpura	1938	Ramesh Chandra Ojha, Laduram Vyas

Prajamandals, part 2 — 1939 to 1946

State	Year	Founder / leading name
Kishangarh	1939	—
Sirohi	1939	Gokul Bhai Bhatt — 'the Gandhi of Rajasthan'
Kota	1939	Pandit Nayanuram Sharma
Banswara	1943	—
Dungarpur	1944	Bhogilal Pandya
Jaisalmer	1945	Mithalal Vyas
Pratapgarh	1945	—
Jhalawar	1946	—

Some of the Marwar detail is separately examinable. The Marwar Hitkarini Sabha was set up in 1938 and later became the Marwar Lok Parishad. Balmukund Bissa died in jail in 1942 during the Marwar agitation.

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2023 as a match-the-following — Prajamandal to leader. The four names that recur are Kapoor Chand Patni (Jaipur), Jai Narayan Vyas (Marwar), Manikya Lal Verma (Mewar), Magharam Vaidya (Bikaner).

TRAP

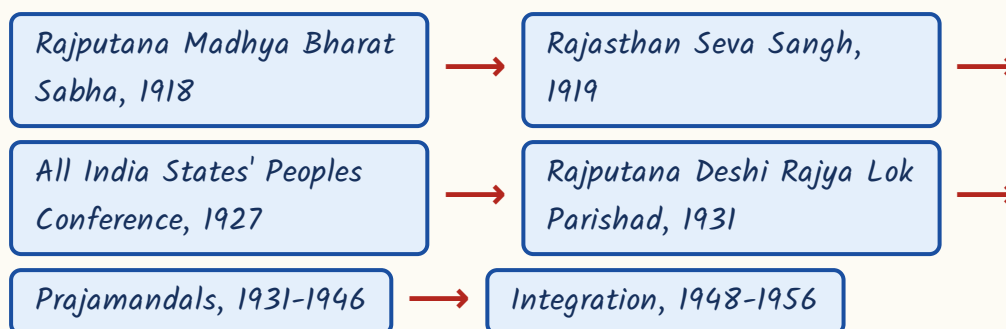
'Kota - Manikya Lal Verma' is a classic wrong pair. Kota's Prajamandal is Pandit Nayanuram Sharma. Manikya Lal Verma belongs to Mewar.

Two nicknames will fetch you two states for free. Gokul Bhai Bhatt is 'the Gandhi of Rajasthan' and he means Sirohi. Bhogilal Pandya is the builder of tribal education in the Vagad region and he means Dungarpur.

The umbrella bodies — how the movement organised itself

Before the Prajamandals there were regional and all-India bodies that gave the princely-state movements a platform. Learn them as a chain, because their years run in a neat sequence.

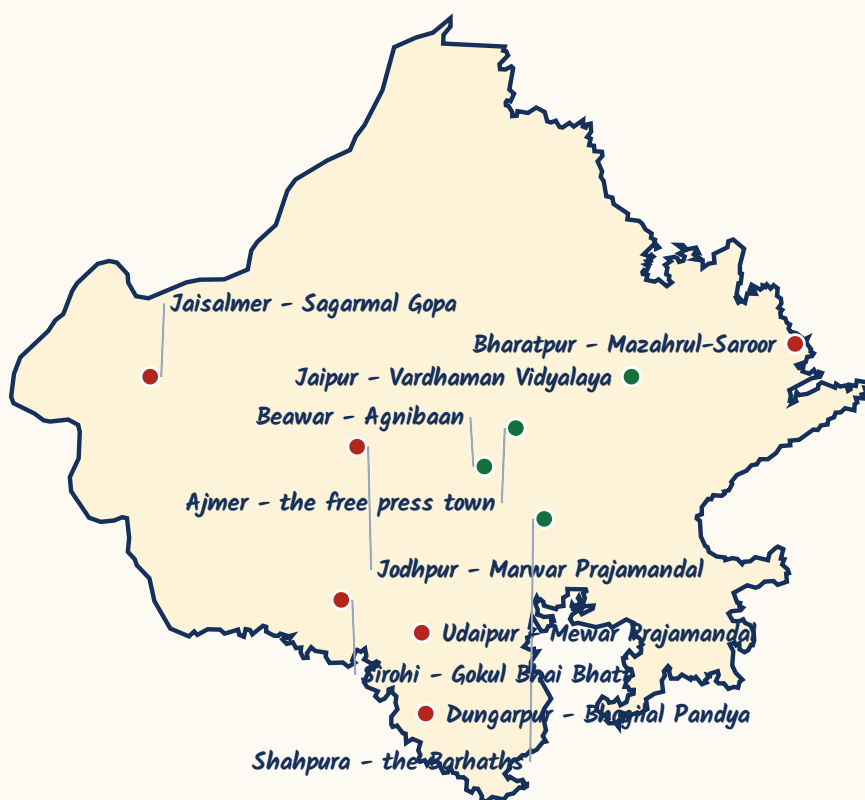
How the movement built itself up



- Rajputana Madhya Bharat Sabha — 1918, formed at the Delhi session of the Congress under Jamnalal Bajaj's lead; headquarters Ajmer.
- Rajasthan Seva Sangh — founded 1919 at Wardha by Vijay Singh Pathik; shifted to Ajmer in 1920.
- All India States' Peoples Conference — founded 1927 at Bombay; Vijay Singh Pathik was among its office-bearers.
- Nehru presided over the AISPC's Ludhiana session of 1939.
- Rajputana Deshi Rajya Lok Parishad — first session at Ajmer, 1931, presided over by Ram Narayan Chaudhary.

Notice how often Ajmer appears. Ajmer was British territory, so political work was legal there. That is why the Seva Sangh moved to Ajmer, why the Madhya Bharat Sabha was headquartered there, and why Rajasthan's nationalist press was printed there.

Where the movement had its addresses



Ajmer was British soil, so the press and the sabhas could work there openly

The press — newspaper, editor, place, year

RPSC has asked a newspaper question in almost every recent paper. The trick is that three or four papers share the same two or three editors, so you must learn the pairs, not just the names.

Newspapers of the Rajasthan freedom movement

Newspaper	Editor / founder	Place	Year
Mazahrul-Saroor	—	Bharatpur	1849 — earliest newspaper of Rajasthan
Rajputana Gazette	Maulvi Murad Ali	Ajmer	1885
Rajasthan Kesari	Vijay Singh Pathik (financed by Jamnalal Bajaj)	Wardha	1920

Newspaper	Editor / founder	Place	Year
Naveen Rajasthan	Vijay Singh Pathik — organ of the Rajasthan Seva Sangh	Ajmer	1922
Tarun Rajasthan	Ram Narayan Chaudhary, Jai Narayan Vyas	Ajmer	1923
Tyag Bhumi	Haribhau Upadhyaya	Ajmer	1927
Agnibaan	Jai Narayan Vyas	Beawar	—
Akhand Bharat	Jai Narayan Vyas	Bombay	1938
Pratap	Ganesh Shankar Vidyarthi	Kanpur	Carried the Bijolia cause

Tyag Bhumi is the most examinable of these. It was the most influential nationalist weekly of Rajasthan, and its editor Haribhau Upadhyaya later became Chief Minister of Ajmer state, from 1952 to 1956.

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2024 — who was the editor of 'Tyag Bhumi'? Answer: Haribhau Upadhyaya. The linked statement question adds that it began in 1927 and that Upadhyaya became Chief Minister of Ajmer state.

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2018 — 'Mazahrul-Saroor', regarded as the earliest newspaper of Rajasthan, was published from? Answer: Bharatpur, 1849.

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2021 as a match-the-following on newspapers and editors. The safest anchors are Tyag Bhumi-Upadhyaya, Naveen Rajasthan-Pathik, Agnibaan-Jai Narayan Vyas, Rajputana Gazette-Maulvi Murad Ali.

Here is the false pair RPSC plants. Jai Narayan Vyas published Agnibaan, Akhand Bharat and Tarun Rajasthan. He did NOT publish Tyag Bhumi — that is Haribhau Upadhyaya. 'Which newspaper was NOT published by Jai Narayan Vyas' is a live question and Tyag Bhumi is the answer.

Pathik's two papers are both 'Rajasthan' papers — Rajasthan Kesari (Wardha, 1920) and Naveen Rajasthan (Ajmer, 1922). Kesari came first and from Wardha, the same place where he had founded the Rajasthan Seva Sangh a year earlier. That link between the man, the town and the year is worth memorising as a unit.

Which editor, which paper



The revolutionaries — Sethi and the Barhaths

Rajasthan also had an armed revolutionary strand, centred on Shahpura and Jaipur, and linked to the Delhi and Banaras conspiracies. It is a small group of names, so learn each one with the single act that fixes it.

- Arjun Lal Sethi — founded the Vardhaman Vidyalaya at Jaipur in 1907, and the Jain Shiksha Prachark Samiti.
- Kesari Singh Barhath of Shahpura — wrote 'Chetavani ra Chungatya' (1903), thirteen sorthas urging Maharana Fateh Singh to boycott the Delhi Durbar.
- Kesari Singh also founded the Veer Bharat Sabha and was jailed at Hazaribagh.
- Jorawar Singh Barhath — took part in the bomb attack on Viceroy Lord Hardinge in Delhi, 23 December 1912.
- Pratap Singh Barhath — died of torture in Bareilly Central Jail.
- Rao Gopal Singh Kharwa — a leading revolutionary figure of Ajmer-Merwara.
- Sagarmal Gopa of Jaisalmer — wrote 'Jaisalmer ka Gundaraj' and 'Azadi ke Diwane'; died in jail on 4 April 1946.

YAAD RAKHO

Three Barhaths, three fates: Kesari Singh wrote (Chetavani ra Chungatya), Jorawar Singh bombed (Hardinge, 1912), Pratap Singh died (Bareilly jail).
Father, brother, son — write, bomb, die.

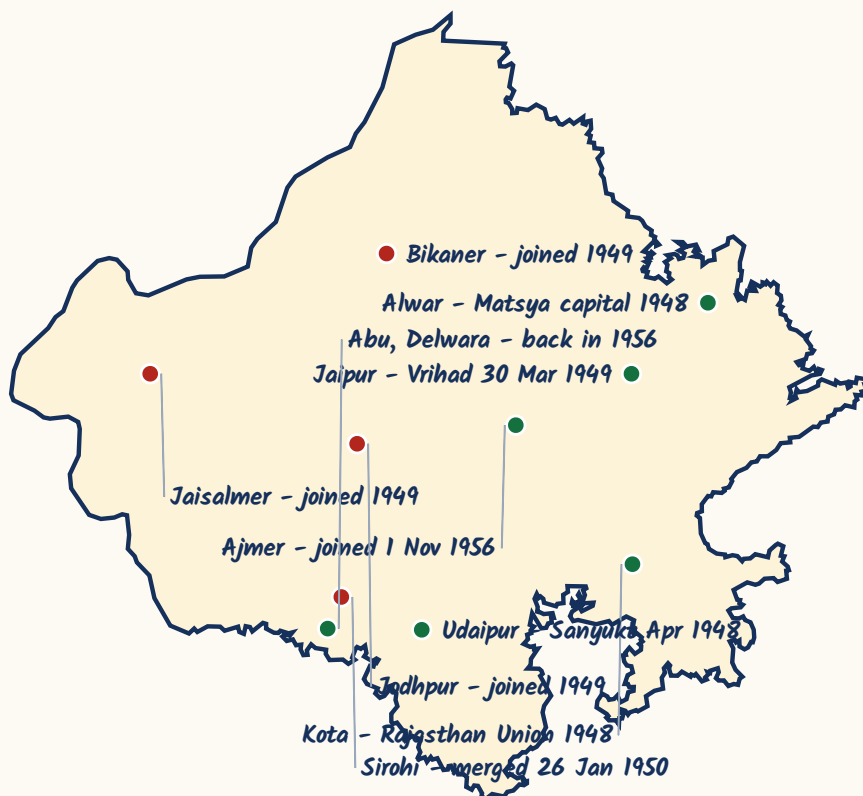
Alongside them stood the Gandhian leaders — Gokul Bhai Bhatt of Sirohi, called 'the Gandhi of Rajasthan'; Jai Narayan Vyas of Marwar; Heera Lal Shastri of Jaipur; Balwant Singh Mehta and Manikya Lal Verma of Mewar; Gokul Lal Asawa of Shahpura; and Ram Narayan Chaudhary. And the women: Ratan Devi and Anjana Devi Chaudhary of the Bijolia and Begun movements, Kishori Devi, Narayani Devi Verma, Rama Devi and Nagendra Bala.

Integration — the seven stages, in order, with dates

This is the most asked single item in Rajasthan History. RPSC does not ask you what happened at each stage. It asks you to put the stages in order, or to match a stage to its Rajpramukh or its Prime Minister. So learn the sequence as a sequence.

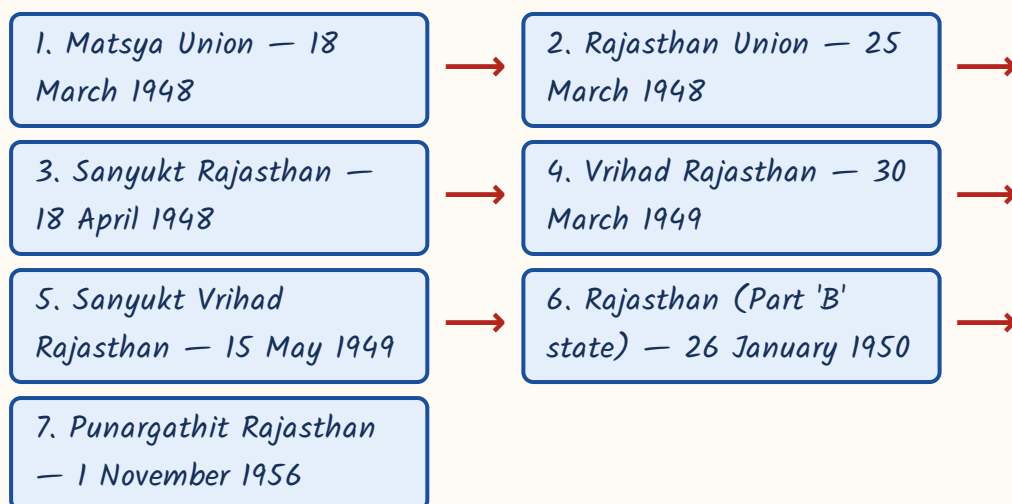
The logic is simple: the small eastern states merged first, the big states last, and Ajmer last of all. Three unions formed in 1948, two mergers in 1949, statehood in 1950, and the final shape in 1956.

Integration on the map - east first, Ajmer last



Sironj went the other way, out to Madhya Pradesh, in the same reorganisation

The seven stages of the integration of Rajasthan



Stage by stage — what joined, who headed it

Stage & date	What joined	Rajpramukh	Prime Minister / note
1. Matsya Union, 18 Mar 1948	Alwar, Bharatpur, Dholpur, Karauli + Neemrana chiefship. Capital Alwar	Udaybhan Singh of Dholpur	Shobha Ram; inaugurated by N.V. Gadgil
2. Rajasthan Union, 25 Mar 1948	Kota, Bundi, Tonk, Jhalawar, Dungarpur, Banswara, Pratapgarh, Kishangarh, Shahpura + Kushalgarh. Capital Kota	Bhim Singh of Kota	Gokul Lal Asawa
3. Sanyukt Rajasthan, 18 Apr 1948	Udaipur joined. Capital Udaipur	Maharana Bhupal Singh	Manikya Lal Verma; inaugurated by Jawaharlal Nehru
4. Vrihad Rajasthan, 30 Mar 1949	Jaipur, Jodhpur, Bikaner, Jaisalmer joined. Capital Jaipur	Sawai Man Singh II; Maharajpramukh Bhupal Singh	Heera Lal Shastri; inaugurated by Sardar Patel
5. Sanyukt Vrihad Rajasthan, 15 May 1949	Matsya Union merged in	Sawai Man Singh II	On the Shankar Rao Deo committee's recommendation
6. Rajasthan, 26 Jan 1950	Sirohi merged; Abu and Delwara went to Bombay. Part 'B' state	Sawai Man Singh II	Heera Lal Shastri becomes first Chief Minister

Stage & date	What joined	Rajpramukh	Prime Minister / note
7. Punargathit Rajasthan, 1 Nov 1956	Ajmer-Merwara, Abu Road and Delwara added; Sunel Tappa gained; Sironj lost to MP	Rajpramukh abolished by the 7th Amendment	Gurumukh Nihal Singh first Governor; Mohan Lal Sukhadia CM

YAAD RAKHO

Two chants. Dates: 18-3-48, 25-3-48, 18-4-48, 30-3-49, 15-5-49, 26-1-50, 1-11-56 — three in 1948, two in 1949, Republic Day 1950, reorganisation 1956. Prime Ministers in the same order: Shobha Ram, Gokul Lal Asawa, Manikya Lal Verma, Heera Lal Shastri — 'SGMH', and the last of them becomes the first Chief Minister.

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2024 — the Matsya Union, the first stage in the integration of Rajasthan, was formed on? Answer: 18 March 1948.

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2023 — who was the Prime Minister of the Matsya Union? Answer: Shobha Ram.

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2018 and again in 2024 as an ordering question — arrange the stages of integration. The order is Matsya Union, Rajasthan Union, Sanyukt Rajasthan, Vrihad Rajasthan.

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2024 — who was the first and only Rajpramukh of Rajasthan? Answer: Sawai Man Singh II of Jaipur.

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2023 — Rajasthan's present shape was completed on 1 November 1956, when the first Governor took charge. Who was he? Answer: Gurumukh Nihal Singh.

The two 1948 unions — do not mix them up

Stage 1 and Stage 2 are one week apart and both are called unions. Every year a question exploits that. Fix them side by side once and you will never lose the mark.

Matsya Union vs Rajasthan Union

Matsya Union — 18 Mar 1948	Rajasthan Union — 25 Mar 1948
Alwar, Bharatpur, Dholpur, Karauli	Kota, Bundi, Tonk, Jhalawar, Dungarpur, Banswara, Pratapgarh, Kishangarh, Shahpura
Plus the Neemrana chiefship	Plus the Kushalgarh chiefship
Capital: Alwar	Capital: Kota
Rajpramukh: Udaybhan Singh of Dholpur	Rajpramukh: Bhim Singh of Kota
PM: Shobha Ram	PM: Gokul Lal Asawa
Inaugurated by N.V. Gadgil	Merged into Sanyukt Rajasthan a month later
Stayed separate till 15 May 1949	Absorbed Udaipur on 18 Apr 1948

Two riders. Kishangarh sat in the RAJASTHAN Union, not the Matsya Union — 'which was NOT a constituent of the Matsya Union' is a live question and Kishangarh is the answer. And the name Matsya comes from the ancient Matsya janapada of that eastern tract, not from any modern district.

Loose ends of integration — units, capital, Rajpramukh, Sironj

A handful of separate facts hang off the integration story, and each one has been made into a question.

- Rajasthan was formed out of 19 princely states, 3 chiefships — Neemrana, Kushalgarh and Lava — and the Chief Commissioner's province of Ajmer-Merwara.
- Sawai Man Singh II of Jaipur was the first and the ONLY Rajpramukh of Rajasthan.
- The office of Rajpramukh was abolished by the 7th Constitutional Amendment in 1956.
- V.P. Menon, Secretary of the States Ministry, executed the mergers under Sardar Patel.
- The capital question was settled in favour of Jaipur on the recommendation of a committee headed by B.R. Patel.
- Sirohi was split — Abu and Delwara first went to Bombay in 1950 and came back to Rajasthan only in 1956.
- Sironj went OUT of Rajasthan to Madhya Pradesh in 1956; Sunel Tappa came IN.

TRAP

In and out on 1 November 1956: Ajmer-Merwara IN, Abu Road IN, Delwara IN, Sunel Tappa IN — Sironj OUT. If a question asks what did NOT become part of Rajasthan in 1956, the answer is Sironj.

TRAP

Heera Lal Shastri was Prime Minister of Vrihad Rajasthan and then the first Chief Minister of Rajasthan. He was never Governor. Bhupal Singh of Mewar was Maharajpramukh, never the second Rajpramukh — there was no second Rajpramukh.

CURRENT LINK

Current link (as of September 2026): Rajasthan Diwas is no longer fixed to 30 March. From 2025 the state government observes it on Chaitra Shukla Pratipada, the Hindu new year; in 2025 the two coincided on 30 March, and in 2026 it was observed on 19 March. The historical fact is unchanged — Vrihad Rajasthan was formed on 30 March 1949. Read the question carefully: 'formation date' is 30 March 1949, 'celebration date' now moves each year.

CURRENT LINK

Current link (as of September 2026): 1 November 2026 completes seventy years of the States Reorganisation Act, 1956, and therefore of Rajasthan's present boundary. The Act came out of the States Reorganisation Commission under Fazl Ali, which reported in 1955; the same Act abolished the Part A, B and C classification and, through the 7th Constitutional Amendment, the office of Rajpramukh. Anniversary years are exactly when RPSC returns to a settled fact, so keep 1 November 1956, Gurumukh Nihal Singh and the 7th Amendment together.

REVISION RECAP

1. Jaipur Prajamandal 1931, Kapoor Chand Patni — first in Rajasthan; reorganised 1936–38 by Heera Lal Shastri.
2. Marwar 1934 — Jai Narayan Vyas and Bhanwar Lal Sarraf; Marwar Hitkarini Sabha 1938; Balmukund Bissa died in jail 1942.
3. Bikaner 1936 — Magharam Vaidya, founded at Calcutta because of the ban at home.

4. Mewar 1938 — Manikya Lal Verma, banned and revived 1941; Sirohi 1939 — Gokul Bhai Bhatt; Kota 1939 — Nayanuram Sharma; Dungarpur 1944 — Bhogilal Pandya; Jaisalmer 1945 — Mithalal Vyas.
5. Rajputana Madhya Bharat Sabha 1918 (Delhi session, Jamnalal Bajaj, HQ Ajmer); Rajasthan Seva Sangh 1919 Wardha (Pathik).
6. AISPCC 1927 Bombay; Nehru presided at Ludhiana 1939. Deshi Rajya Lok Parishad first session Ajmer 1931, Ram Narayan Chaudhary.
7. Mazahrul-Saroor, Bharatpur 1849 — earliest newspaper of Rajasthan; Rajputana Gazette, Ajmer 1885, Maulvi Murad Ali.
8. Pathik's papers: Rajasthan Kesari (Wardha 1920), Naveen Rajasthan (Ajmer 1922, organ of Seva Sangh).
9. Tyag Bhumi 1927, Haribhau Upadhyaya — later CM of Ajmer state 1952-56. Vyas's papers: Agnibaan, Akhand Bharat, Tarun Rajasthan.
10. Arjun Lal Sethi — Vardhaman Vidyalaya, Jaipur, 1907. Kesari Singh Barhath — 'Chetavani ra Chungatya' 1903, 13 sorthas, Veer Bharat Sabha, jailed at Hazaribagh.
11. Jorawar Singh Barhath — Hardinge bomb attack, Delhi, 23 Dec 1912; Pratap Singh Barhath died in Bareilly jail. Women: Ratan Devi, Anjana Devi Chaudhary, Kishori Devi, Narayani Devi Verma, Nagendra Bala.
12. Sagarmal Gopa of Jaisalmer — 'Jaisalmer ka Gundaraj', died in jail 4 April 1946; Rao Gopal Singh Kharwa of Ajmer-Merwara.
13. Seven stages: 18-3-48 Matsya, 25-3-48 Rajasthan Union, 18-4-48 Sanyukt, 30-3-49 Vrihad, 15-5-49 Sanyukt Vrihad, 26-1-50 Rajasthan, 1-11-56 Punargathit.
14. PMs in order: Shobha Ram, Gokul Lal Asawa, Manikya Lal Verma, Heera Lal Shastri.
15. Rajpramukhs of the unions: Udaybhan Singh (Matsya), Bhim Singh (Rajasthan Union), Bhupal Singh (Sanyukt), Sawai Man Singh II (Vrihad onward).
16. Vrihad Rajasthan inaugurated by Sardar Patel, 30 March 1949 — the historical Rajasthan Day; Sanyukt Rajasthan by Nehru; Matsya Union by N.V. Gadgil.
17. Matsya merger 15 May 1949 on the Shankar Rao Deo committee's recommendation; Sirohi merged 26 Jan 1950, Abu and Delwara going to Bombay.
18. 1 Nov 1956: Ajmer-Merwara, Abu Road, Delwara and Sunel Tappa in; Sironj out to MP; Rajpramukh abolished by the 7th Amendment.
19. 19 princely states + 3 chiefships (Neemrana, Kushalgarh, Lava) + Ajmer-Merwara = Rajasthan. Capital Jaipur on the B.R. Patel committee's advice.
20. Sawai Man Singh II — first and only Rajpramukh; Gurumukh Nihal Singh — first Governor; Heera Lal Shastri — first Chief Minister.

RH10

Architecture: Forts, Palaces, Temples, Havelis, Stepwells

About 2-3 questions a paper. In 2023 alone two questions came out of fort typology. Expect at least one match-the-following and one NOT-correctly-matched.

This is the biggest pure-matching chapter in Rajasthan Art and Culture. Fort to type, fort to builder, fort to district, temple to place, stepwell to town — RPSC asks it as List-I / List-II almost every year. You are not learning architecture here. You are learning pairs.

Architecture of Rajasthan

Fort types

- Giri - Chittorgarh
- Jal - Gagron
- Dhanva - Jaisalmer
- Van - forest belt
- Eran - Chambal ravines
- Parikh - Lohagarh
- Sahay / Sainya

UNESCO Hill Forts 2013

- Chittorgarh
- Kumbhalgarh
- Ranthambore
- Amber
- Jaisalmer
- Gagron

Other UNESCO sites

- Keoladeo 1985
- Jantar Mantar 2010
- Walled City Jaipur 2019

Palaces

- Hawa Mahal - Pratap Singh
- Umaid Bhawan - Umaid Singh
- Lalgarh - Ganga Singh
- Jal Mahal - Man Sagar lake

Temples

- Dilwara - Mount Abu
- Ranakpur - Pali
- Osian - Jodhpur
- Kiradu - Barmer
- Jagat - Udaipur
- Rajorgarh - Alwar

Water & memory

- Chand Baori Abhaneri
- Raniji ki Baori Bundi
- Toorji ka Jhalra
- Panna Meena Amber
- Gaitor chhatris
- Jaswant Thada

Havelis

- Patwon ki Haveli
- Nathmal ki Haveli
- Salim Singh ki Haveli
- Shekhawati painted havelis

Start with typology — this is where the marks are

The old texts on statecraft, the Shukraniti and Manu, classify a fort by what protects it. Not by who built it. Not by how big it is. By the natural defence around it. RPSC lifts this classification straight out of the textbook and asks you to match a fort to its type. Learn the eight names first, then hang one Rajasthan example on each.

Fort typology and the standard Rajasthan example

Type	What protects it	Standard example
Giri durg	A hill	Chittorgarh, Kumbhalgarh, Ranthambore
Jal / audak durg	Water on the flanks	Gagron (Jhalawar)
Dhanva / marusthaliya durg	Desert	Jaisalmer
Van / aranya durg	Forest and thorn scrub	Forest forts of the Aravalli belt
Eran durg	Ravines and broken land	Chambal ravine country, Bhainsrorgarh side
Parikh durg	A dug moat	Lohagarh (Bharatpur), Junagarh (Bikaner)
Sahay durg	Loyal allies around it	-
Sainya durg	A standing army	-

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2023 — Gagron Fort of Jhalawar is classified as which type of fort? Answer: jal durg. It stands where the Kali Sindh meets the Ahu, so water guards it on three sides. Two more Gagron one-liners: it was built by Bijaldev Dod, it is said to rest on rock with no laid foundation, and it saw two sakas, in 1423 and 1444. The dargah of the Sufi saint Mitthe Shah lies just below the fort.

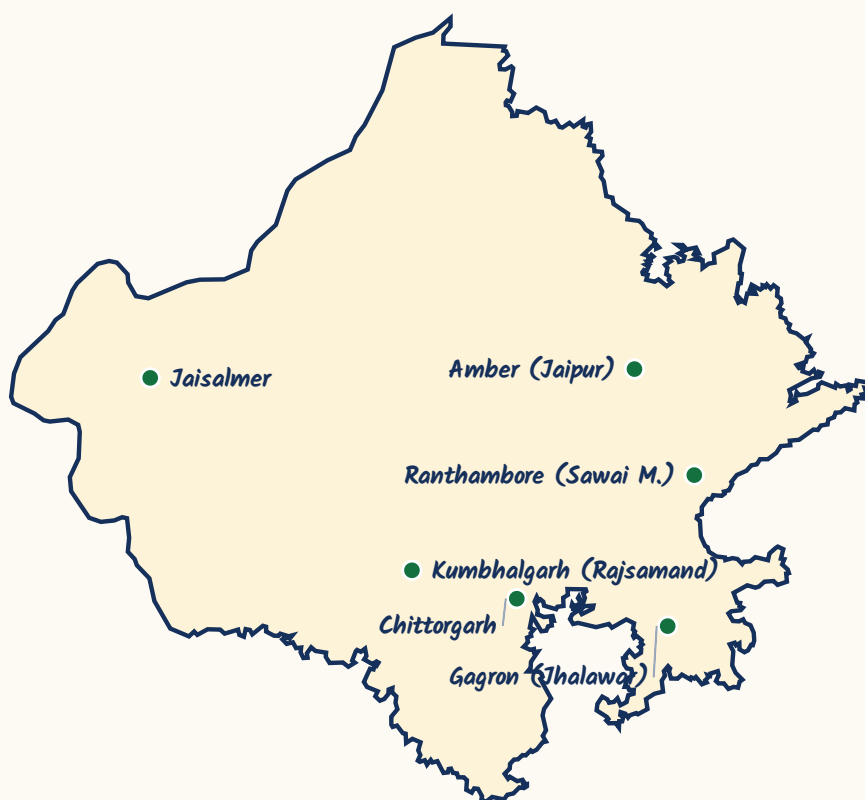
TRAP

Do not write Ranthambore as a jal durg. RAS Pre 2023 asked the NOT-correctly-matched version and Ranthambore was the wrong pair — it sits on an isolated hill where the Aravalli meets the Vindhyas, so it is a giri durg. Also keep the water pair straight: jal means a river on the flanks (Gagron), parikh means a dug moat (Lohagarh).

The six UNESCO Hill Forts, and Rajasthan's four World Heritage properties

In 2013, at the 37th session of the World Heritage Committee, UNESCO inscribed six Rajasthan forts as a single serial property called the Hill Forts of Rajasthan. Serial property means one listing, six components. Learn all six by name and district. Coaching lists keep adding a seventh fort to confuse you — there are exactly six.

The six UNESCO Hill Forts of Rajasthan (2013)

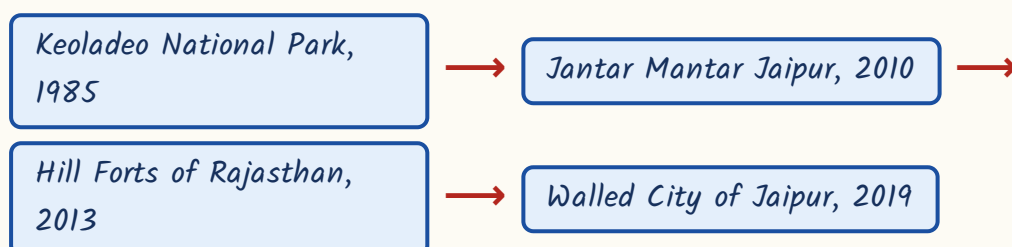


Five are giri durg; Gagron alone is a jal durg. Bhainsrorgarh is NOT in the list.

The six Hill Forts of Rajasthan (UNESCO 2013)

Fort	District	Key builder / founder
Chittorgarh	Chittorgarh	Mori ruler Chitrangada (founder)
Kumbhalgarh	Rajsamand	Rana Kumbha, 1443-58
Ranthambore	Sawai Madhopur	Chauhan-period hill fort
Amber	Jaipur	Raja Man Singh I, present form from 1592
Jaisalmer	Jaisalmer	Rawal Jaisal, 1156
Gagron	Jhalawar	Bijaldev Dod

Rajasthan's four UNESCO World Heritage properties, in order of inscription



YAAD RAKHO

Mnemonic for the six: CH-K-R-A-J-G — CHittor, Kumbhalgarh, Ranthambore, Amber, Jaisalmer, Gagron. Read it as CHAKRA-JG. Five are giri; Gagron is the odd jal durg inside a list called Hill Forts. And remember what is NOT in it — Bhainsrorgarh, in Chittorgarh district at the Chambal-Bamani confluence, called the Vellore of Rajasthan, is the tempting fourth option RPSC plants.

CURRENT LINK

Current link (as of September 2026): the Rock Art Sites of the Chambal Valley were added to India's UNESCO Tentative List on 8 February 2024. The property spans Madhya Pradesh and Rajasthan, and its Rajasthan clusters lie in Jhalawar, Bhilwara, Chittorgarh and Kota districts. Remember the word tentative — it is a candidate, not an inscribed site.

CURRENT LINK

Current link (as of September 2026): India hosted the World Heritage Committee for the first time when its 46th session met in New Delhi from 21 to 31 July 2024. No Rajasthan property was inscribed at that session, so the state's count stays at four - Keoladeo 1985, Jantar Mantar 2010, the Hill Forts 2013 and the Walled City of Jaipur 2019. Of these only the Hill Forts are a serial property, and only they are a cultural landscape spread across six districts.

Chittorgarh and Kumbhalgarh — the two forts RPSC never leaves alone

Chittorgarh is the largest fort of India by area. It stands on the Mesa plateau and was founded by the Mori ruler Chitrangada. Its fame rests on three sakas — the women's mass self-immolation followed by the men riding out to die. Learn the three dates with the three attackers as a sequence; ordering questions come from here.

The three sakas of Chittorgarh



Vijay Stambh vs Kirti Stambh — the confusion RPSC exploits

Vijay Stambh	Kirti Stambh
Raised by Rana Kumbha, completed 1448	12th century, raised by the Bagherwal merchant Jija
Nine storeys, 37.19 m	Seven storeys, about 22 m
Marks victory over Mahmud Khilji of Malwa at Sarangpur, 1437	A Jain tower dedicated to Adinath
Architect Sutradhar Jaita with sons Napa, Puja and Poma	Not a Kumbha structure at all

ASKED IN RAS

Repeatedly asked — whose victory does the Vijay Stambh commemorate?

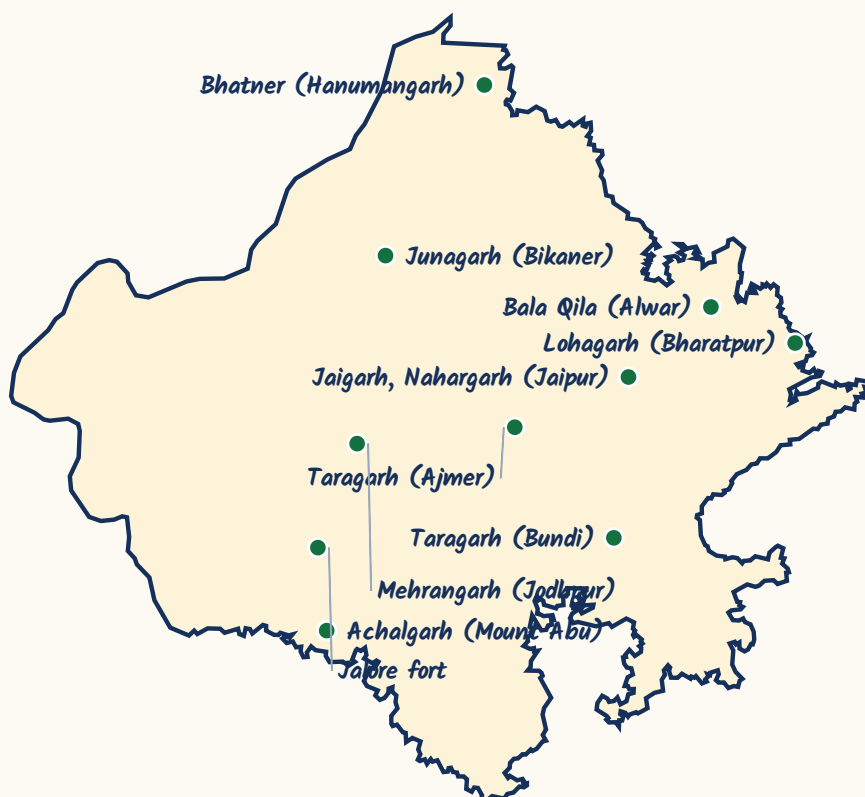
Answer: Rana Kumbha's victory over Mahmud Khilji of Malwa at Sarangpur, 1437. The tower is also the emblem of the Rajasthan Police. A second question shape asks for its architect: Sutradhar Jaita.

Kumbhalgarh is Rana Kumbha's own creation, built between 1443 and 1458 by his chief architect Mandan. Its perimeter wall runs about 36 km, which is why it is called the Great Wall of India. The innermost citadel is Katargarh. Maharana Pratap was born here. The fort fell only once, in 1578, to the Mughal general Shahbaz Khan. Keep the two architects apart: Mandan built Kumbhalgarh and wrote Prasad Mandan, Rajvallabh Mandan and Devata Murti Prakaran; Sutradhar Jaita built the Vijay Stambh.

The rest of the forts — builder, place, one identifying tag

For every remaining fort you need three things: who built it, which district it is in, and the one detail that identifies it in an option. Nothing more. Read the table across, not down.

Other major forts and their districts



Two Taragarhs — Ajmer in the centre, Bundi in Hadoti. Bhatner is the northernmost.

Fort to builder to district (set 1)

Fort	Builder / year	District & identifying tag
Jaisalmer (Sonar Quila)	Rawal Jaisal, 1156	Jaisalmer; Trikuta hill, 99 bastions, a living fort, yellow sandstone without lime mortar
Mehrangarh	Rao Jodha, 1459	Jodhpur; Chidiyatunk hill, Lohapol, Phool Mahal, Moti Mahal
Junagarh	Raja Rai Singh, 1589-94	Bikaner; supervised by Karan Chand, a plains fort not a hill fort
Amber	Raja Man Singh I, from 1592	Jaipur; Sheesh Mahal, Ganesh Pol, Diwan-i-Aam, Jagat Shiromani temple
Jaigarh	Sawai Jai Singh II, 1726	Jaipur; Chel ka Teela, the Jaivana cannon, Asia's largest cannon foundry
Nahargarh	Sawai Jai Singh II, 1734	Jaipur; first named Sudarshangarh, Madhavendra Bhawan added by Sawai Madho Singh II
Lohagarh	Maharaja Suraj Mal, 1733	Bharatpur; moat fort the British failed to take in 1805, Jawahar Burj and Fateh Burj

Fort to builder to district (set 2)

Fort	Builder / event	District & identifying tag
Bhatner	Bhupat, son of Bhati Jaisal	Hanumangarh; oldest fort of Rajasthan, on the Ghaggar, town renamed Hanumangarh in 1805
Taragarh (Garh Beetli)	Ajayaraja Chauhan	Ajmer; the Gibraltar of Rajasthan
Taragarh, Bundi	Rao Bar Singh Hada	Bundi; a separate fort of the same name
Achalgarh	Paramara fort rebuilt by Rana Kumbha, 1452	Sirohi, on Mount Abu; Achaleshwar Mahadev temple
Jalore (Sonagir / Swarnagiri / Kanchangiri)	Fell to Alauddin Khilji, 1311	Jalore; Kanhaddev's defence told in Padmanabh's Kanhadde Prabandh
Siwana	Veer Narayan Panwar	Barmer; saka of Sataldev
Shergarh	Renovated by Sher Shah Suri	Baran, on the Parwan river; another Shergarh lies in Dholpur

Fort	Builder / event	District & identifying tag
Bhainsrorgarh	Water-girt fort	Chittorgarh; Chambal-Bamani confluence, the Vellore of Rajasthan
Bala Qila	Alwar's hill fort	Alwar; also simply called Alwar Fort
Timangarh	Early medieval hill fort	Karauli

TRAP

Three planted wrong pairs to memorise as wrong. (1) Taragarh has two versions — Ajmer is Ajayaraja Chauhan's, Bundi is Rao Bar Singh Hada's. (2) Shergarh is in Baran district on the Parwan, not Jhalawar; Jhalawar's fort is Gagron. (3) Lohagarh was built by Suraj Mal — his son Jawahar Singh only raised the Jawahar Burj inside it.

- Mandalgarh, Chittorgarh and Kumbhalgarh together are called the three sentinels of Mewar.
- Jaswant Thada, built 1899 for Maharaja Jaswant Singh II, stands beside Mehrangarh.
- The Jaivana cannon was cast at Jaigarh in 1720.

Palaces — a small set, high return

Palaces are asked as palace-to-city or palace-to-builder pairs. The set is small. Learn it once and it stays.

Palace to builder to place

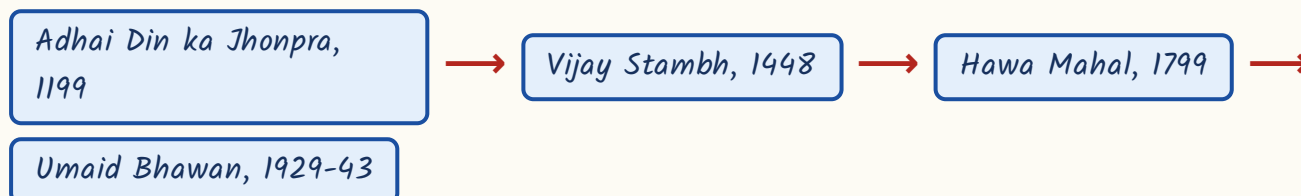
Palace	Builder	Place & detail
Hawa Mahal	Sawai Pratap Singh, 1799	Jaipur; architect Lal Chand Ustad, five storeys, 953 jharokhas, shaped like Krishna's crown

Palace	Builder	Place & detail
Umaid Bhawan (Chittar Palace)	Maharaja Umaid Singh, 1929-43	Jodhpur; architect Henry Vaughan Lanchester, Chittar sandstone, built as famine relief
Lalgarh Palace	Maharaja Ganga Singh	Bikaner; architect Sir Samuel Swinton Jacob, red Dulmera sandstone, named after his father Lall Singh
Jal Mahal	Built in the reign of Sawai Madho Singh	Jaipur; stands in the Man Sagar lake
Sukh Mahal	Bundi rulers	Bundi; on Jait Sagar lake
Padmini Mahal	-	Inside Chittorgarh fort
Jag Mandir / Jag Niwas	Mewar rulers	Udaipur; island palaces of Lake Pichola
Anup Mahal	-	Inside Junagarh, Bikaner

TRAP

Hawa Mahal is Sawai Pratap Singh's, 1799 — not Sawai Jai Singh II's. This exact swap is offered as a wrong statement. Jai Singh II founded Jaipur in 1727 and built Jaigarh and Nahargarh; Pratap Singh built Hawa Mahal.

- Samuel Swinton Jacob also designed the Albert Hall Museum at Jaipur.
- Amber remained the Kachhwaha capital until it moved to Jaipur in 1727.
- The Madhavendra Bhawan at Nahargarh has nine identical suites for the queens.

The chronological ordering question RPSC likes to build

Temples — the densest matching set in the chapter

Rajasthan's temples belong mostly to the Nagara style, with the marble Maru-Gurjara style as its western branch. Do not spend time on style theory. Spend it on temple, place, district and deity. That is what appears in List-II.

Temple sites and their districts



Nathdwara is Rajsamand; Eklingji is Udaipur. That pair is the one RPSC swaps.

Temple to place to district

Temple	Place	District & note
Dilwara Jain temples	Mount Abu	Sirohi; Maru-Gurjara marble style
Chaumukha temple of Adinath	Ranakpur	Pali; patron Dharna Shah (Porwal), architect Depak, 1,444 pillars, Kumbha's reign
Gurjara-Pratihara cluster, Sachiya Mata	Osian	Jodhpur; the Khajuraho of Rajasthan

Temple	Place	District & note
Someshwar temple, Solanki style	Kiradu	Barmer
Ambika Mata temple, 961 CE	Jagat	Udaipur; the Khajuraho of Mewar
Sas-Bahu temple, 975 CE	Nagda	Udaipur
Neelkanth Mahadev temple	Rajorgarh	Alwar; Bargujar ruler Mathandeva, Rajor inscription of 960 CE
Sun temple (Padmanabh temple), 10th c.	Jhalrapatan	Jhalawar; Jhalrapatan is the city of temple bells
Harshnath Shiva temple	Harshnath	Sikar
Ghateshwar Mahadev temple	Baroli	Chittorgarh
Mahanaleshwar Shiva complex	Menal	Chittorgarh; on the Chambal-side plateau near Begun

Dilwara — learn the four names as one block

The Dilwara temples

Temple	Patron / year	Dedicated to
Vimal Vasahi	Vimal Shah, 1031	Adinath
Luna Vasahi	Vastupal and Tejpal, 1230	Neminath
Pittalhar	Bhima Shah	Adinath (large brass image)
Khartar Vasahi	-	Parshvanath

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2024 — the Neelkanth Mahadev temple at Rajorgarh, referred to in the Rajor inscription of 960 CE, was built by whom? Answer: Mathandeva of the Bargujar (Badgujar) line, in present-day Alwar district.

TRAP

The Ambika Mata temple at Jagat is in UDAIPUR district, not Rajsamand. Nathdwara and Kumbhalgarh are Rajsamand; Jagat and Nagda are Udaipur. Jagat-Rajsamand has been used as the wrong pair.

- Sun temples of Rajasthan: Jhalrapatan (Jhalawar), Osian, Varman (Sirohi), Surya Narayan at Ranakpur.
- Achaleshwar Mahadev at Achalgarh worships a toe-impression of Shiva instead of a linga.
- Eklingji (Udaipur), Nathdwara (Rajsamand), the Brahma temple at Pushkar and Govind Dev Ji (Jaipur) are the major living shrines.

Ajmer's Indo-Islamic monuments

A small cluster, but it is asked because it is the earliest Indo-Islamic building in Rajasthan and because it sits on top of a Hindu institution. Get the builder and the date right.

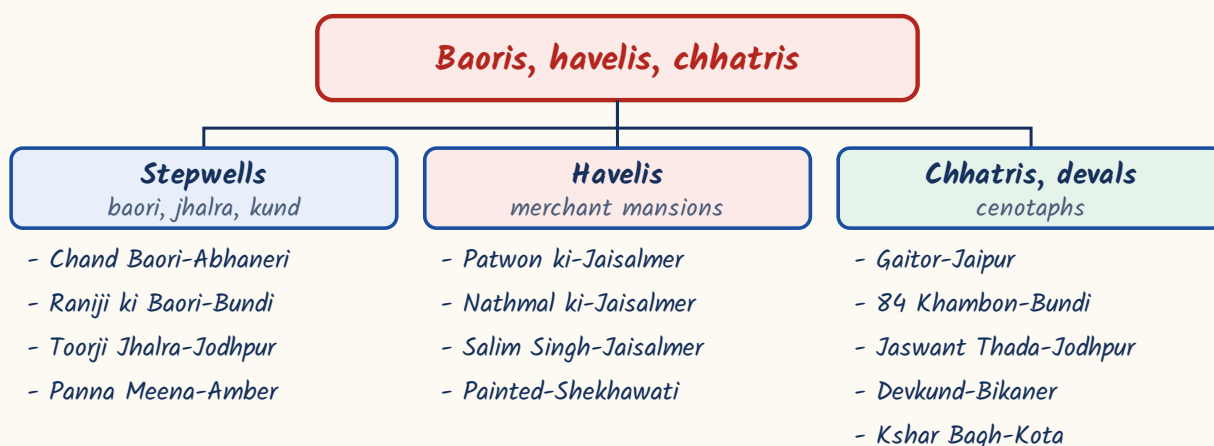
- Adhai Din ka Jhonpra, Ajmer — raised by Qutbuddin Aibak in 1199.
- It stands on the site of a Sanskrit college founded by the Chauhan ruler Vigraharaja IV.
- The arched screen in front was added later by Iltutmish.
- The Dargah of Khwaja Moinuddin Chishti at Ajmer is the other great monument of the town.
- Tarkin ka Darwaza at Nagaur belongs to the same early tradition.

Use 1199 as your date anchor. In almost every RPSC ordering question on Rajasthan architecture, Adhai Din ka Jhonpra is the oldest item on the list and therefore goes first.

Stepwells, havelis and chhatris

Water architecture and memorial architecture close the chapter. Both are pure place-matching. Only four stepwell names ever appear in the options — Chand at Dausa, Rani at Bundi, Toorji at Jodhpur, Panna Meena at Amber. C-R-T-P.

Water and memorial architecture



Stepwell to place

Stepwell	Place / district	Detail
Chand Baori	Abhaneri, Dausa	Nikumbha ruler Chanda, c. 8th-9th century; about 3,500 steps, 13 storeys; adjoins the Harshat Mata temple
Raniji ki Baori	Bundi	Built 1699 by Rani Nathavati
Toorji ka Jhalra	Jodhpur	-
Panna Meena ka Kund	Amber, Jaipur	-

Havelis

- Patwon ki Haveli, Jaisalmer — commissioned by Guman Chand Patwa in 1805; a cluster of five, the largest haveli of Rajasthan.
- Nathmal ki Haveli and Salim Singh ki Haveli are also at Jaisalmer; Salim Singh's has a peacock-shaped upper storey.
- The painted havelis of Shekhawati are concentrated at Nawalgarh, Mandawa and Fatehpur.

Chhatris and devals

- Gaitor, Jaipur — cenotaphs of the Kachhwaha rulers from Sawai Jai Singh II onward; the queens' cenotaphs stand at Maharani ki Chhatri.
- Chaurasi Khambon ki Chhatri, Devpura, Bundi — eighty-four pillars, raised by Rao Anirudh Singh.
- Jaswant Thada, Jodhpur (1899); Devkund, Bikaner; Kshar Bagh, Kota.

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2023 as a match set — Gagron / Jhalawar, Bhatner / Hanumangarh, Kumbhalgarh / Rajsamand, Taragarh / Ajmer. Fort-to-district is the single most reliable question shape in this chapter, so revise the two builder tables above before every mock.

REVISION RECAP

1. Fort types: giri hill, jal water, dhanva desert, van forest, eran ravine, parikh moat, sahay allies, sainya army.
2. Gagron = jal durg, Kali Sindh + Ahu, Jhalawar, Bijaldev Dod, no laid foundation, sakas 1423 and 1444.
3. Ranthambore = giri durg, never jal. Lohagarh = parikh durg.
4. Six UNESCO Hill Forts, 2013: Chittorgarh, Kumbhalgarh, Ranthambore, Amber, Jaisalmer, Gagron. Not Bhainsrorgarh.
5. Rajasthan's four World Heritage sites: Keoladeo 1985, Jantar Mantar 2010, Hill Forts 2013, Walled City Jaipur 2019.

6. Chittorgarh: largest fort of India by area, Mesa plateau, founder Chitrangada Mori, sakas 1303, 1535, 1568.
7. Vijay Stambh = Kumbha, 1448, nine storeys, 37.19 m, architect Sutradhar Jaita, victory at Sarangpur 1437. Kirti Stambh = Jija, Adinath, seven storeys, 12th century.
8. Kumbhalgarh = Kumbha with architect Mandan, 36-km wall, Katargarh citadel, Pratap's birthplace, Rajsamand.
9. Mehrangarh Rao Jodha 1459; Junagarh Rai Singh 1589-94; Amber Man Singh I 1592; Jaigarh 1726 and Nahargarh 1734 both Sawai Jai Singh II.
10. Bhatner = oldest fort, on the Ghaggar, Hanumangarh. Taragarh Ajmer = Garh Beetli, Ajayaraja Chauhan, Gibraltar of Rajasthan.
11. Hawa Mahal 1799 Sawai Pratap Singh, architect Lal Chand Ustad, 953 jharokhas. Umaid Bhawan by Lanchester as famine relief. Lalgarh by Ganga Singh, architect Swinton Jacob.
12. Ranakpur = Chaumukha Adinath, Pali, patron Dharna Shah, architect Depak, 1,444 pillars.
13. Dilwara: Vimal Vasahi 1031 Adinath, Luna Vasahi 1230 Neminath, Pittalhar Bhima Shah, Khartar Vasahi Parshvanath.
14. Osian = Khajuraho of Rajasthan (Jodhpur); Jagat = Khajuraho of Mewar (Udaipur, 961 CE).
15. Rajorgarh Neelkanth Mahadev by Mathandeva, Rajor inscription 960 CE, Alwar.
16. Adhai Din ka Jhonpra 1199, Qutbuddin Aibak, on Vignaraja IV's Sanskrit college; screen added by Iltutmish.
17. Chand Baori at Abhaneri in Dausa, about 3,500 steps; Raniji ki Baori at Bundi, 1699, Rani Nathavati.
18. Patwon ki Haveli, Jaisalmer, 1805, Guman Chand Patwa, largest in Rajasthan; Chaurasi Khambon ki Chhatra at Bundi.

RH11

Painting Schools and Handicrafts

About 2–3 questions a paper. Painting gives you one match-the-following almost every year; handicrafts gives one craft-to-district one-liner.

Two halves, one method. Painting is school-to-painter-to-patron matching; handicrafts is craft-to-centre matching. RESEARCH puts painting schools matched to painters in the 2013, 2018 and 2024 papers — it is one of the most reliable repeat clusters in the whole exam.

Painting & Handicrafts

Mewar

- Chawand Ragmala 1605
- Sahibdin
- Manohar
- Nathdwara Pichwai
- Deogarh

Hadoti

- Bundi - Chunar Ragmala 1591
- Kota - shikar scenes
- Uniara (Tonk)

Kishangarh

- Nihal Chand
- Bani Thani
- Savant Singh / Nagari Das
- Gundalao lake

Marwar & Bikaner

- Shiv Das
- Dhola-Maru
- Ali Raza
- Ruknuddin

Dhundhar & Alwar

- Sahib Ram
- Bihari Satsai
- Baldev
- ivory painting

Textile crafts

- Bandhej
- Leheriya
- Bagru dabu
- Sanganeri
- Ajrakh Barmer
- Kota Doria

Metal & clay

- Thewa Pratapggarh
- Meenakari Jaipur
- Koftgiri Udaipur
- Usta Bikaner
- Blue pottery
- Molela

Wood & folk

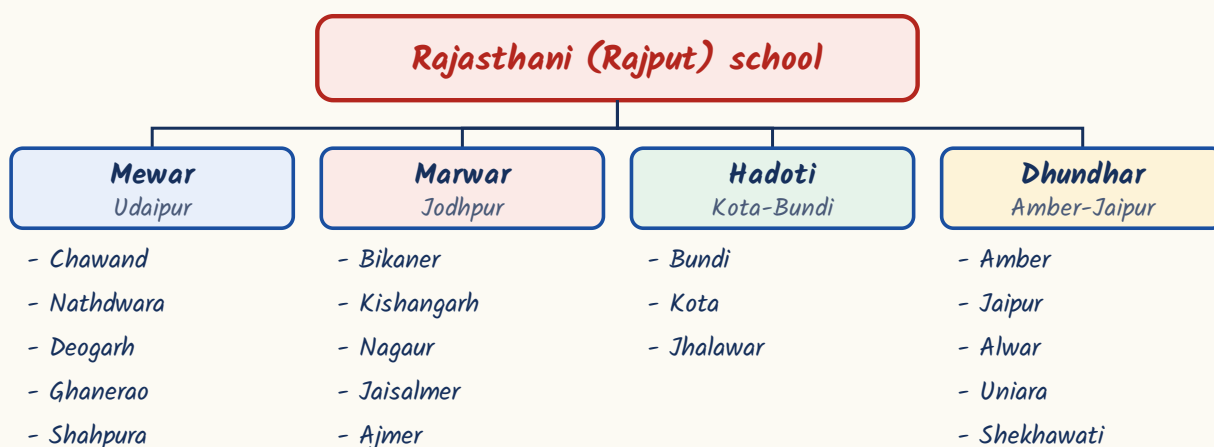
- Kavad Bassi
- Phad Shahpura
- Kathputli puppets

Where Rajasthani painting comes from, and how to attack the chapter

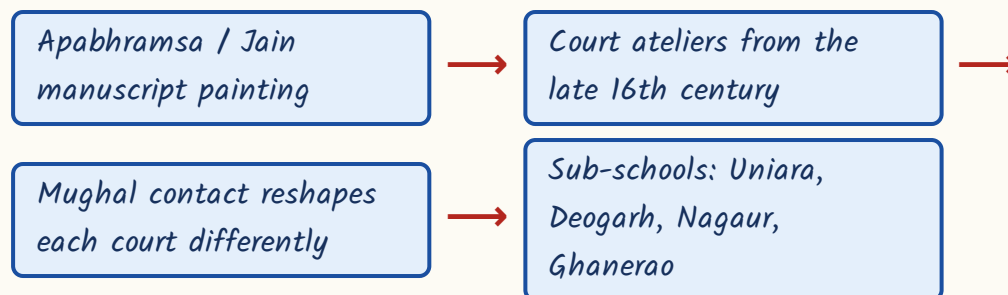
Rajasthani painting grew out of the Western Indian Apabhramsa and Jain manuscript tradition — the illustrated palm-leaf and paper manuscripts of the Jain merchants. From the late sixteenth century these miniatures develop into court schools, collectively called the Rajasthani or Rajput school. Mughal contact modifies each school differently; that is why Bikaner looks Mughal-Deccani and Mewar stays flat and bright.

Now the method. RPSC does not ask you to describe a style. It asks you to pair a name with a school. So build three lists in your head: school-to-painter, school-to-patron, school-to-signature-work. Everything else is background. The dated Ragmala sets give you a ready-made chronology question as a bonus.

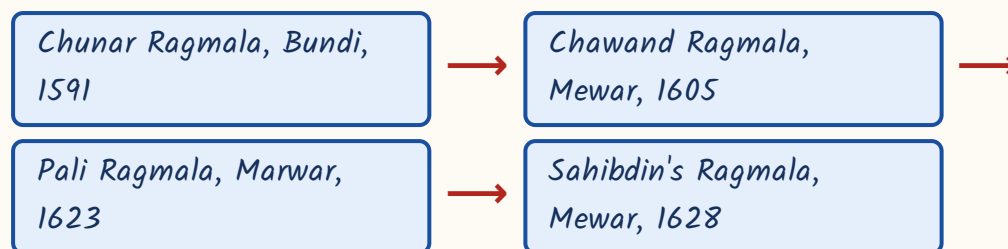
The four families of Rajasthani painting



How the schools came to be



The dated Ragmala sets — the ordering question RPSC has already built



YAAD RAKHO

Remember the four dates as 91-05-23-28. Chunar 1591 is Bundi and is the EARLIEST of the lot — students routinely put Mewar's 1605 first because Mewar feels older as a kingdom. It is not.

Mewar — the school with the greatest master

Mewar is the oldest continuous school. Its earliest dated set is a Ragmala painted at Chawand in 1605 by Nisaruddin, under Maharana Amar Singh I — Chawand was then the Mewar capital. But the school's greatest name comes a generation later.

- Sahibdin is the greatest master of the Mewar school; he worked under Maharana Jagat Singh I.
- His works: Ragmala of 1628, Rasikpriya, Bhagavata Purana, and the Yuddha Kanda of the Ramayana.
- The other Mewar painter to remember is Manohar.
- Style marks: flat bright colour, oval faces, pointed noses.
- Sub-centres of the Mewar region: Nathdwara, Deogarh, Ghanerao.

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2024 — Sahibdin, the greatest painter of the Mewar school, worked chiefly under which ruler? Answer: Maharana Jagat Singh I. Do not answer Amar Singh I; he is the Chawand Ragmala patron, 1605.

Hadoti — Bundi and Kota, one parent and one offshoot

Bundi and Kota are treated as one family because Kota grew out of Bundi. But their subject matter is completely different, and that difference is exactly what gets asked. Bundi paints nature and the monsoon. Kota paints the hunt.

Bundi vs Kota

Bundi school	Kota school
Earliest work: Chunar Ragmala, 1591, for Rao Bhoj Singh	An offshoot of Bundi, later
Lush vegetation, monsoon skies, elephants, red-brown ground	Shikar (hunting) scenes in dense dark forest, tiny human figures
Chitrashala of the Bundi palace is its great mural site	Flourished under Maharao Ram Singh and Umed Singh
-	Painter: Raghunath Das

- The Chunar Ragmala was painted by artists trained in the Mughal atelier — hence its early Mughal feel.
- Uniara (Tonk) is a sub-school that blends Bundi and Jaipur styles.
- Kota's treatment — small figures set against a dark forest mass — is found in no other Rajasthani school.

Kishangarh — the smallest school, the most famous painting

Kishangarh is a small state that produced the single most recognisable Rajasthani painting. Raja Savant Singh, who ruled 1748-57 and wrote Krishna-bhakti poetry under the pen-name Nagari Das, patronised the painter Nihal Chand. Bani Thani, a singer at his court, was the model. The portrait is called the Indian Mona Lisa.

- Painter: Nihal Chand. Patron: Raja Savant Singh, pen-name Nagari Das.
- Other Kishangarh painters: Amar Chand, Sitaram, Soorajmal.
- Style: elongated upturned eyes, arched eyebrows, pointed chin and nose.
- Themes: Krishna-Radha, Morchhal, boat scenes.
- Background: the panoramic Gundalao lake of Kishangarh.

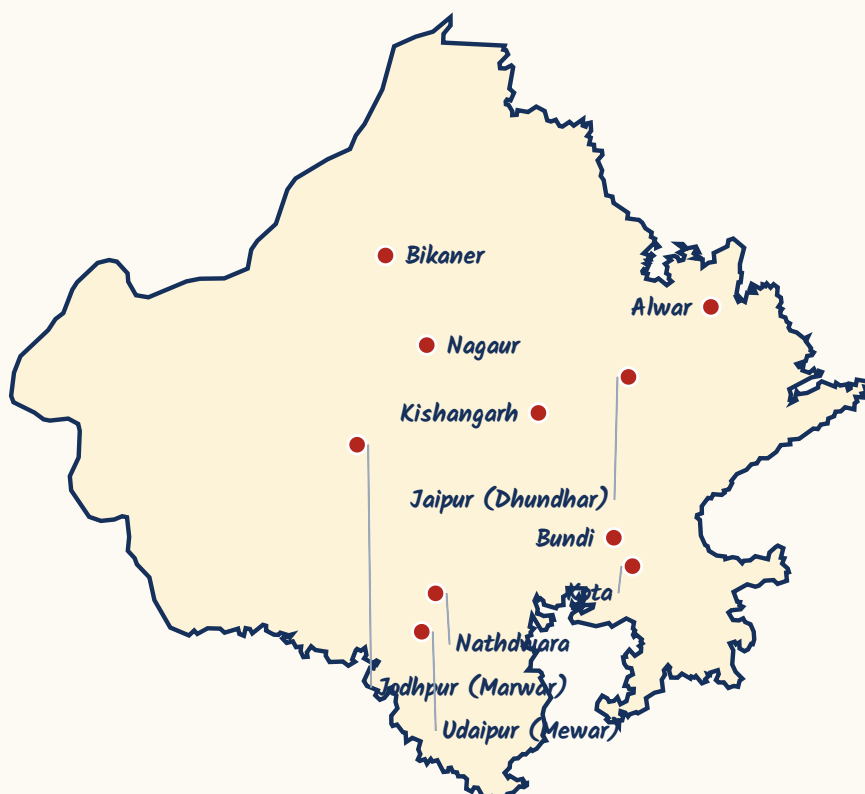
ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2024 — the painting Bani Thani of the Kishangarh school was executed by whom? Answer: Nihal Chand. A companion question asks the pen-name of his patron: Nagari Das.

Marwar, Bikaner, Dhundhar, Alwar — and the master table

These four are almost always taught as a block because RPSC puts them together in one List-I. Learn the table below cold. It is the single highest-return thing in this chapter.

Centres of the painting schools



Bundi and Kota sit together in Hadoti; Kishangarh lies in Ajmer district.

School to painter to patron to signature work

School	Painter(s)	Patron & signature work
Mewar	Sahibdin, Manohar	Maharana Jagat Singh I; Ragmala 1628, Rasikpriya
Bundi	Mughal-trained artists	Rao Bhoj Singh; Chunar Ragmala 1591
Kota	Raghunath Das	Maharao Ram Singh, Umed Singh; shikar scenes
Kishangarh	Nihal Chand	Raja Savant Singh (Nagari Das); Bani Thani
Marwar / Jodhpur	Shiv Das, Kishan Das, Dana, Amardas, Kalu, Virji	Maharaja Man Singh (Nath subjects); Dhola-Maru, Pali Ragmala 1623

School	Painter(s)	Patron & signature work
Bikaner	Ali Raza (Ustad), Ruknuddin, Shahadin, Nathu	Rai Singh, Karan Singh, Anup Singh; signed and dated works
Dhundhar (Amber-Jaipur)	Sahib Ram, Ghasi Ram, Hukma, Guman	Sawai Pratap Singh; life-size portraits, Bihari Satsai
Alwar	Baldev, Ghasi Ram, Sali Ram, Jamna Das	Maharao Raja Vinay Singh; ivory painting, Gulistan miniatures

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2013 — Ali Raza and Ruknuddin are the celebrated painters of which school? Answer: Bikaner. The reason for its Mughal-Deccani look is worth knowing: Karan Singh and Anup Singh served long spells in the Deccan. Bikaner artists were also unusual in signing and dating their work.

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2024 — the painter Shiv Das belongs to which school? Answer: Marwar (Jodhpur). The Marwar signature theme is the Dhola-Maru romance. In RAS Pre 2018 the same idea came as a painter-to-school match set.

TRAP

Sahib Ram is JAIPUR (Dhundhar), not Bundi. RPSC has used Bundi-Sahib Ram as the wrong pair in a NOT-correctly-matched question. Also note Ghasi Ram appears in both the Jaipur and Alwar lists — if the option pairs Ghasi Ram with ivory painting, it is Alwar.

Folk and devotional painting — Pichwai, Phad, Kavad

Alongside the court schools runs a devotional and narrative tradition. These three are asked as place questions, not style questions.

Pichwai, Phad and Kavad - the three districts



P-P-K, R-B-C. All three lie in south-central Rajasthan, which is why options shuffle them.

- Pichwai — large cloth paintings hung behind the Shrinathji image at Nathdwara, Rajsamand district; they change with the season and the festival.
- Phad — long cloth scrolls narrating Pabuji and Devnarayan; painted at Shahpura in Bhilwara district by the Joshi (Chhipa) family.
- Devnarayan ki Phad is the longest; Pabuji ki Phad is the most widely performed.
- The Bhopa narrates the Pabuji phad to the Ravanhatha, and the Devnarayan phad to the Jantar.
- Kavadi — a portable painted wooden shrine with hinged panels, made by Suthar craftsmen at Bassi, Chittorgarh; a Kavadiya Bhat opens it panel by panel while telling the story. Bassi is also known for wooden toys and puppets.
- Basohli is NOT a Rajasthani school — it belongs to the Pahari group in Jammu. Uniara, Nagaur, Deogarh, Ghanerao, Shahpura and Sirohi are the genuine Rajasthani sub-centres.

YAAD RAKHO

Three folk forms, three districts, one line: Pichwai at Nathdwara in RAJSAMAND, Phad at Shahpura in BHILWARA, Kavadi at Bassi in CHITTORGARH. P-P-K, R-B-C. Options in this chapter shuffle exactly these three districts.

Handicrafts I — textiles, the craft-to-centre table

Handicrafts is asked one way only: which place. So build the table place-first. Learn the district for each craft, and learn the two crafts that are constantly swapped.

Textile craft to centre

Craft	Centre / district	What it is
Bandhej (tie-and-dye)	Jaipur, Sikar, Jodhpur, Udaipur, Nathdwara	Cloth tied in points and dyed
Leheriya	Jaipur, Jodhpur, Udaipur	Diagonal stripes made by resist-tying
Sanganeri printing	Sanganer, Jaipur	Fine floral DIRECT block printing on a white ground
Bagru printing	Bagru, Jaipur district	Dabu (mud-resist) printing in earthy red and black; syahi-begar prints
Ajrakh printing	Barmer and Balotra	Geometric prints in indigo and madder, by the Khatri community
Kota Doria	Kaithoon, near Kota	Khat weave of cotton and silk giving square checks; GI-registered
Namda	Tonk	Felted woollen rugs
Pattu	Jaisalmer and Barmer	Woollen shawl
Jajam	Akola (Chittorgarh), Bhilwara	Block-printed floor spread
Gotta-kinari	Khandela (Sikar), Ajmer, Jaipur	Metallic ribbon applied on fabric
Danka work	Udaipur	The Udaipur counterpart of gotta work
Zari / Zardozi	Jaipur, Bikaner	Metal-thread embroidery

Bagru vs Sanganeri — the single most swapped pair in handicrafts

Bagru	Sanganeri
Dabu, i.e. mud-RESIST printing	Direct block printing
Earthy reds and blacks; syahi-begar	Fine floral motifs, delicate lines
Usually on an off-white or dyed ground	On a white ground
Bagru village, Jaipur district	Sanganer town, Jaipur

TRAP

Kota Doria is woven at Kaithoon in KOTA district — not Bhilwara.

Bhilwara's association is phad painting at Shahpura and textile mills. RPSC has used Kota Doria-Bhilwara as the wrong pair.

CURRENT LINK

Current link (as of September 2026): Jaipur has been a member of the UNESCO Creative Cities Network since 2015 in the field of Crafts and Folk Art - the first Indian city admitted in that field, joined later by Srinagar in 2021. Keep this apart from the World Heritage inscription of the Walled City of Jaipur in 2019: Creative City is 2015 and is about living crafts, World Heritage is 2019 and is about the built city. RPSC has offered the two dates as a swap.

Handicrafts II — metal, clay, glass and wood

Same drill. One line per craft: the place and the technique. Techniques matter here because RPSC has asked a craft-to-technique match set.

Handicraft centres of Rajasthan



Bagru and Sangner are both in Jaipur district, about 25 km apart - do not swap them.

Craft to centre to technique

Craft	Centre	Technique
Thewa	Pratapgarh	Engraved sheet gold fused on to coloured glass; the hereditary Raj Soni family
Meenakari	Jaipur	Enamelling; brought in when Raja Man Singh I fetched enamellers from Lahore
Koftgiri	Udaipur, Alwar, Jaipur	Gold or silver wire inlaid into steel
Usta art (munawwat)	Bikaner	Gold embossing and painting on camel hide; seen in Junagarh's Anup Mahal
Blue pottery	Jaipur	Quartz powder, fuller's earth, borax, gum and glass — NO clay
Molela terracotta	Molela, Rajsamand	Votive clay plaques, chiefly of Devnarayan, by Kumhar craftsmen
Kavad	Bassi, Chittorgarh	Painted wooden shrine with hinged panels, by Suthar craftsmen

Craft	Centre	Technique
Marble carving	Jaipur; marble from Makrana, Nagaur	Makrana supplied the white marble of the Taj Mahal

Pottery — four types, four places

Type	Place
Blue pottery	Jaipur
Black pottery	Sawai Madhopur, Kota
Kagzi (paper-thin) pottery	Alwar
Terracotta plaques	Molela, Rajsamand

TRAP

Blue pottery contains no clay at all. Its dough is quartz powder, fuller's earth, borax, gum and glass — and the low firing temperature is why the ware is fragile. Any statement calling clay its main ingredient is the wrong one. It reached Jaipur from Persia through Kashmir and Delhi, was encouraged by Sawai Ram Singh II, and was revived in the twentieth century by Kripal Singh Shekhawat.

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2013 — Molela, famous for votive terracotta plaques of folk deities, is in which district? Answer: Rajsamand. Molela lies near Nathdwara, and its plaques of Devnarayan are installed by Bhil and Gurjar devotees in village shrines.

CURRENT LINK

Current link (as of September 2026): a cluster of Rajasthan crafts received Geographical Indication tags in August 2023 — Nathdwara Pichwai, Jodhpuri Bandhej, Udaipur Koftgiri, Bikaner Usta art and Bikaner embroidery. Nagauri Ashwagandha received a GI tag in January 2026 and was widely reported as the state's twenty-second GI product. Published totals vary between 22 and 23 depending on how food and craft items are counted, so learn the PRODUCTS and their years, not the running total. Older Rajasthan GI crafts include Blue Pottery, Bagru print, Sanganeri print, Kota Doria, Molela pottery, Thewa and Makrana marble. Rajasthali is the state handicraft emporium.

REVISION RECAP

1. Rajasthani painting descends from the Western Indian Apabhramsa / Jain manuscript tradition.
2. Ragmala order: Chunar (Bundi) 1591, Chawand (Mewar) 1605, Pali (Marwar) 1623, Sahibdin's 1628.
3. Mewar: Sahibdin under Jagat Singh I; Chawand 1605 set painted by Nisaruddin under Amar Singh I.
4. Bundi = monsoon, vegetation, elephants, Chitrashala. Kota = shikar scenes, Ram Singh and Umed Singh, painter Raghunath Das.
5. Kishangarh: Nihal Chand, patron Savant Singh alias Nagari Das, Bani Thani = Indian Mona Lisa, Gundalao lake backgrounds.
6. Marwar: Shiv Das, Kishan Das, Dana; theme Dhola-Maru; Nath subjects under Maharaja Man Singh.
7. Bikaner: Ali Raza and Ruknuddin; Mughal-Deccani influence; artists signed and dated their work.
8. Jaipur/Dhundhar: Sahib Ram, life-size portraits, Bihari Satsai, patron Sawai Pratap Singh. Alwar: Baldev and Ghasi Ram, ivory painting, Vinay Singh.
9. Pichwai = Nathdwara (Rajsamand). Phad = Shahpura (Bhilwara), Joshi family. Kavadi = Bassi (Chittorgarh).
10. Devnarayan phad is the longest and is narrated to the Jantar; Pabuji phad is narrated to the Ravanhatha.
11. Blue pottery: Jaipur, no clay, revived by Kripal Singh Shekhawat.
12. Thewa = Pratapgarh, Raj Soni family, gold on glass. Usta = Bikaner, gold on camel hide.

13. Koftgiri = wire inlay on steel (Udaipur); Meenakari = enamelling (Jaipur, via Man Singh I from Lahore).
14. Bagru = dabu mud-resist; Sanganer = fine floral direct printing. Ajrakh = Barmer/Balotra, Khatri community.
15. Kota Doria at Kaithoon, Kota district; Namda at Tonk; Pattu at Jaisalmer-Barmer; Gotta-kinari at Khandela, Sikar.
16. Pottery: blue Jaipur, black Sawai Madhopur-Kota, kagzi Alwar, terracotta Molela. Makrana marble from Nagaur.

RH12

Performing Arts: Music, Dance, Theatre, Instruments

About 2-3 questions a paper. At least one is almost always instrument classification or instrument-to-community.

The instrument classification is the highest-frequency single fact in Rajasthan Art and Culture. Tat, sushir, avanaddh, ghan — RPSC asked it in 2013, in 2021 twice and again in 2024. After that come dance-to-community and theatre-form-to-region. All matching, all learnable in one sitting.

Performing Arts of Rajasthan

Tat (string)

- Ravanhatha
- Kamaycha
- Sarangi
- Jantar
- Chautara
- Bhapang
- Chikara
- Ektara
- Surinda

Sushir (wind)

- Algoza
- Poongi/Been
- Satara
- Shehnai
- Karna
- Bankiya
- Nad
- Morchang
- Mashak
- Bhungal

Avanaddh (drum)

- Nagara
- Dhol
- Chang
- Damroo
- Mridang
- Khanjari
- Maandal
- Naubat
- Damama

Ghan (solid)

- Khartal
- Manjira
- Jhanjh
- Thali
- Ghadwa
- Chimta
- Ghungroo
- Lezim

Communities

- Manganiyar
- Langa
- Bhopa
- Kamad
- Dholi
- Bhat
- Kalbeliya

Dances

- Ghoomar
- Gair
- Chari
- Bhavai
- Kalbeliya
- Terahtali
- Gavari
- Walar
- Chakri
- Kachhi Ghodi
- Agni

Theatre

- Khyal
- Rammat
- Tamasha
- Rasdhari
- Nautanki
- Swang
- Kathputli

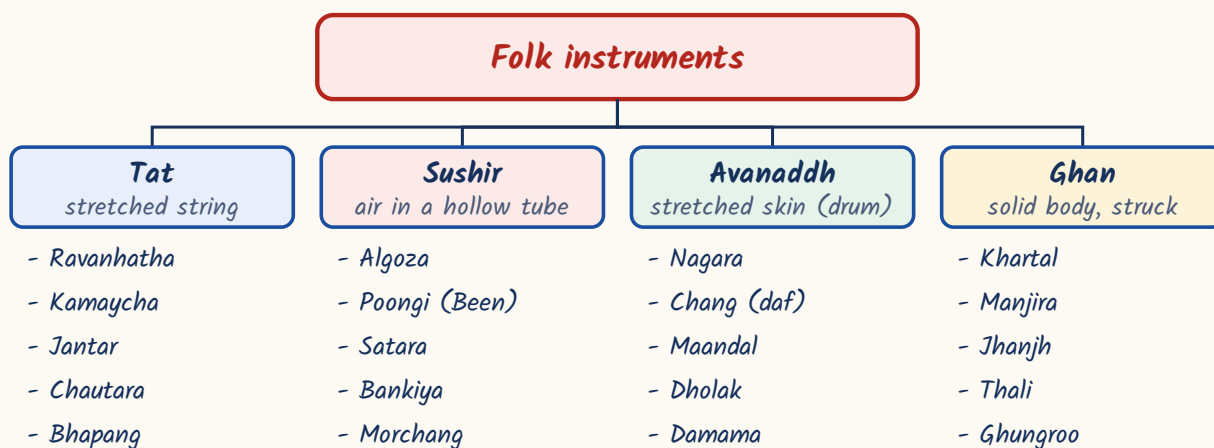
Classical & texts

- Jaipur Kathak gharana
- Atrauli-Jaipur khayal
- Mewati gharana
- Sangeet Raj
- Nartan Nirnay

The four classes of instruments — learn this before anything else

Indian tradition sorts every instrument by how the sound is produced, not by how it is played. Four classes. Tat is a stretched string. Sushir is air through a hollow tube. Avanaddh is a stretched membrane, that is a drum. Ghan is a solid body that rings when struck. Learn the four Sanskrit names and their English equivalents together, because RPSC uses both in the same option list.

How the sound is made - the four classes



The four classes

Sanskrit class	English	Rajasthan examples
Tat vadya	Chordophone (string)	Ravanhatha, Kamaycha, Sarangi, Jantar, Chautara, Bhapang, Chikara, Ektara, Surinda, Rabab
Sushir vadya	Aerophone (wind)	Algoza, Poongi/Been, Satara, Shehnai, Nad, Karna, Bankiya, Bhungal, Mashak, Morchang
Avanaddh vadya	Membranophone (drum)	Nagara, Dhol, Dholak, Chang, Damroo, Mridang/Pakhawaj, Khanjari, Maandal, Tasa, Dhaunsa, Naubat, Damama
Ghan vadya	Idiophone (solid)	Khartal, Manjira, Jhanjh, Thali, Ghara/Ghadwa, Chimta, Ghungroo, Lezim, Ghuraliyo

YAAD RAKHO

Remember: TAAR is a string, so Tat = taar. SU-shir has hawa going through it, so wind. Avanaddh has 'nadh' = tied, so a tied skin, a drum. Ghan means solid metal or wood. Four names, four ideas — and every year at least one question turns on nothing more than this.

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2024 — the Chautara, used with Ramdevji bhajans, belongs to which class? Answer: tat (string). It is a four-stringed tanpura-like instrument, played chiefly by the Kamad community. Asked in RAS Pre 2013 — the Khartal, a pair of hard wooden clappers, is which type? Answer: ghan vadya; its great exponent was Sadiq Khan Manganiyar of Jaisalmer.

TRAP

Two classification traps RPSC has actually used. (1) The Manjira is a pair of small metal cymbals — it is GHAN, not avanaddh and not sushir. (2) The Surinda is a BOWED STRING instrument of the Langas, so it is tat — it appears in NOT-a-wind-instrument questions alongside Algoza, Satara and Bankiya, which are genuinely wind. Also note the Morchang, a small iron jaw harp, is counted among sushir vadya in the Rajasthani tradition.

Tat vadya in detail — instrument, community, use

String instruments carry most of the matching questions because each one belongs to a specific community and a specific deity or story. Do not learn the instrument alone. Learn instrument plus who plays it plus what it accompanies.

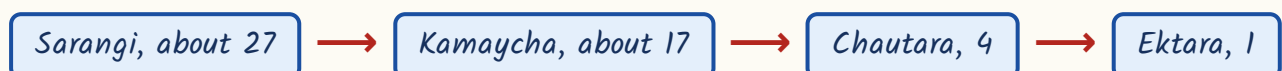
String instrument to community to use

Instrument	Played by	What it accompanies / detail
Ravanhatha	Bhopas of Pabuji	Pabuji ki Phad; half-coconut belly; called an early ancestor of the violin
Kamaycha	Manganiyars of Jaisalmer-Barmer	About 17 strings, round leather-covered mango-wood resonator; exponent Sakar Khan
Jantar	Gurjar Bhopas of Devnarayan	Devnarayan ki Phad; veena-like, two gourds, 5-6 strings
Chautara	Kamad community	Ramdevji bhajans; four strings, tanpura-like
Sarangi	Langas (Sindhi Sarangi, Gujratan Sarangi)	About 27 strings
Surinda	Langas	Another bowed instrument of the Langas
Bhapang	Mewati Jogi of Mewat / Alwar	Single-stringed 'talking drum'; exponent Jahoor Khan Mewati
Chikara	Garasia and Meo	Three strings
Ektara	Wandering singers	One string

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2021 — the Bhapang, the single-stringed 'talking drum', belongs to which region? Answer: Mewat, that is the Alwar-Bharatpur belt. The name says drum but the instrument is a string instrument; that is precisely why it is asked.

Descending order by number of strings — RPSC has built an ordering question on exactly this



Wind, drum and solid instruments

For the other three classes you mostly need the name and one identifying tag. Read once, then test yourself by covering the right column.

- Algoza — a PAIR of bamboo flutes played together; one carries the melody, the other a drone. Played by Langa, Bhil and Kalbeliya musicians.
- Poongi (Been) — gourd-bodied pipe of the Kalbeliya snake charmers; accompanies the Kalbeliya dance with the Khanjari and Dholak.
- Morchang — small iron jaw harp, the 'Jew's harp of Rajasthan', played by Langa and Manganiyar musicians.
- Satara, Shehnai, Nad, Karna, Bankiya, Bhungal, Mashak — the rest of the wind list.

Avanaddh — the drums

- Nagara — the largest of the percussion instruments.
- Chang (daf) — single-membrane frame drum; THE Holi instrument of Shekhawati.
- Maandal — baked-clay drum with one small and one large mouth, used by the Bhils in the Gavari dance-drama, along with the Thali.
- Others: Dhol, Dholak, Damroo, Mridang/Pakhawaj, Khanjari, Tasa, Dhaunsa, Naubat, Damama.

Ghan — the solids

- Khartal — pair of hard wooden clappers; exponent Sadiq Khan Manganiyar.
- Manjira, Jhanjh, Thali, Ghara/Ghadwa, Chimta, Ghungroo, Lezim, Ghuraliyo.

The performing communities

Rajasthan's folk music is hereditary. A family plays one instrument for one patron community for generations. RPSC matches the community to the instrument, so learn the pairs, not the sociology.

Hereditary musician communities and where they belong



Manganiyar and Langa share the same western belt - Jaisalmer-Barmer - but not the same instruments.

Manganiyar vs Langa — the pair students mix up

Manganiyar	Langa
Muslim hereditary musicians of Jaisalmer-Barmer	Muslim hereditary musicians of the same western belt
Play the Kamaycha and the Khartal	Play the Sindhi Sarangi and the Algoza (also Surinda)
Patrons: Rajputs and Charans	Patrons: Sindhi Sipahi
Exponents: Sakar Khan (Kamaycha), Sadiq Khan (Khartal)	-

Community to instrument to deity or story

Community	Instrument	Sings / narrates
Bhopa of Pabuji	Ravanhatha	Pabuji ki Phad
Gurjar Bhopa of Devnarayan	Jantar	Devnarayan ki Phad
Kamad	Chautara / Tandoora	Ramdevji bhajans; Kamad women perform Terahtali
Mewati Jogi	Bhapang	Mewati folk songs of Alwar
Kalbeliya (Sapera)	Poongi, Khanjari, Dholak	Kalbeliya dance songs
Dholi, Bhat, Dhadhi, Rawal	Drums and narrative song	Genealogy and praise singing; the Bhat also perform Kathputli

Folk songs — one line each

Folk songs are asked as song-to-occasion. Nothing deeper. Learn the occasion in three words.

Folk song to occasion or theme

Song	Occasion / theme
Panihari	Sung by women drawing water at the well
Kurjan	The demoiselle crane carries a message to the absent husband
Olyun	Marwari song of longing and remembrance
Jachcha	Birth songs
Halariya	Sung at the birth of a child
Supna, Moriya, Peepli, Hichki, Kaga, Papaiyo, Bandola	Songs of separation, omen and longing
Rasiya	Bharatpur region

YAAD RAKHO

Three of these are named after birds — Kurjan the demoiselle crane, Kaga the crow, Papaiyo the papiha. All three belong to the songs of separation and waiting. If an option pairs a bird with a wedding or a birth, it is wrong.

Dances — region, community, one identifying action

This is the second big matching set of the chapter. Every dance has one physical action that identifies it — pots on the head, thirteen manjiras, a dummy horse, fire. Learn the action and the community together.

Folk dances and their home regions



Chakri is Hadoti (Baran-Kota), not Garasia country; Bhavai is the Udaipur-Sirohi belt, not Shekhawati.

Dance to region to community

Dance	Region	Community & identifying action
<i>Ghoomar</i>	<i>All over Rajasthan</i>	<i>Bhil in origin, adopted by Rajput households; women only; circular ghoomna; danced at Gangaur and Teej</i>
<i>Gair</i>	<i>Mewar and Marwar</i>	<i>Men's Holi dance; Dandi Gair of Jalore-Marwar, Geendad of Shekhawati</i>
<i>Chari</i>	<i>Kishangarh and Ajmer</i>	<i>Gurjar and Saini women balance a brass chari with a lighted lamp; exponent Falku Bai</i>
<i>Bhavai</i>	<i>Udaipur, Sirohi, Dungarpur</i>	<i>Seven to nine pots balanced on the head, dancing on a sword edge or glass; Daulat Bai, Krishna Vyas</i>
<i>Kalbeliya</i>	<i>Western Rajasthan</i>	<i>Sapera community; forms Indoni, Shankaria, Panihari; Gulabo Sapera</i>
<i>Terahtali</i>	<i>Padarla / Ramdevra</i>	<i>Kamad women, thirteen manjiras tied to the body, for Baba Ramdev; Mangi Bai and Moti Bai</i>
<i>Gavari (Gavri)</i>	<i>Mewar</i>	<i>Bhil ritual dance-drama for about forty days after Rakshabandhan; only men, playing female roles too</i>
<i>Walar and Loor</i>	<i>Sirohi and Pali</i>	<i>Garasia tribe; Walar without any instrument, Loor at Holi</i>
<i>Chakri</i>	<i>Baran and Kota (Hadoti)</i>	<i>Kanjar community; women spin rapidly in wide skirts</i>
<i>Kachhi Ghodi</i>	<i>Shekhawati</i>	<i>Dummy-horse dance at weddings</i>
<i>Agni (fire) dance</i>	<i>Katariyasar, Bikaner</i>	<i>Jasnathi Siddhs dance barefoot on live embers to the nagara</i>
<i>Kathputli</i>	<i>Statewide</i>	<i>String puppetry by the Bhat/Nat community; puppets carved at Bassi, Chittorgarh</i>

Ghoomar vs Gair — the classic swap

Ghoomar	Gair
Women only	Men's dance
Bhil in origin, taken up by Rajput households	Mewar and Marwar
Gangaur, Teej, weddings	Holi
Name from ghoomna, the circular movement	Variants: Dandi Gair (Jalore), Geendad (Shekhawati)

TRAP

Chakri belongs to the KANJAR of Baran-Kota, not the Garasia. The Garasia dances are Walar, Loor and Jawara. And Bhavai is the Udaipur-Sirohi-Dungarpur belt, not Shekhawati — Shekhawati's own dances are Chang, Geendad and Kachhi Ghodi.

- Terahtali: thirteen brass manjiras on wrists, elbows, waist and arms; the performer may also balance a pot and hold a sword in her mouth.
- In Terahtali the male singers accompany on the Chautara or Tandoora.
- Gavari is dedicated to Gauri (Parvati) and includes episodes such as Bhanwarya and Khetudiyar.
- In Kathputli the puppeteer speaks through a bamboo-and-leather reed called the boli, and a companion interprets for the audience.
- Two more named dances to recognise: the Dhol (drum) dance of the Jalore region and the Bam dance of the Alwar-Bharatpur belt, named after the bam drum.

CURRENT LINK

Current link (as of September 2026): the Padma Shri has gone repeatedly to Rajasthan's folk performers, and RPSC likes award-to-art pairs. Sakar Khan, the Manganiyar master of the Kamaycha, was honoured in 2012, and Gulabo Sapera of the Kalbeliya community for the Kalbeliya dance in 2016. The state's main annual platform for these performers is the Rajasthan International Folk Festival at Mehrangarh, Jodhpur, held around Sharad Purnima.

Folk theatre — Khyal and the rest

Khyal is the umbrella name for Rajasthani folk theatre in verse. Its branches are named after towns or founders. Outside Khyal there are five or six named forms, each tied to a region and usually to a festival. That region tag is what is asked.

Folk theatre - form to place



Tamasha is Jaipur and Rammat is the Bikaner-Jaisalmer-Phalodi belt. The swap is a standing trap.

Theatre form to region to founder or family

Form	Region	Founder / detail
Kuchamani Khyal	Kuchaman, Nagaur	Lachhiram
Shekhawati Khyal	Shekhawati	Nanuram
Turra-Kalangi	Nimbahera, Chittorgarh	Turra stands for Shiva, Kalangi for Parvati; two parties compete in verse
Hela Khyal and Ali Baksh Khyal	Alwar	-
Jaipuri Khyal	Jaipur	-
Rammat	Bikaner, Jaisalmer, Phalodi	Performed in the open at Holi; nagara and dholak are its main instruments
Tamasha	Jaipur	Bhatt family, settled under Sawai Pratap Singh; performed at Gangaur on a fixed open-air stage
Rasdhari	Mewar	Devotional narrative theatre; the Leela forms belong to the same devotional stream

Form	Region	Founder / detail
Nautanki	Bharatpur-Dholpur belt	-
Swang	Chirawa, Mandal (Bhilwara)	-
Gavari / Rai	Bhil areas of Mewar	Ritual dance-drama

ASKED IN RAS

Asked as a match set in recent papers — Kuchamani Khyal / Nagaur, Rammat / Bikaner, Tamasha / Jaipur, Turra-Kalangi / Chittorgarh. And the NOT-matched version plants Tamasha-Bikaner. Tamasha is Jaipur; Bikaner is Rammat.

TRAP

Unlike Khyal, which is played wherever a crowd gathers, Tamasha uses a **FIXED** open-air stage. That single distinction has been used as a statement in a statement-based question.

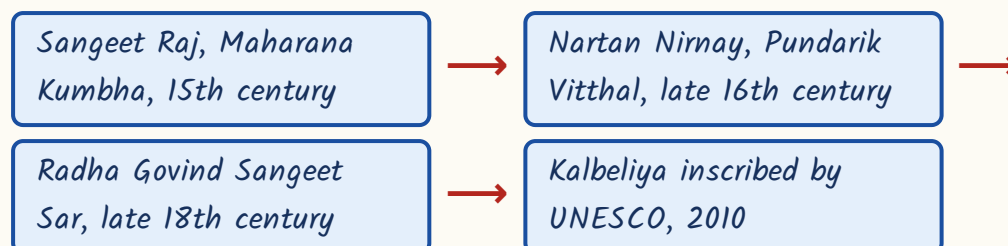
Classical music, gharanas and the treatises

The classical half is short but it supplies the chronology question. Learn four gharana facts and four books. That is the whole section.

- Jaipur gharana of Kathak — the state's classical dance tradition.
- Atrauli-Jaipur gharana of khayal — founded by Alladiya Khan.
- Mewati gharana — associated with Pandit Jasraj.
- Dhrupad was cultivated at the Jaipur and Jodhpur courts.

- Maharana Kumbha wrote *Sangeet Raj*, *Sangeet Mimansa* and *Sud Prabandh*, and a commentary on the *Gita Govinda* called *Rasik Priya*.
- Pundarik Vitthal wrote *Nartan Nirnay*.
- *Radha Govind Sangeet Sar* was compiled under Sawai Pratap Singh of Jaipur.

Chronology of the treatises and the UNESCO milestone



ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2021 as a match set — Kamaycha / tat, Algoza / sushir, Nagara / avanaddh, Khartal / ghan. Also asked in 2021 as a statements question on the same classification. If you learn only one table from this chapter, learn the four classes.

CURRENT LINK

Current link (as of September 2026): the Padma Shri 2026 list included two Rajasthan folk musicians — Gafruddin Mewati Jogi of Deeg, honoured for the Bhapang and Mewati folk music, and Taga Ram Bhil of Jaisalmer, honoured for tribal folk music and the Algoza. Both awards sit exactly on top of the instrument list above, which is why they are worth remembering by instrument. Note also that the Kalbeliya folk songs and dances were inscribed on the UNESCO Representative List of Intangible Cultural Heritage in 2010 — still Rajasthan's only ICH entry.

REVISION RECAP

1. Four classes: tat = string, sushir = wind, avanaddh = drum, ghan = solid.
2. Chautara = tat, four strings, Kamad community, Ramdevji bhajans.

3. Khartal = ghan, wooden clappers, Sadiq Khan Manganiyar. Manjira = ghan, never avanaddh.
4. Surinda = bowed string of the Langas; Morchang = jaw harp counted as sushir.
5. Ravanhatha with Pabuji ki Phad (Bhopa); Jantar with Devnarayan ki Phad (Gurjar Bhopa).
6. Kamaycha = Manganiyar, about 17 strings, Sakar Khan. Sindhi Sarangi and Algoza = Langa.
7. Bhapang = single-stringed, Mewat/Alwar, Mewati Jogi, Jahoor Khan Mewati.
8. String order: Sarangi 27, Kamaycha 17, Chautara 4, Ektara 1.
9. Chang = Holi drum of Shekhawati; Maandal = clay drum of the Bhil Gavari; Nagara = largest percussion.
10. Ghoomar = women, Bhil origin, Gangaur and Teej. Gair = men, Holi, Mewar-Marwar; Dandi Gair Jalore, Geendad Shekhawati.
11. Chari = Kishangarh-Ajmer, Gurjar and Saini women, lamp on a brass pot, Falku Bai.
12. Bhavai = Udaipur-Sirohi-Dungarpur, pots on head, sword edge, Daulat Bai.
13. Terahtali = Kamad women, thirteen manjiras, for Baba Ramdev, Mangi Bai.
14. Gavari = Bhil, Mewar, forty days after Rakshabandhan, men only. Walar and Loor = Garasia. Chakri = Kanjar of Baran-Kota.
15. Kalbeliya = Sapera, UNESCO ICH 2010, Gulabo Sapera; forms Indoni, Shankaria, Panihari.
16. Kuchamani Khyal - Lachhiram, Nagaur. Shekhawati Khyal - Nanuram. Turra-Kalangi - Nimbahera; Turra is Shiva, Kalangi is Parvati.
17. Rammatt = Bikaner-Jaisalmer-Phalodi at Holi. Tamasha = Jaipur, Bhatt family, at Gangaur, fixed stage.
18. Kathputli = Bhat/Nat community; puppets carved at Bassi, Chittorgarh.
19. Sangeet Raj, Sangeet Mimansa, Sud Prabandh = Maharana Kumbha. Nartan Nirnay = Pundarik Vitthal. Radha Govind Sangeet Sar under Sawai Pratap Singh.

RH13

Language, Dialects, Literature; Saints, Sects and Folk Deities

About 3-4 questions a paper. Literary work-to-author is asked EVERY year; folk deities were asked in 2012, 2013, 2023 and 2024; saints and sects in 2018, 2021 and 2024; dialects in 2012 and 2024.

This is the densest single chapter in the whole Rajasthan section. Four separate lists live here — dialects, literary works, sects and folk deities — and RPSC asks all four as matching questions. The work-to-author list has appeared in every paper the research covers.

Language, Literature, Saints & Folk Deities

Origin & styles

- Maru-Gurjar Apabhramsa
- Grierson, LSI 1908
- Dingal — Charan, veer rasa
- Pingal — Bhatt, shringar rasa

Dialects

- Marwari, Mewari, Dhundhari
- Hadauti, Mewati, Ahirwati
- Bagri, Wagdi, Godwadi
- Shekhawati, Malvi, Rangdi, Nimadi

Literary forms

- Raso
- Vachanika
- Khyat & Vigat
- Veli, Duha, Prabandh

Key works

- Prithviraj Raso — Chand Bardai
- Kuvalayamala — Uddyotana Suri
- Veli Krishan Rukmani Ri — Prithviraj Rathore
- Rajprashasti — Ranchhod Bhatt

Sects

- Vishnoi — Jambhoji — Mukam
- Dadu Panth — Naraina
- Ramsnehi — four branches
- Jasnathi, Laldasi, Nimbarka, Charandasi

Folk deities

- Panch Peer: Pabuji, Harbhuji, Ramdevji, Mehaji, Gogaji
- Tejaji — Kharnal
- Devnarayan — Asind

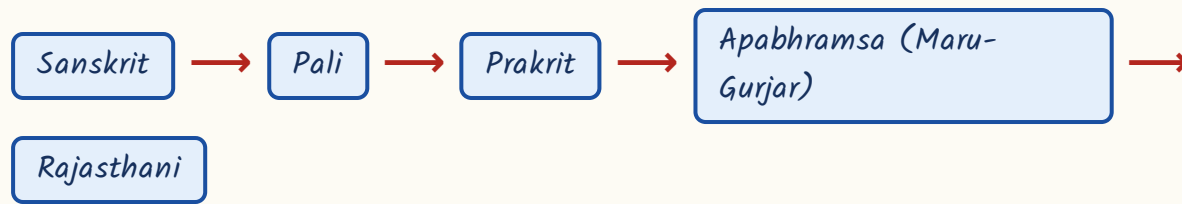
Folk goddesses

- Karni Mata — Deshnok
- Jeen Mata — Revasa
- Kaila Devi — Karauli
- Shila Devi — Amber

Where Rajasthani comes from — origin and the man who classified it

Rajasthani is not a branch of Hindi. It has its own line of descent, and RPSC tests that line. The parent is Maru-Gurjar Apabhramsa — also written Gurjar Apabhramsa. Dr Motilal Menariya is the scholar usually cited for this derivation. Learn the ladder as a sequence; it has been asked as a straight one-liner.

The descent of Rajasthani



- George Abraham Grierson gave the first scientific classification of Rajasthani dialects.
- He did it in the Linguistic Survey of India, 1908, and he popularised the very name 'Rajasthani'.
- L.P. Tessitori did pioneering work on Old Western Rajasthani — but he did NOT give the classification.
- Kuvalayamala (778 AD) names eighteen desi languages, one of them 'Maru' — the earliest notice of this speech.
- Riddles in Rajasthani are called Aadi, Hiyali and Bujh — three words, one meaning.
- Rajasthan's official language under the Rajasthan Official Languages Act, 1956 is Hindi; Rajasthani is not in the Eighth Schedule.

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2024 — in Rajasthani, the words 'Aadi' and 'Hiyali' are used for what? Answer: riddles. Put 'Bujh' in the same box; it is the third word for the same thing and is the obvious next version of the question.

Dingal and Pingal — two styles, not two languages

Students lose this question by treating Dingal and Pingal as dialects. They are literary styles. Dingal is the bardic style of the west, carried by Charan poets, built on the western form of Marwari, and it sings of war. Pingal belongs to the east, is carried by Bhatt poets, carries a heavy Braj element, and sings of love. Get the direction right — west/veer versus east/shringar — and every statement question here collapses.

Dingal vs Pingal

Dingal	Pingal
Western Rajasthan	Eastern Rajasthan
Charan poets	Bhatt poets
Built on Marwari	Braj-mixed
Veer rasa — heroism and war	Shringar rasa — love
Prose form: Vachanika. Verse: Duha, Geet, Veli	Verse in Braj-influenced metres
Veli Krishan Rukmani Ri, Dholu Maru ra Duha, Achaldas Khichi ri Vachanika	Prithviraj Raso, Vansh Bhaskar

YAAD RAKHO

Trick to remember: D for Dingal = Desert (west) and Dhal-Talwar (veer rasa). P for Pingal = Purab (east) and Prem (shringar rasa). RPSC's favourite false statement is 'Dingal is based on Braj' — Braj belongs to Pingal.

The dialects and their districts — pure matching marks

There is nothing to understand here. RPSC gives a dialect and asks for the region, or gives four pairs and asks which one is wrong. So do not learn the dialect — learn the districts. Marwari covers the largest area of any Rajasthani dialect; that single fact has been used as a statement more than once.

Dialect to region — the seven you cannot miss

Dialect	Districts / region	Note
Marwari	Jodhpur, Pali, Nagaur, Bikaner, Jaisalmer	Widest dialect by area; Dingal is built on it
Mewari	Udaipur, Chittorgarh, Bhilwara, Rajsamand	Mewar region
Dhundhari	Jaipur, Tonk, Dausa	Also called Jaipuri
Hadauti	Kota, Bundi, Baran, Jhalawar	The Hadoti region
Mewati	Alwar and Bharatpur	Speech of the Mev community
Ahirwati (Rathi)	Behror, Kotputli, Mundawar	Named after the Ahir community
Shekhawati	Sikar, Churu, Jhunjhunu	Shekhawati region

Dialect to region — the border and mixed dialects

Dialect	Districts / region	Note
Bagri	Sri Ganganagar and Hanumangarh	Bagar tract; strong Punjabi and Haryanvi influence
Wagdi	Dungarpur and Banswara	The Vagad region; Gujarati and Mewari influence
Godwadi	Pali, Sirohi, Jalore	The Godwar tract
Malvi	Pratapgarh and Jhalawar	Malwa border
Rangdi	Pratapgarh	A mixture of Marwari and Malvi
Nimadi	Nimar belt	A sub-dialect of Malvi
Devdawati / Khairadi / Dhatki	Sirohi / Shahpura-Bundi belt / Jaisalmer-Barmer border	The three smallest; usually only distractors

Dialect to region - anchor each one to a district



Marwari covers the largest area of any Rajasthani dialect

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2012 as a straight match — Hadauti with Kota and Jhalawar, Mewati with Alwar and Bharatpur, Godwadi with the Godwar tract, Shekhawati with Sikar-Churu-Jhunjhunu. The same four keep coming back. RAS Pre 2024 returned to dialects as a NOT-matched question, with Rangdi (Pratapgarh) as the trick.

YAAD RAKHO

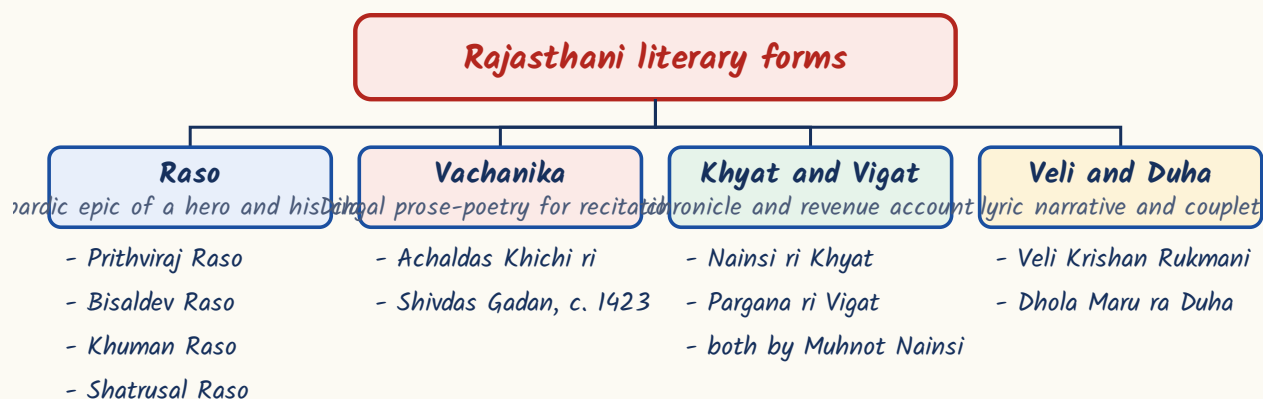
Anchor each dialect to ONE district and the rest follows — Bagri to Ganganagar, Wagdi to Dungarpur, Godwadi to Sirohi, Rangdi to Pratapgarh, Ahirwati to Behror. Watch the pair RPSC loves to swap: Bagri is north-west (Ganganagar-Hanumangarh), Wagdi is south (Dungarpur-Banswara).

The literary works — the single most asked list in the Rajasthan section

If you learn one table in this whole chapter, learn this one. Work-to-author matching has appeared in every RAS paper the research covers. Before the table, fix what the form-names mean, because the question is sometimes framed as 'the finest Vachanika' or 'the best-known Raso' rather than by title.

- Raso — a bardic epic in praise of a hero and his clan.
- Vachanika — Dingal prose-poetry meant for recitation; the finest is Achaldas Khichi ri Vachanika.
- Khyat — a dynastic chronicle; Vigat — a revenue and statistical account.
- Veli — a short lyric narrative; Duha — a couplet; Vat — a prose tale.
- Prabandh, Prakash, Vilas, Ravela and Nisani are the other named forms.
- Dingal supplies the Vachanika and the Duha; Pingal supplies the Raso in its Braj-influenced form.

Literary form to the works written in it



Work to author — the compulsory list

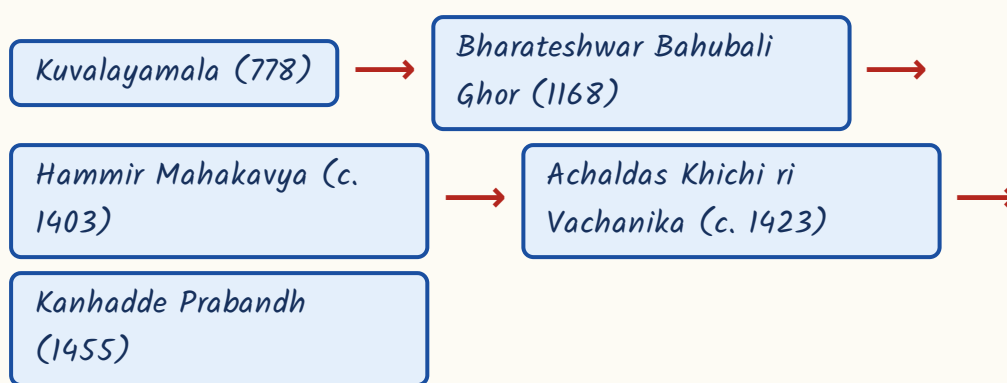
Work	Author	Note
Kuvalayamala	Uddyotana Suri	778 AD, Prakrit, written at Jabalipur (Jalore)
Bharateshwar Bahubali Ghor	Vajrasen Suri	1168 — oldest available Jain work in Rajasthani
Hansawali	Asayit (Asaigu)	Among the earliest available Rajasthani works
Prithviraj Raso	Chand Bardai	Pingal; court poet of Prithviraj Chauhan III
Bisaldev Raso	Narpati Nalha	
Khuman Raso	Dalpat Vijay	Traces Mewar from Bappa Rawal onwards
Shatrusal Raso	Dungarsi	
Hammir Mahakavya	Nayanchandra Suri	Sanskrit, c. 1403
Kanhadde Prabandh	Padmanabh	1455, Jalore
Achal Das Khichi ri Vachanika	Shivdas Gadan	c. 1423, Dingal; Gagron against Hoshang Shah of Malwa
Vachanika Rathore Ratan Singh ji ri	Jagga Khidiya	The other famous Vachanika
Veli Krishan Rukmani Ri	Prithviraj Rathore 'Pithal'	Dursa Adha called it the fifth Veda / nineteenth Purana
Dhola Maru ra Duha	Kavi Kallol	Dingal
Padmavat	Malik Muhammad Jayasi	Awadhi, 1540

Chronicles, prashastis and the rest

Work	Author	Note
Rajprashasti	Ranchhod Bhatt Telang	25 black stone slabs at Rajsamand lake; largest inscription in India
Vansh Bhaskar	Suryamal Mishran	Of Bundi; Pingal tradition
Nainsi ri Khyat	Muhnnot Nainsi	Nainsi is called the 'Abul Fazl of Rajasthan'

Work	Author	Note
Marwar ra Pargana ri Vigat	Muhnnot Nainsi	An early statistical survey of Marwar
Suraj Prakash	Karnidan	The name RPSC plants next to Khuman Raso as a wrong pair
Bhakt Mal	Nabhadas	
Prithviraj Vijay	Jayanak	Sanskrit — not to be confused with Prithviraj Raso

Chronological order of composition — asked as an ordering question



ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2024 — which work-author pair is NOT correctly matched? The planted pair was 'Khuman Raso — Karnidan'. Khuman Raso is Dalpat Vijay; Karnidan wrote Suraj Prakash. RAS Pre 2016 asked the author of Hansawali (Asayit). RAS Pre 2024 also ran the four-pair match Bisaldev Raso—Narpati Nalha, Kanhadde Prabandh—Padmanabh, Hammir Mahakavya—Nayanchandra Suri, Dhola Maru ra Duha—Kavi Kallol.

TRAP

Three 'Prithviraj' entries, three different answers. Prithviraj Raso is by Chand Bardai (Pingal). Prithviraj Vijay is by Jayanak (Sanskrit). Veli Krishan Rukmani Ri is BY Prithviraj Rathore of Bikaner. Do not let the shared name pull you to the wrong option.

Modern Rajasthani — the Sahitya Akademi line and the language question

Two things get asked from the modern period. First, the Sahitya Akademi award given in the Rajasthani language — the first winner is a fixed fact, the current winner is current affairs. Second, the constitutional status of Rajasthani, which is a favourite because most students assume it is already recognised. It is not.

- First Sahitya Akademi Award in Rajasthani: Vijaydan Detha 'Bijji', 1974, for *Bataan Ri Phulwari*.
- Kanhaiyalal Sethia won it in 1976 for *Leeltans*.
- Rajasthani is NOT among the 22 languages of the Eighth Schedule of the Constitution.
- Rajasthan's official language remains Hindi under the Rajasthan Official Languages Act, 1956.

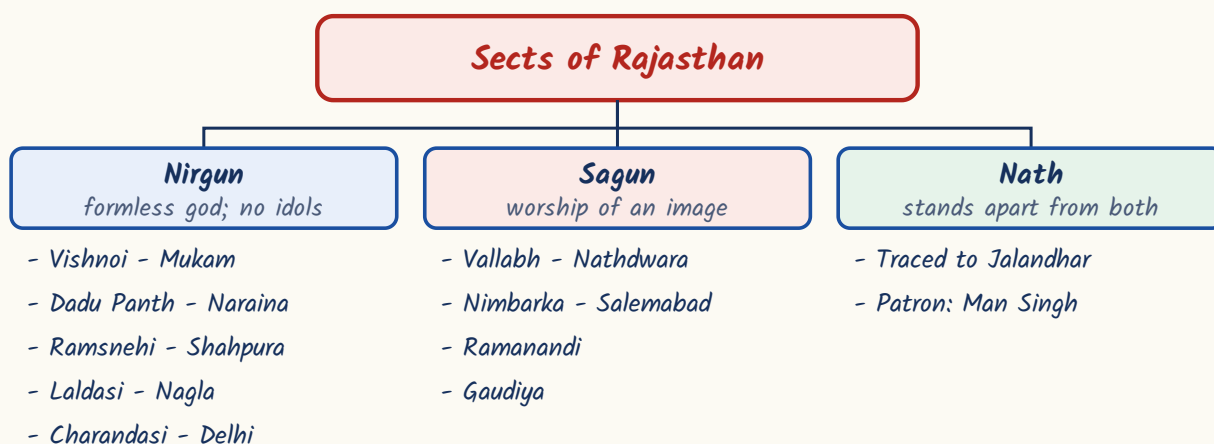
CURRENT LINK

Current link (as of September 2026): Rajasthani is still outside the Eighth Schedule. The state has pressed the Centre repeatedly since 2003 — again in 2009, 2015, 2017, 2019, 2020 and 2023 — and in March 2023 the state government set up a committee to examine giving Rajasthani official-language status within the state on the Chhattisgarh-Jharkhand model. Recent Sahitya Akademi awards in Rajasthani: Gaje Singh Rajpurohit (2023, *Palakati Preet*), Mukut Maniraj (2024, *Gaon Ar Amma*), Jitender Kumar Soni (2025, *Bharkhama*). The award in the Rajasthani language was itself asked in 2018 and 2023, so track the 2026 winner as well.

Saints and sects — build the map before the detail

Sort the sects into two families first. Nirgun sects worship a formless god and reject idols — Dadu Panth, Ramsnehi, Laldasi, Vishnoi, Alakhiya, Charandasi. Sagun sects worship an image — Vallabh's Pushtimarg at Nathdwara, Nimbarka at Salemabad, Ramanandi, Gaudiya. The Nath sect, tracing to Jalandhar Nath, sits apart and was patronised by Maharaja Man Singh of Jodhpur. Now the table. RPSC asks sect-to-founder, sect-to-headquarters, or both together, so learn all three columns as one unit.

Sort the sects first, then learn the seats



Sect to founder to main seat — learn all three columns

Sect	Founder	Main seat
Vishnoi	Jambhoji (Guru Jambheshwar)	Mukam, Nokha (Bikaner) — founded at Samrathal Dhora
Jasnathi	Jasnath	Katariyasar (Bikaner)
Dadu Panth	Dadu Dayal	Naraina, near Dudu (Jaipur)
Ramsnehi (main peeth)	Sant Ramcharan	Shahpura (Bhilwara)
Laldasi	Sant Laldas	Nagla (Bharatpur); samadhi at Sherpur (Alwar)

Sect	Founder	Main seat
Charandasi	Charandas	Delhi — the only Rajasthani sect seated outside the state
Nimbarka	Nimbarkacharya	Salemabad, Kishangarh (Ajmer)
Vallabh / Pushtimarg	Vallabhacharya	Nathdwara (Rajsamand)
Alakhiya	Lalgiri (Alakhgiri) of Sulakhaniya, Churu	Bikaner

The four Ramsnehi branches — a guaranteed match question

Ramsnehi branch to founder

Branch (place)	District	Founder
Shahpura — the main peeth	Bhilwara	Sant Ramcharan
Rain	Nagaur	Sant Daryavji
Khedapa	Jodhpur	Sant Ramdas
Sinhthal	Bikaner	Sant Haridas

The sects in detail — what goes beyond the table

The table gets you the match questions. The statement questions need one layer more — rules, numbers, festivals and the names of the disciples. Take them sect by sect.

Vishnoi — the sect RPSC returns to most

- Jambhoji was born in 1451 at Pipasar in Nagaur district.
- He founded the sect in 1485 at Samrathal Dhora in Bikaner.
- He laid down 29 rules — hence the name Bishnoi (bis + nau, twenty and nine).
- Several of the 29 rules protect green trees and wildlife; this is why the sect is quoted in environment papers too.
- His samadhi is at Mukam, in Nokha tehsil of Bikaner.
- Khejarli, 1730 — 363 Vishnois led by Amrita Devi died resisting the felling of khejri trees ordered by men of Maharaja Abhay Singh of Jodhpur.

Dadu, Jasnath, Laldas, Ramsnehi, Charandas and Meera

- Dadu Dayal (1544-1603) was born at Ahmedabad; his principal centre is Naraina near Duda in Jaipur.
- His followers are organised in the '52 thambas'; the branches are Khalsa, Naga, Uttarade, Khaki and Virakt.
- Dadu's disciples: Rajjab of Sanganer, Sundardas (called the 'second Shankaracharya') and Garibdas.
- Jasnath (born 1482) of Katariyasar laid down 36 rules; the Jasnathis are famous for the Agni (fire) dance and are largely Jats.
- Laldas (1540-1648) was born at Dholidoob in Alwar and was a Mev, a Muslim by birth; he preached Nirgun devotion to Ram and Hindu-Muslim unity; the sect's greeting is 'Jairam'.
- Ramsnehi is Nirgun: its collected utterances are the Anabhai Vani, its places of worship are Ramdwaras, and its chief festival is Phuldol, held at Shahpura after Holi.
- Charandas was born at Dehra in Alwar in 1703; his women disciples Sahjo Bai and Daya Bai are celebrated saint-poets — Daya Bai wrote Daya Bodh and Vinay Malika.
- Meera Bai was married in 1516 to Bhojraj, the eldest son of Rana Sanga; Sant Raidas is traditionally her guru; she is called the 'Radha of Rajasthan'.
- Sant Pipa was the Khichi Chauhan ruler of Gagron who renounced his throne and became a disciple of Ramanand.
- Sant Dhanna, a Jat saint of the Tonk region, was another disciple of Ramanand.
- Karma Bai of Kalva in Nagaur is remembered for the khichda she offered to Jagannath.
- The Parnami (Pranami) sect follows Mahamati Prannath; it has followers in Rajasthan but its main seat, Panna, is in Madhya Pradesh.
- Ramanandi and Gaudiya are the two large Sagun Vaishnava orders present in the state; Nathdwara (Vallabh) and Salemabad (Nimbarka) are the seats that get asked.

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2018 — where did Jambhoji found the Vishnoi sect? Samrathal Dhora. Asked in RAS Pre 2021 — the main seat of the Dadu Panth? Naraina. Asked in RAS Pre 2024 as a two-statement question on Sant Laldas: born at Dholidoob in Alwar and a Mev, principal seat at Nagla in Bharatpur — both statements correct.

TRAP

Vishnoi has THREE places and RPSC rotates them: born Pipasar (Nagaur), founded Samrathal Dhora (Bikaner), samadhi Mukam (Nokha, Bikaner). Two numbers also get swapped — 29 rules Vishnoi, 36 rules Jasnathi. And the Dadu Panth's seat is Naraina, NOT Sanganer; Sanganer is only the birthplace of his disciple Rajjab, and that was the wrong option in 2021.

Folk deities — Rajasthan's human heroes turned gods

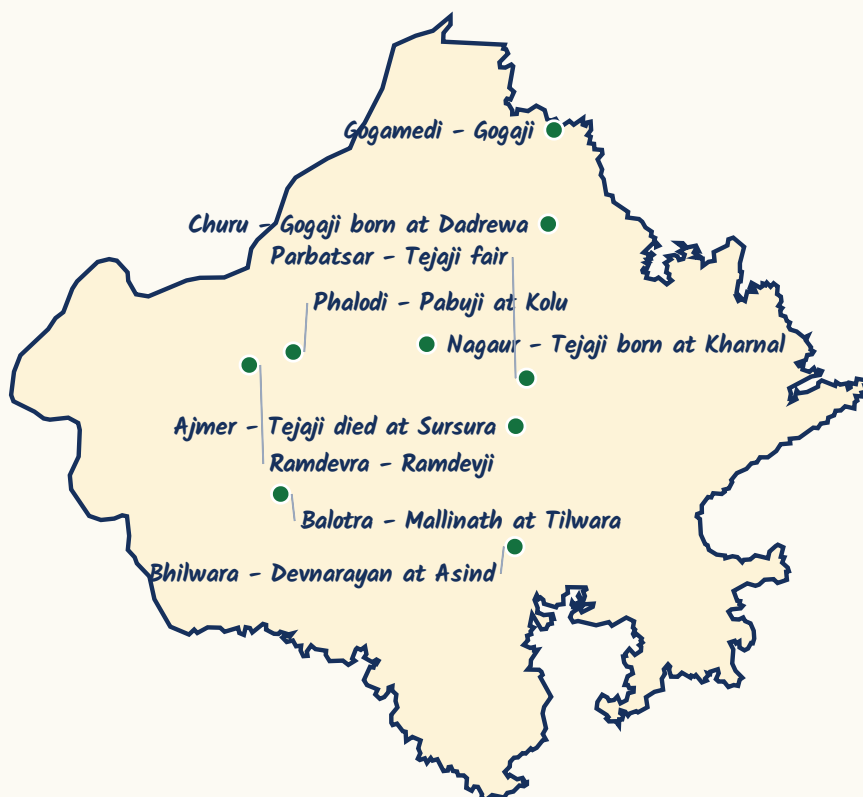
Folk deities are historical or semi-historical men who were deified after death, usually for dying in defence of cattle or for curing snakebite. For every one of them RPSC can ask four things: the shrine, the district, the community that worships him, and the animal or instrument attached to him. Learn all four together — that is how the statement questions are built.

- The Panch Peer of Rajasthan: Pabuji, Harbhuji, Ramdevji, Mehaji and Gogaji.
- Chant them as PA-HA-RA-ME-GO; that ordering has been enough to answer 'which of the following is NOT a Panch Peer'.
- Gogaji, Tejaji and Ramdevji are the three most asked individually.

Folk deity to shrine to district

Deity	Shrine / place	District and detail
Gogaji	Gogamedi, Nohar	Hanumangarh; born at Dadrewa (Churu); a Chauhan; 'Jahar Peer', the snake deity
Tejaji	Kharnal (birth), Sursura (death)	Nagaur / Ajmer; a Jat; mare Leelan; invoked against snakebite
Ramdevji	Ramdevra (Runicha), near Pokhran	Jaisalmer; Tanwar Rajput; 'Ramsa Peer'
Pabuji	Kolu, Phalodi	Rathore; mare Kesar Kalmi; the god of camels
Devnarayan	Asind and Malaseri Dungri	Bhilwara; the deity of the Gurjar community
Mallinath	Tilwara, on the Luni	Balotra; the Malani tract is named after him
Harbhuji	Bengti (Baingti)	Phalodi

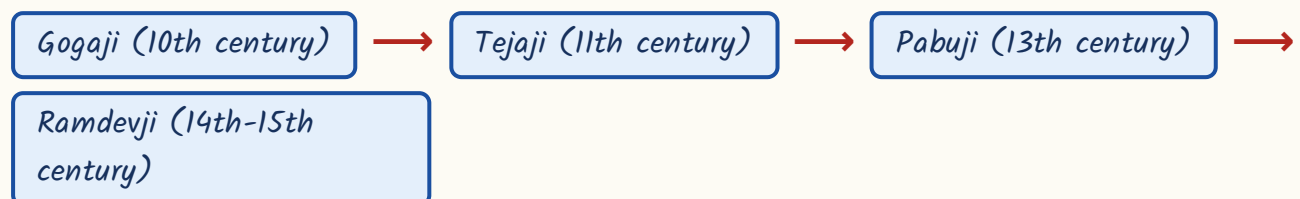
Folk deities - shrine, birthplace and district



Dots are exact for Gogamedi and Ramdevra; the rest are placed at the district town

- Gogaji's fair falls on Goga Navami, Bhadrapad Krishna Navami, at Gogamedi; farmers tie the 'Goga Rakhdi' before ploughing.
- He is revered by Hindus and Muslims alike — hence the title Jahar Peer.
- Tejaji's great cattle fair is at Parbatsar in Nagaur, in Bhadrapad.
- Ramdevji is worshipped as footprints (pagalya), not as an idol; he opposed untouchability; his followers form the Kamdiya panth.
- Terahtali is danced in Ramdevji's honour by women of the Kamad community; his fair runs Bhadrapad Shukla 2 to 11.
- Pabuji ki Phad is sung by Nayak Bhopas to the Ravanhatha; Pabuji is credited with bringing camels to Marwar and is honoured by the Raika-Rebari.
- Devnarayan ki Phad is sung to the Jantar — a different instrument from Pabuji's.
- Kalla ji Rathore, a defender of Chittor in 1568, is worshipped at Rasmi in Chittorgarh.
- Kesariya Kanwar ji and Baba Jharkhandi belong to the same class of minor folk deities and usually appear only as distractor options.

Traditional order of the folk deities — an ordering question waiting to happen



ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2023 — in which district is Gogamedi? Hanumangarh.

Asked in RAS Pre 2013 — in which district is Ramdevra? Jaisalmer. The

research digest shows folk deities were asked in 2012, 2013, 2023 and

2024 — four of the seven papers analysed. Treat this as a near-certainty.

TRAP

Two phads, two instruments — Pabuji ki Phad goes with the Ravanhatha, Devnarayan ki Phad with the Jantar. RPSC's statement version swaps them. And Gogaji was a CHAUHAN, not a Rathore; Pabuji is the Rathore. Also keep Kharnal (Tejaji's birthplace, Nagaur) apart from Parbatsar (his fair, also Nagaur) and Sursura (his death, Ajmer).

CURRENT LINK

Current link (as of September 2026): the 1111th Avatara Mahotsav of Devnarayan ji was marked at Malaseri Dungri in Bhilwara on 28 January 2023, with the Prime Minister attending. Since then Malaseri Dungri has been pushed as a Gurjar pilgrimage circuit site. If RPSC dresses a folk-deity question as current affairs, this is the hook — and the answer still reduces to Devnarayan = Gurjar = Asind/Malaseri = Bhilwara = Jantar.

Folk goddesses — kuldevis and their places

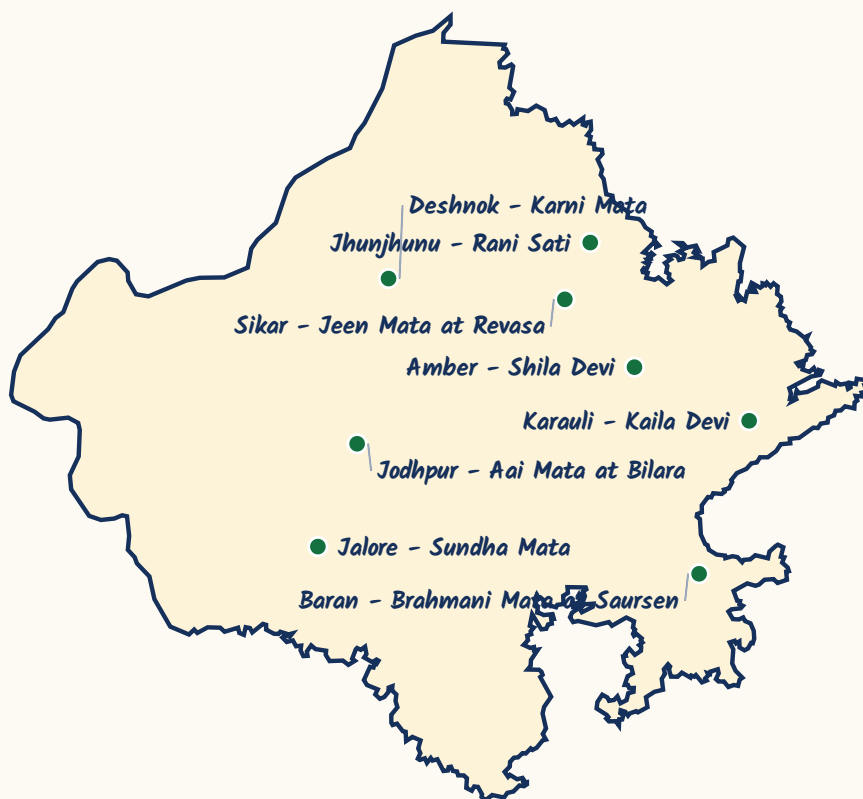
Same drill as the deities, but here the second column is the community whose kuldevi she is. Karni Mata for the Charans and the Bikaner Rathores, Shila Devi for the Kachhwahas, Kaila Devi for the Jadauns of Karauli, Aai Mata for the Sirvis. Place first, community second.

Folk goddess to place to district

Goddess	Place	District and detail
Karni Mata	Deshnok	Bikaner; Charan kuldevi; the white rats called 'kaba'
Jeen Mata	Revasa	Sikar
Shila Devi	Amber	Jaipur; brought by Man Singh I

Goddess	Place	District and detail
Kaila Devi	Trikut hills, on the Kalisil	Karauli; kuldevi of the Jadaun (Yadav) rulers; Languriya songs
Aai Mata	Bilara	Jodhpur; kuldevi of the Sirvis
Sundha Mata	Sundha hill, Jaswantpura	Jalore; a headless idol; Rajasthan's first ropeway, 2006
Rani Sati	Jhunjhunu	The Rani Sati temple
Brahmani Mata	Saursen	Baran; worshipped from behind; a donkey fair is held

Folk goddesses - place first, community second



District towns used as anchors; each goddess lies in the district shown

- Karni Mata is credited with laying the foundation of Mehrangarh at Jodhpur in 1459 — Mehrangarh, not Jaigarh.
- Her fair is held at Deshnok in the Chaitra and Ashwin Navratris.
- Kaila Devi's 'Lakhi' mela falls on Chaitra Shukla Ashtami.
- Sakrai (Shakambhari) Mata is worshipped at Sakrai in the Udaipurwati belt of Shekhawati.
- Karni Mata is the kuldevi of the Charans and the aradhya devi of the Bikaner Rathores.

ASKED IN RAS

RPSC's standard match here pairs Jeen Mata with Revasa, Shila Devi with Amber, Aai Mata with Bilara and Rani Sati with Jhunjhunu; the NOT-matched version has used Brahmani Mata, whose temple is at Saursen in Baran. Learn the place, not the legend — the legend is never the answer.

REVISION RECAP

1. Rajasthani descends from Maru-Gurjar Apabhramsa; ladder is Sanskrit-Pali-Prakrit-Apabhramsa-Rajasthani.
2. Grierson classified the dialects in the Linguistic Survey of India, 1908; Tessitori only researched Old Western Rajasthani.
3. Dingal = west, Charan, Marwari base, veer rasa. Pingal = east, Bhatt, Braj-mixed, shringar rasa.
4. Aadi, Hiyali and Bujh all mean 'riddle' — RAS Pre 2024.
5. Marwari is the widest dialect by area; Bagri is Ganganagar-Hanumangarh, Wagdi is Dungarpur-Banswara, Godwadi is Pali-Sirohi-Jalore, Rangdi is Pratapgarh.
6. Kuvalayamala, Uddyotana Suri, 778 AD, at Jalore, names 'Maru' among eighteen desi languages.
7. Chand Bardai-Prithviraj Raso; Narpati Nalha-Bisaldev Raso; Dalpat Vijay-Khuman Raso; Dungarsi-Shatrusal Raso.
8. Shivdas Gadan-Achaldas Khichi ri Vachanika; Padmanabh-Kanhadde Prabandh; Nayanchandra Suri-Hammir Mahakavya; Asayit-Hansawali.
9. Prithviraj Rathore 'Pithal' wrote Veli Krishan Rukmani Ri; Dursa Adha called it the fifth Veda.

10. Rajprashasti-Ranchhod Bhatt Telang, 25 slabs at Rajsamand, largest inscription in India; Vansh Bhaskar-Suryamal Mishran; Suraj Prakash-Karnidan.
11. Muhnot Nainsi, the 'Abul Fazl of Rajasthan', wrote Nainsi ri Khyat and Marwar ra Pargana ri Vigat.
12. First Sahitya Akademi Award in Rajasthani: Vijaydan Detha, 1974, Bataan Ri Phulwari; Sethia 1976 for Leeltans. Rajasthani is still outside the Eighth Schedule.
13. Vishnoi: Jambhoji, born Pipasar 1451, founded Samrathal Dhora 1485, 29 rules, samadhi Mukam; Khejarli 1730, Amrita Devi, 363 martyrs.
14. Dadu Panth-Naraina, 52 thambas; Jasnathi-Katariyasar, 36 rules, Agni dance; Laldasi-Nagla (Bharatpur); Charandasi-Delhi; Nimbarka-Salemabad; Alakhiya-Bikaner.
15. Ramsnehi: Shahpura-Ramcharan (main, Phuldol), Rain-Daryavji, Khedapa-Ramdas, Sinhthal-Haridas.
16. Panch Peer: Pabuji, Harbhujji, Ramdevji, Mehaji, Gogaji.
17. Gogaji-Gogamedi (Hanumangarh), Chauhan, Jahar Peer; Tejaji-Kharnal (Nagaur), fair at Parbatsar; Ramdevji-Ramdevra (Jaisalmer), pagalya; Pabuji-Kolu (Phalodi), Ravanhatha; Devnarayan-Asind (Bhilwara), Jantar.
18. Karni Mata-Deshnok (kaba rats, Mehrangarh foundation 1459); Jeen Mata-Revasa; Shila Devi-Amber; Kaila Devi-Karauli; Aai Mata-Bilara; Sundha Mata-Jalore, first ropeway.

RH14

Social Life: Fairs, Festivals, Customs, Dress, Ornaments, Tribes

About 2-3 questions a paper. Ornament-to-body-part and fair-to-district are near-certain; costume terms were asked in 2012, 2021 and 2024; fairs in 2013, 2016 and 2023; tribes appear in most papers.

The most learnable chapter in the paper. Almost every question here is a match — fair to district, festival to tithi, ornament to body part, tribe to region. There is very little to understand and a great deal to memorise correctly, which is exactly why careless students lose these marks.

Social Life of Rajasthan

Cattle fairs

- Pushkar — Ajmer, Kartik
- Mallinath — Tilwara, oldest
- Tejaji — Parbatsar
- Chandrabhaga — Jhalrapatan

Customs

- Jalwa Pujan, Jadula
- Sagai, Bindoli, Toran, Pheras
- Mausar / Nukta
- Nata, Aata-Sata, Dapa

Tribes

- Meena (largest), Bhil (2nd), Garasia (3rd)
- Sahariya — only PVTG, Baran
- Damor, Kathodi, Kanjar, Sansi
- Rabari, Gadia Lohar

Deity & tribal fairs

- Ramdevra — Jaisalmer
- Kaila Devi — Karauli
- Beneshwar — Dungarpur, tribal Kumbh
- Sitabari — Baran, Sahariya

Dress

- Angarkhi, Atamsukh, Dogla
- Pagri: Amarshahi, Shahjahani, Khidkidar
- Ghaghra, Kanchli, Kachhabu, Odhna
- Pomcha, Lehariya, Mothra, Kasumal

Festivals

- Gangaur — Chaitra Shukla 3
- Hariyali & Kajali Teej
- Akha Teej, Dhinga Gavar
- Ghudla, Sanjhi

Ornaments

- Rakhdi / Borla — head
- Toti — ear
- Timaniya — neck
- Bajuband — arm, Kandora — waist, Nevari — foot

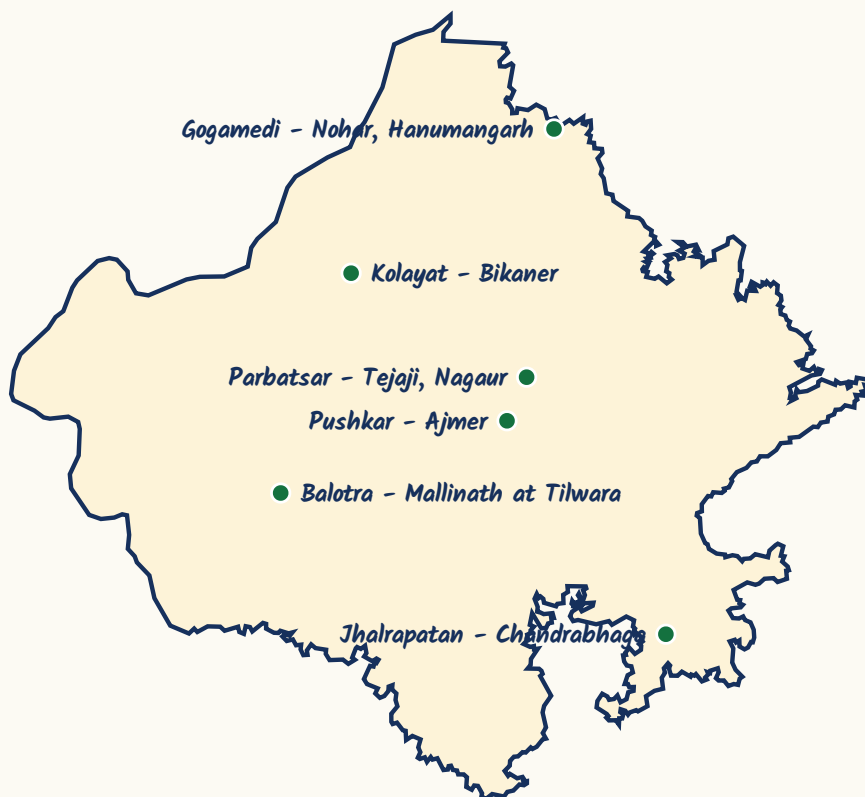
Fairs — start with the cattle fairs

Rajasthan's fairs fall into three groups: cattle fairs, deity fairs and tribal fairs. Take the cattle fairs first, because they carry the most fixed data — a place, a district, usually a river, and a month. That is exactly the shape of an RPSC question. Learn the month along with the district; the exam has asked the closing day of Pushkar directly.

The cattle fairs

Fair	Place and district	Month and note
Pushkar	Pushkar, Ajmer	Kartik Ekadashi to Kartik Purnima; the camel fair
Mallinath	Tilwara (Balotra), on the Luni	Chaitra; the oldest cattle fair of Rajasthan
Tejaji	Parbatsar, Nagaur	Bhadrpad
Chandrabhaga	Jhalrapatan, Jhalawar, on the Chandrabhaga	Kartik Purnima
Gogamedi	Nohar, Hanumangarh	Bhadrpad Krishna Navami — Goga Navami
Kolayat	Kolayat, Bikaner	Kartik Purnima; sacred to Kapil Muni

The six cattle fairs on the map



Pushkar, Chandrabhaga and Kolayat all close on Kartik Purnima

- Pushkar holds the principal Brahma temple of India — that fact is half of every Pushkar question.
 - The Malani tract of western Rajasthan takes its name from Mallinath.
 - Tejaji was born at Kharnal in Nagaur, and his fair is at Parbatsar in the same district.
 - The Kolayat fair falls on the same day as Pushkar's closing day, Kartik Purnima.
-
- Kartik Purnima is a crowded date — Pushkar, Chandrabhaga and Kolayat all end on it.
 - Chaitra belongs to Mallinath, Kaila Devi, Karni Mata, Ghudla and Gangaur.
 - Bhadrapad belongs to Tejaji, Gogaji, Ramdevra, Khejarli and Kajali Teej.
 - Magh Purnima belongs to Beneshwar; Phalgun to Khatu Shyamji.

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2016 — where is the Chandrabhaga cattle fair held? Jhalrapatan, Jhalawar. Asked in RAS Pre 2013 — where is Tejaji's great cattle fair? Parbatsar. RAS Pre 2016 also asked the closing day of the Pushkar fair (Kartik Purnima). Three cattle fairs across three papers.

Deity fairs, tribal fairs and the Muslim fairs

The deity fairs are simply the folk deities and goddesses of the previous chapter seen from the calendar side. If you already know that Ramdevra is in Jaisalmer and Kaila Devi in Karauli, you have most of this section. Fill in only the month and the distinctive detail.

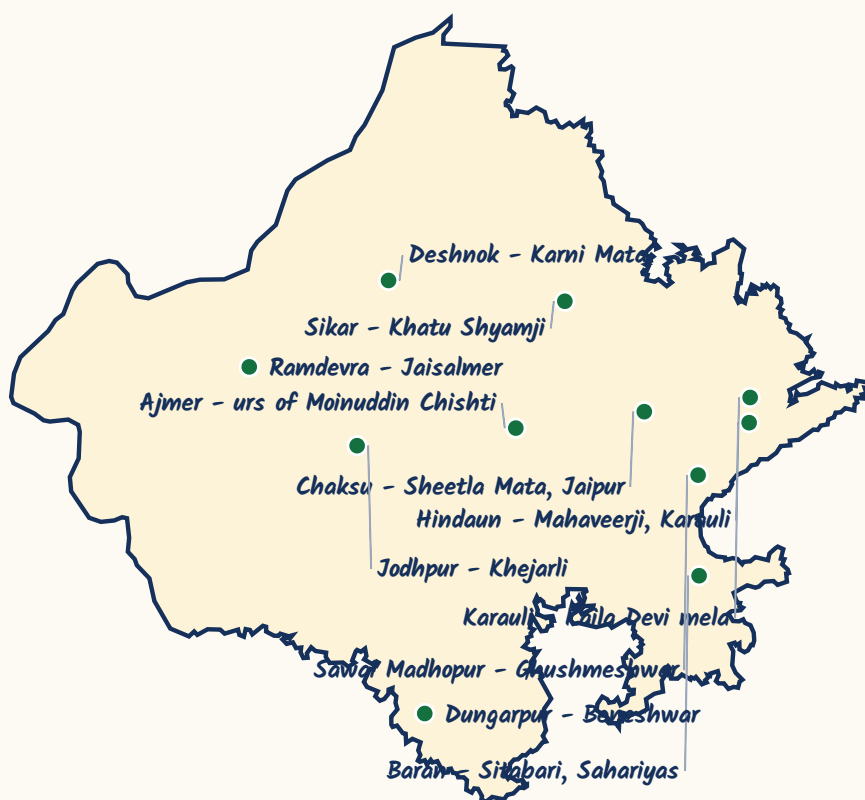
Deity and pilgrim fairs

Fair	Place	District and month
Ramdevra	Ramdevra (Runicha), near Pokhran	Jaisalmer; Bhadrapad Shukla 2 to 11
Kaila Devi 'Lakhi' mela	Trikut hills, on the Kalisil	Karauli; Chaitra Shukla Ashtami
Karni Mata	Deshnok	Bikaner; Chaitra and Ashwin Navratri
Khatu Shyamji	Khatu	Sikar; Phalgun
Mahaveerji	Chandangaon, Hindaun, on the Gambhir	Karauli
Ghushmeshwar	Shivad	Sawai Madhopur; reckoned the twelfth jyotirlinga
Sheetla Mata	Sheel ki Doongri, Chaksu	Jaipur; Chaitra Krishna Ashtami
Khejarli	Khejarli	Jodhpur; Bhadrapad Shukla Dashami
Dadu mela	Naraina	Jaipur; seat of the Dadu Panth

The tribal fairs and the two great urs

- Beneshwar — at Sabla/Navatapura in Dungarpur, at the confluence of the Som, Mahi and Jakham, on Magh Purnima; called the 'Kumbh of the tribals (Bhils)'.
- Sitabari — at Kelwara in Baran; the great fair of the Sahariyas.
- Urs of Khwaja Moinuddin Chishti — Ajmer, 1 to 6 Rajab.
- Galiakot urs — Dungarpur, of the Dawoodi Bohras, at the dargah of Syed Fakhruddin.
- Sheetla Mata is worshipped in a broken idol; her vehicle is the donkey and her priests are drawn from the Kumhar caste.
- Khejarli's fair commemorates the 363 Vishnoi tree-martyrs of 1730 led by Amrita Devi.

Deity, tribal and urs fairs - which district



Beneshwar sits at the Som-Mahi-Jakham confluence in Dungarpur

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2023 — the Beneshwar fair, the 'Kumbh of the tribals', is in which district? Dungarpur. RPSC's favourite NOT-matched trap in this list is Mallinath: the fair is at Tilwara near Balotra on the Luni, and the wrong option offered is Jaisalmer.

Gangaur and Teej — the pair the exam actually decides on

Both are women's festivals, both fall on a Tithiya, both are about Parvati. That is precisely why RPSC puts them together and swaps their months. Fix four coordinates: Gangaur is Chaitra, Teej is Shravan or Bhadrapad; Hariyali Teej belongs to Jaipur, Kajali Teej belongs to Bundi. And remember the Rajasthani saying, because it has itself been used as a statement.

Gangaur vs Teej

Gangaur	Teej
Chaitra Shukla Tithiya — eighteen days after Holi	Hariyali Teej: Shravan Shukla Tithiya. Kajali (Badi) Teej: Bhadrapad Krishna Tithiya
Worship of Isar (Shiva) and Gauri (Parvati)	Worship of Parvati; the monsoon and swing festival
Jaipur's Gangaur procession is the most famous	Hariyali Teej is Jaipur's; Kajali Teej is Bundi's
Variants: Gulabi Gangaur at Nathdwara, Dyinga Gavar at Jodhpur	Teej sawari begins the festival season
Ends the festival year	Begins the festival year

- The saying: 'Teej tyoharan ri shuruat, Gangaur tyoharan ro ant' — Teej starts the festival cycle, Gangaur ends it.
- Gulabi (Pink) Gangaur is the distinctive Gangaur of Nathdwara in Rajsamand district.
- Dyinga Gavar is celebrated at Jodhpur in Vaishakh, just after Gangaur; women in disguise take over the streets, one of the very few Indian festivals led entirely by women.
- Ghudla belongs to Marwar, in Chaitra — girls carry a perforated earthen pot with a lamp burning inside and sing Ghudla songs.

TRAP

'Kajali Teej is celebrated at Jaipur in Shravan' — FALSE, and RPSC writes it exactly like that. Kajali (Badi) Teej is Bundi's and falls in Bhadrapad Krishna. Jaipur's is Hariyali Teej, Shravan Shukla. One city, one month each — do not merge them.

ASKED IN RAS

The research digest lists Gulabi Gangaur among the fairs-and-festivals repeats of 2013, 2016 and 2023, alongside Pushkar, Beneshwar, Chandrabhaga and Tejaji. The Gulabi Gangaur question has only one answer: Nathdwara, Rajsamand. Do not write Jodhpur — Jodhpur is Dhing Gavar.

The rest of the festival calendar

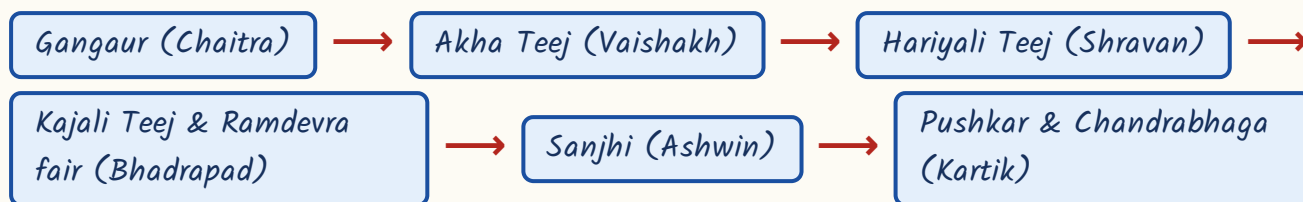
Beyond Gangaur and Teej, the exam wants festival-to-tithi matching and, occasionally, an ordering question. Both are solved the same way: memorise the Vikram Samvat month for each festival and then run the months in order.

Festival to tithi

Festival	Tithi / month	Note
Gangaur	Chaitra Shukla Tritiya	Isar and Gauri
Ghudla	Chaitra	Marwar; perforated pot with a lamp
Sheetla Ashtami	Chaitra Krishna Ashtami	Chaksu fair; cold food eaten
Akha Teej / Akshaya Tritiya	Vaishakh Shukla Tritiya	An 'abuj' muhurat; traditionally the child-marriage season
Dhing Gavar	Vaishakh	Jodhpur
Nirjala Ekadashi	Jyeshtha Shukla Ekadashi	The waterless fast
Hariyali Teej	Shravan Shukla Tritiya	Jaipur
Kajali (Badi) Teej	Bhadrapad Krishna Tritiya	Bundi

Festival	Tithi / month	Note
Goga Navami	Bhadrapad Krishna Navami	Gogamedi fair
Ramdev Jayanti / Ramdevra fair	Bhadrapad Shukla 2 to 11	Jaisalmer
Sanjhi	Ashwin Krishna Paksha (Pitru Paksha)	Cow-dung wall art made by girls; ends with immersion
Pushkar, Chandrabhaga, Kolayat	Kartik Purnima	The three Kartik fairs
Makar Sankranti	Mid-January, when the sun enters Capricorn	Kite flying, especially at Jaipur

The festival year in order, beginning with Chaitra



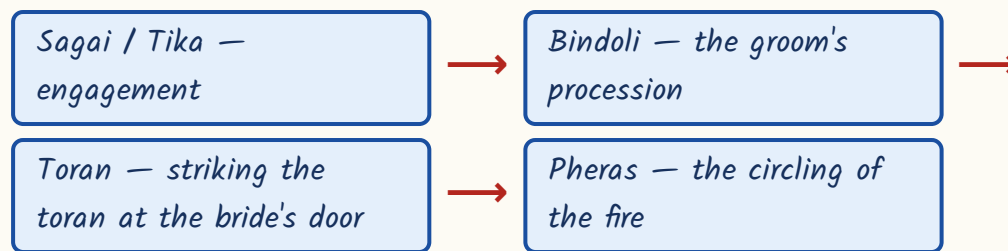
YAAD RAKHO

Fix the Vikram Samvat month order once and every ordering question in this chapter solves itself: Chaitra, Vaishakh, Jyeshtha, Ashadh, Shravan, Bhadrapad, Ashwin, Kartik, Margashirsha, Paush, Magh, Phalgun. The year starts in Chaitra, not January.

Customs — birth, marriage and death

The exam asks these as vocabulary: it gives a Rajasthani word and asks what it means, or gives four word-meaning pairs and asks which is wrong. So learn the word first and the ritual second. Group them by stage of life — that is how you stop confusing them.

The marriage sequence



- *Jalwa Puja* — the mother worships a well or water source a few days after childbirth.
- *Jadula (Mundan)* — the child's first tonsure. *Dhundh* — a birth-related celebration for the newborn boy.
- *Mausar (Mosar)* and *Nukta* — the community feast given after a death; long criticised as a cause of rural indebtedness.
- *Nata pratha* — a woman goes to live with another man after a settlement, usually a money payment.
- *Aata-Sata* — exchange marriage, where two families exchange brides. Do not confuse it with *Nata*.
- *Dapa* — the bride price paid among the *Garasia*, *Sahariya* and *Damor* tribes.
- *Talak* — the customary term for separation in some communities.
- *Kanyavarodh* — the practice that kept girls from marrying outside a narrow circle, driving up dowry demands and, in extreme form, feeding female infanticide.
- The *Walterkrit Rajputana Hitkarini Sabha* (1888, Ajmer) was set up largely to curb *Kanyavarodh*, extravagant marriage expenditure and *Mausar*.
- This is the link between this chapter and the 19th-century reform chapter — *RPSC* has asked the *Walterkrit Sabha* directly, in 2024.
- *Sati* was abolished in *Bundi* in 1822 and across *Rajputana* in 1844; the *Tyaga* and *Dakan* customs were struck down at *Udaipur* in 1853.

Dress — men's and women's terms

Two kinds of question come from dress. One is a plain vocabulary question ('Atamsukh is what?'). The other is a colour or textile question, and there Kasumal, Lehariya and Mothra are the repeats. Keep the men's list and the women's list separate in your head; RPSC's wrong option is usually a women's garment slipped into a men's list.

- Men: Dhoti, Angarkha/Angarkhi (upper garment), Atamsukh (long padded winter coat), Dogla, Patka, Mojari.
 - Pagri styles: Amarshahi (after Maharana Amar Singh of Mewar), Shahjahani, Khidkidar, Udaishahi, Rajshahi, Jodhpuri safa.
 - Kachhabu is a woman's upper garment, NOT a turban style — RPSC has used it as the wrong option in a pagri list.
 - Poti and Chirmi are among the other named cloth items of the traditional wardrobe.
-
- Women: Ghaghra (the pleated skirt), Kanchli/Kurti (the bodice), Kachhabu (upper garment), Odhna/Chunari (the veil).
 - Pomcha — a yellow odhni printed with lotus motifs, traditionally given and worn on the birth of a child.
 - Lehariya — diagonal wave-like stripes, worn in the Teej and Shravan season. It is NOT concentric circles.
 - Mothra — lehariya tied diagonally in both directions, producing a criss-cross check.
 - Bandhej — the tie-and-dye craft; Jodhpur, Jaipur and Sikar are noted centres.
 - Kasumal — a deep red or crimson, named after kusum, safflower, from which the dye was obtained.

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2024 — 'Kasumal', a colour used in Rajasthani costume, is what? Answer: deep red or crimson, from safflower. The research digest groups Kasumal with Toti as a costume-and-ornament repeat cluster of 2012, 2021 and 2024, so expect one question from this pair of topics every paper.

Ornaments — the most directly asked table in the chapter

RPSC asks this as bluntly as a question can be asked: 'On which part of the body is X worn?' There is no reasoning involved and no partial credit. Learn the body part and nothing else. Read the table downwards once, then cover the right column and recall it.

Ornaments of the head and upper body

Body part	Ornaments
Head	Rakhdi / Borla, Sheeshphool, Memand, Tikda
Ear	Toti, Jhumka, Surliya, Bali
Nose	Nath, Nathdi, Bhanwariya, Laung
Neck	Timaniya, Hansli, Kanthi, Aad, Hamel, Madaliya

Ornaments of the arm, waist and foot

Body part	Ornaments
Arm and hand	Bajuband (upper arm), Chuda, Gajra, Pahunchi, Hathphool
Waist	Kandora, Kardhani, Tagdi
Foot	Payal, Nevari, Kadi, Anwala, Bichhiya, Rimjhol

YAAD RAKHO

Seven anchors and this topic is finished: Rakhdi head, Toti ear, Nathdi nose, Timaniya neck, Bajuband arm, Kandora waist, Nevari foot. One warning — Anwala sounds like an arm word but it is a hollow circular ornament worn on the FOOT. Rakhdi/Borla is also the mark of a married woman.

Where each ornament is worn - head to foot**Rakhdi / Borla**

head; mark of a married woman

Nathdi

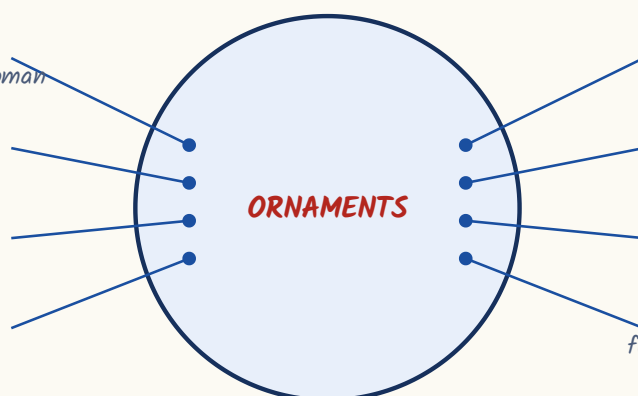
nose

Bajuband

upper arm

Nevari

foot

**Toti**

ear (asked RAS Pre 2021)

Timaniya

neck

Kandora

waist

Anwala

foot, not arm - the usual trap

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2021 — on which part of the body is 'Toti' worn?

Answer: the ear. RPSC's match version in the same family runs

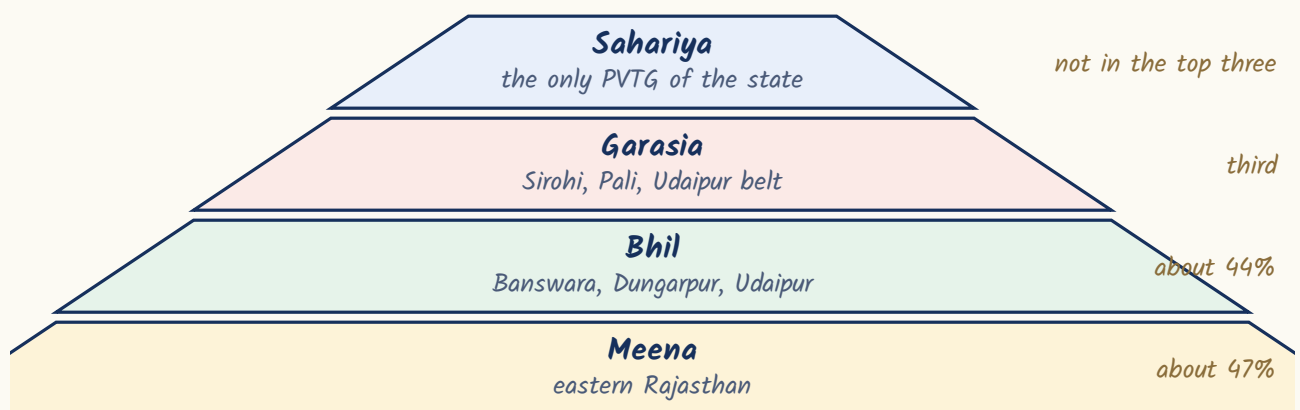
Sheeshphool-head, Bhanwariya-nose, Bajuband-upper arm, Nevari-foot, and its NOT-matched version has used Anwala, which belongs to the foot.

Tribes — the framework, and Bhil against Mina

Start with the population order, because a wrong assumption here poisons three or four questions. Scheduled Tribes are 13.48 per cent of Rajasthan's population by Census 2011. The order is Meena first, Bhil second, Garasia third. Sahariya is the only PVTG in the state — but being the most vulnerable does not make it the largest or the second largest, and that gap is exactly where RPSC sets its trap.

- Census 2011: Scheduled Tribes are 13.48 per cent of Rajasthan's population.
- Meena is the largest ST, about 47 per cent of the state's ST population.
- Bhil is second, about 44 per cent. Garasia is third.
- Sahariya is the only Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Group of Rajasthan, but is not among the top three by population.
- The Tribal Area Development (TAD) department has its headquarters at Udaipur.

Scheduled Tribes by share of the ST population



Bhil vs Mina

Bhil	Mina (Meena)
Southern Rajasthan — Banswara, Dungarpur, Udaipur, Pratapgarh	Eastern Rajasthan
Second largest ST, about 44 per cent of the ST population	Largest ST, about 47 per cent of the ST population
Village head: Gameti. Hamlet: Phala. Group of hamlets: Pal	Divided into Zamindar Mina and Chowkidar Mina
Shifting cultivation called Walra — Chimata on hill slopes, Dajiya on the plains	Settled cultivators; described as the most educated tribe of the state
Dances: Gawari (Rai) in Shravan-Bhadrapad in Mewar, and Ghoomar	Meena Kshatriya Mahasabha founded 1933; removed from the Criminal Tribes list in 1952
Called the 'bowmen of India'; Beneshwar is their Kumbh	The Chowkidar Minas served traditionally as village watchmen

- The Bhil settlement ladder, in order: Phala (hamlet) to Pal (group of hamlets) to the village under the Gameti.
- Walra is the name of the shifting-cultivation practice as a whole.
- Bhil tribal movements — Govind Giri, the Samp Sabha and Mangarh 1913 — belong to the movements chapter but the same tribe.
- Mina headmen are not called Gameti; Gameti is Bhil, Mukhi is Damor, Kotwal is Sahariya.

TRAP

Chimata is on the HILL SLOPES; Dajiya is on the PLAINS. RPSC has run this as a two-statement question with the terms reversed, and both statements were wrong. Say it once, correctly: Chimata-Chadhai (slope), Dajiya-Dharti (plain).

CURRENT LINK

Current link (as of September 2026): the 13.48 per cent figure and the Meena-Bhil-Garasia order still rest on Census 2011, because no fresher count exists. The next Census of India has been notified for 2027 and will be conducted in two phases, with 1 March 2027 as the reference date for most of the country and 1 October 2026 for the snow-bound areas, and it will enumerate caste for the first time since 1931. Until those figures are published, answer every tribal-population statement in this chapter from Census 2011.

The smaller tribes and the nomadic communities

For each of the smaller tribes the exam wants three things: the district, the word for the headman, and one distinctive custom or dance. Nothing more. Read the table as three columns of vocabulary, not as ethnography.

Tribe to area to headman and distinctive terms

Tribe	Main area	Headman and distinctive terms
Bhil	Banswara, Dungarpur, Udaipur, Pratapgarh	Gameti; Phala, Pal; Walra cultivation; Gawari dance
Mina	Eastern Rajasthan	Zamindar Mina and Chowkidar Mina; Mahasabha 1933
Garasia	Abu Road and Pindwara (Sirohi), Bali (Pali), Gogunda and Kotra (Udaipur)	House 'Gher', hamlet 'Faliya'; marriages Mor Bandhiya, Peharavana, Tanana; bride price 'Dapa'; Valar/Gaur dance
Sahariya	Kishanganj and Shahbad tehsils, Baran	Headman 'Kotwal'; huts Topa, Korua, Gopna; the only PVTG; Sitabari fair
Damor	Simalwara and Aspur (Dungarpur), Banswara	Headman 'Mukhi'; the Gyaras fair
Kathodi	Kotra and Jhadol, Udaipur	Migrants from Maharashtra; make katha from khair wood; Mavlia dance

Tribe	Main area	Headman and distinctive terms
Kanjar	Hadoti region	Deities Jogania Mata, Chauth Mata, Hanuman; Chakri and Dhakad dances
Sansi	Bharatpur	Sub-groups Bija and Mala; kuldevi Sikodari Mata
Rabari / Raika	Marwar, western Rajasthan	Camel breeders; worship Pabuji
Gadia Lohar	Nomadic, across the state	Blacksmiths travelling in bullock carts; the Chittor vow

Tribal belts of Rajasthan



The Tribal Area Development department has its headquarters at Udaipur

- *Gadia Lohar: they vowed not to return to Chittorgarh after its fall to Akbar in 1568; Jawaharlal Nehru led them into Chittorgarh fort in 1955.*
- *Garasia is the third largest ST and lives in the Sirohi-Pali-Udaipur belt, not in Baran and Jhalawar.*
- *Kalbeliya and Bhopa are the well-known performing communities; the Kalbeliya dance was inscribed on UNESCO's Intangible Cultural Heritage list in 2010.*
- *Sitabari at Kelwara in Baran is the Sahariyas' sacred fair; Beneshwar in Dungarpur is the Bhils'.*

TRAP

Two Sahariya half-truths RPSC has used together. The Sahariyas are the only PVTG of Rajasthan and they do live in Kishanganj and Shahbad in Baran — but they are NOT the second largest tribe; the Bhils are. And on the Gadia Lohars, the vow was about CHITTORGARH, not Jodhpur, and it was NEHRU, not Patel, who led them into the fort in 1955.

CURRENT LINK

Current link (as of September 2026): PM-JANMAN, the Pradhan Mantri Janjati Adivasi Nyaya Maha Abhiyan, was launched on 15 November 2023 with about Rs 24,104 crore over three years for India's PVTGs, with roughly 80 per cent going to housing and roads. In Rajasthan it means exactly one community — the Sahariyas of Kishanganj and Shahbad in Baran, who have been getting housing, road connectivity and electrification under it. Expect 'the only PVTG of Rajasthan' to arrive dressed as a scheme question rather than a tribes question.

REVISION RECAP

1. Pushkar — Ajmer, Kartik Ekadashi to Purnima, camel fair, India's principal Brahma temple.

2. Mallinath at Tilwara (Balotra) on the Luni, Chaitra — the oldest cattle fair; Chandrabhaga at Jhalrapatan, Jhalawar, Kartik Purnima.
3. Tejaji fair — Parbatsar, Nagaur, Bhadrapad; Gogamedi — Nohar, Hanumangarh; Kolayat — Bikaner, Kartik Purnima, Kapil Muni.
4. Beneshwar — Sabla, Dungarpur, Som-Mahi-Jakham confluence, Magh Purnima, the tribal Kumbh; Sitabari — Kelwara, Baran, the Sahariya fair.
5. Kaila Devi Lakhi mela — Karauli, Chaitra Shukla Ashtami; Ramdevra — Jaisalmer, Bhadrapad Shukla 2-11; Khatu Shyamji — Sikar, Phalgun.
6. Ghushmeshwar at Shivad (Sawai Madhopur) is reckoned the twelfth jyotirlinga; Sheetla Mata at Chaksu has a broken idol, a donkey vehicle and Kumhar priests.
7. Gangaur — Chaitra Shukla Tritiya, Isar and Gauri; Gulabi Gangaur at Nathdwara; Dyinga Gavar at Jodhpur in Vaishakh.
8. Hariyali Teej is Jaipur's, Shravan Shukla Tritiya; Kajali Teej is Bundi's, Bhadrapad Krishna Tritiya. Teej starts the festival year, Gangaur ends it.
9. Akha Teej — Vaishakh Shukla Tritiya, an abuj muhurat; Sanjhi — Ashwin Krishna Paksha; Ghudla — Marwar, Chaitra.
10. Jalwa Pujan is well worship after childbirth; Jadula is the mundan; Mausar and Nukta are death feasts; Nata is remarriage by settlement; Dapa is bride price.
11. Men: Angarkhi, Atamsukh (winter coat), Dogla, Patka. Pagri styles Amarshahi, Shahjahani, Khidkidar, Udaishahi.
12. Women: Ghaghra, Kanchli, Kachhabu, Odhna. Pomcha is the yellow lotus odhni for a childbirth; Lehariya is diagonal stripes; Mothra is lehariya both ways.
13. Kasumal is deep red/crimson from kusum, safflower — RAS Pre 2024.
14. Ornaments: Rakhdi/Borla head, Toti ear, Nathdi nose, Timaniya neck, Bajuband arm, Kandora waist, Nevari and Anwala foot.
15. STs are 13.48% of Rajasthan (Census 2011); order Meena (about 47%) > Bhil (about 44%) > Garasia.
16. Bhil: Gameti, Phala, Pal, Walra — Chimata on slopes, Dajiya on plains; Gawari dance; bowmen of India.
17. Sahariya is the only PVTG, Baran, headman Kotwal, huts Topa/Korua/Gopna; Damor headman Mukhi; Garasia bride price Dapa, dance Valar.
18. Kathodi — Udaipur, katha from khair; Kanjar — Hadoti; Sansi — Bharatpur; Rabari/Raika — camel breeders of Marwar; Gadia Lohar — Chittor vow 1568, Nehru 1955; TAD headquarters at Udaipur.